PRESBITERIAN MACKENZIE UNIVERSITY

ANNY VICTÓRIA LACERA AUERSWALD ALBINO

SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING IN A BRAZILIAN MEAT AND DERIVATIVE COMPANY: A STUDY OF MEATCO (2018-2023)

São Paulo
2024

ANNY VICTÓRIA LACERA AUERSWALD ALBINO

SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING IN A BRAZILIAN MEAT AND DERIVATIVE COMPANY: A STUDY OF MEATCO (2018-2023)

Thesis presented to the Graduate Program in Business Administration from Presbiterian Mackenzie University as partial requirement to obtain a Master's degree in Business Administration.

Advisor: Prof. Dr. Almir Martins Vieira

São Paulo

2024

A336s Albino, Anny Victória Lacera Auerswald.
Social sustainability reporting in a brazilian meat and derivative company: a study of meatco (2018-2023) [recurso eletrônico] / Anny Victória Lacera Auerswald Albino.
2 KB ; il.

Dissertação (Mestrado em Administração de Empresas) – Universidade Presbiteriana Mackenzie, São Paulo, 2024.
Orientador: Prof. Dr. Almir Martins Vieira
Bibliografia: p. 123-134

1. Sustentabilidade social nas organizações. 2. Sustentabilidade social. 3. Relatórios de sustentabilidade. 4. Teoria dos Stakeholders. I. Vieira, Almir Martins, *orientador*. II. Título.

Bibliotecária Responsável: Aline Amarante Pereira - CRB 8/9549

Folha de Identificação da Agência de Financiamento

Autor: Anny Victória Lacera Auerswald Albino

Programa de Pós-Graduação *Stricto Sensu* em Administração de Empresas

Título do Trabalho: SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING IN A BRAZILIAN MEAT AND DERIVATIVE COMPANY: A STUDY OF MEATCO (2018-2023)

O presente trabalho foi realizado com o apoio de [1]:

☒ CAPES - Coordenação de Aperfeiçoamento de Pessoal de Nível Superior

☐ CNPq - Conselho Nacional de Desenvolvimento Científico e Tecnológico

☐ FAPESP - Fundação de Amparo à Pesquisa do Estado de São Paulo

☐ Instituto Presbiteriano Mackenzie/Isenção integral de Mensalidades e Taxas

☐ MACKPESQUISA - Fundo Mackenzie de Pesquisa

☐ Empresa/Indústria:

☐ Outro:

[1] **Observação**: caso tenha usufruído mais de um apoio ou benefício, selecione-os.

ANNY VICTÓRIA LACERA AUERSWALD ALBINO

SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING IN BRAZILIAN MEAT AND DERIVATIVE COMPANY: A Study of MeatCo (2018-2023)

Dissertação apresentada ao Programa de Pós-Graduação em Administração de Empresas da Universidade Presbiteriana Mackenzie, como requisito parcial à obtenção de título de Mestre em Administração de Empresas.

Aprovada em

BANCA EXAMINADORA

Documento assinado digitalmente
gov.br
ALMIR MARTINS VIEIRA
Data: 19/12/2024 16:00:51-0300
Verifique em https://validar.iti.gov.br

Prof. Dr. Almir Martins Vieira
Universidade Presbiteriana Mackenzie

Documento assinado digitalmente
gov.br
DARCY MITIKO MORI HANASHIRO
Data: 20/12/2024 10:27:12-0300
Verifique em https://validar.iti.gov.br

Prof. Dr. Darcy Mitiko Mori Hanashiro
Universidade Presbiteriana Mackenzie

Documento assinado digitalmente
gov.br
RAQUEL DA SILVA PEREIRA
Data: 20/12/2024 08:24:45-0300
Verifique em https://validar.iti.gov.br

Prof. Dr. Raquel da Silva Pereira
Universidade Municipal de São Caetano do Sul

RESUMO

Sustentabilidade social nas organizações é um conceito complexo com várias definições. Ela é parte do tripé da sustentabilidade. Porém, é a mais negligenciada, apesar de sua importância para o alcance dos demais aspectos da sustentabilidade. Considerando a importância de questões sociais para diversos stakeholders, é relevante que as empresas relatem suas ações em relação ao tema de forma coerente com suas práticas de sustentabilidade social. A indústria de carne e derivados enfrenta desafios de sustentabilidade social, incluindo grilagem de terras, violações dos direitos indígenas, condições precárias de saúde e segurança dos trabalhadores, condições laborais inadequadas e trabalho infantil. Embora a demanda por produtos éticos esteja aumentando, o consumo global de carne e o papel do Brasil como um dos principais fornecedores de carne continuam a se expandir, exigindo que as empresas equilibrem o lucro com as expectativas sociais. Considerando que a Teoria dos Stakeholders tem sido o principal referencial teórico para facilitar a compreensão da influência, consequências, preocupações e perspectivas de diferentes stakeholders em relação às práticas de sustentabilidade social das empresas, este estudo teve como objetivo responder à seguinte questão de pesquisa: Como as práticas de sustentabilidade social de uma empresa no setor de carne e derivados evoluíram ao longo do tempo e como essas práticas influenciaram e foram influenciadas pelos relacionamentos com os stakeholders? Para responder a essa questão, este estudo investigou as práticas de sustentabilidade social de uma empresa do setor entre 2018 e 2023, por meio da análise de seu relatório de sustentabilidade baseado no Global Reporting Initiative (GRI). O relatório da empresa se tornou mais completo ao longo do tempo, com mais melhorias do que retrocessos nos indicadores de sustentabilidade social. No entanto, as melhorias na transparência nem sempre se traduzem em melhores resultados sociais. No estágio de “conformidade” da sustentabilidade social, os esforços da MeatCo

permanecem reativos, enfatizando a adesão regulatória em vez de um impacto social integrado e uma interação efetiva com os stakeholders.

Palavras-chave: *Sustentabilidade social nas organizações; Sustentabilidade social; Relatórios de sustentabilidade; Teoria dos Stakeholders.*

ABSTRACT

Social sustainability in organizations is a complex concept with several definitions. It is part of the sustainability triple bottom line. However, despite its importance to achieving the other aspects of sustainability, it is the most neglected. Considering the importance of social issues for various stakeholders, it is relevant for companies to disclose their actions on the topic in a coherent form. The meat and derivatives industry faces social sustainability challenges, including land grabbing, Indigenous rights violations, poor worker health and safety, substandard labor conditions, and child labor. Although demand for ethical products is rising, global meat consumption and Brazil's role as a leading meat supplier continue to expand, requiring companies to balance profit with social expectations. Considering that Stakeholder Theory (ST) has been the most used theoretical background to facilitate the understanding of the influence, consequences, concerns, and perspectives of different stakeholders regarding business social sustainability practices, this study aimed to answer the following research question: How have the social sustainability practices of the company in the meat and derivatives sector evolved over time, and how have these practices influenced and been influenced by relationships with stakeholders? To answer that, this study investigated the social sustainability practices of one company from the sector from 2018 to 2023, through analysis of their Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) based sustainability report. The company's reporting has become more complete through time, and with overall more improvements than setbacks in social sustainability indicators. However, the improvements in transparency don't consistently translate to better social outcomes. Positioned at the "compliance" stage of social sustainability, MeatCo's efforts remain reactive, emphasizing regulatory adherence over integrated social impact and stakeholders' interaction.

Palavras-chave: *Social sustainability in organizations; Social sustainability;*

Sustainability reports; Stakeholders Theory.

Contents

1 INTRODUCTION **12**

1.1 RESEARCH QUESTION AND OBJECTIVES 15

1.1.1 Guiding question for this research 15

1.1.2 Objectives 16

1.1.2.1 General objective 16

1.1.2.2 Specific objectives 16

2 THEORETICAL BACKGROUND **17**

2.1 SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY IN ORGANIZATIONS AS PART OF SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT: HISTORY 17

2.2 STAKEHOLDER THEORY 24

2.3 SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY AND THE STAKEHOLDER THEORY 27

2.3.1 Defining social sustainability in organizations 27

2.3.2 Stakeholder Theory Relationship with Social Sustainability in Organization studies 29

2.4 SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING: FROM STAKEHOLDERS FOR STAKEHOLDERS 31

3 METHODOLOGICAL PROCEDURES **35**

3.1 CLASSIFICATION OF THE RESEARCH 35

3.2 DATA COLLECTION 36

3.3 DATA ANALYSIS 38

3.4 COMPANY SELECTION 43

4 RESULTS **48**

4.1 ABOUT THE COMPANY 48

4.2 EVALUATION OF CONSISTENCY IN SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING 50

4.3 EVALUATION OF THE DEVELOPMENT OF SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY INDICATORS OVER TIME 54
4.3.1 Employment (GRI 401) 55
4.3.2 Occupational Health and Safety (GRI 403) 61
4.3.2.1 Occupational Health and Safety (GRI 403 2016) 61
4.3.2.2 Occupational Health and Safety (GRI 403 2018) 66
4.3.3 Training and Education (GRI 404) 78
4.3.4 Diversity and Equal Opportunity (GRI 405) 84
4.3.5 Non-discrimination (GRI 406) 91
4.3.6 Freedom of Association and Collective Bargaining (GRI 407) . . 92
4.3.7 Child Labor (GRI 408) and Forced or Compulsory Labor (GRI 409) 92
4.3.8 Local Communities (GRI 413) 93
4.3.9 Supplier Social Assessment (GRI 414) 95
4.3.10 Public Policy (GRI 415) 96
4.3.11 Customer Health and Safety (GRI 416) 96
4.3.12 Marketing and Labeling (GRI 417) 97
4.3.13 Customer Privacy (GRI 418) 99
4.4 STAKEHOLDER IDENTIFICATION AND ANALYSIS IN MEATCO'S SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY REPORTS 100
5 DISCUSSION **114**
6 FINAL CONSIDERATIONS **118**
References **125**
Appendices **137**
A Theoretical lenses used in SSO studies. **137**
B Definitions of Social sustainability in organizations by studies through stakeholder theorey lense **139**
C Initial template for analysis: stakeholders related to GRI 400 Disclosures and report requirements (GRI, 2016a-q and 2018) **142**

List of Figures

1 Timeline of social sustainability in organizazations. 17

2 SDGs related to social sustainability adapted from United Nations (2015) 21

3 Word Cloud created based on social sustainability in organizations definitions 28

4 Main stakeholders related with GRI 400 (Social sustainability topics). . . 33

5 Company selection flow 46

6 MeatCo Global Operations, Brand Leadership and Governance structure (2023) 50

7 MeatCo's percentage of turnover by region from 2018-2023 56

8 Retention rates of employees that took parental leave, by gender. 57

9 Percentage of employees that were entitled to take parental leave and took it at MeatCo, by gender. 60

10 Average hours of capacitation carried out by the employees of the organization during the period of the report, separated by gender, MeatCo (2018-2023). . . 79

11 Average hours of capacitation carried out by the employees of the organization during the period of the report, separated by gender, MeatCo (2018-2023). . . 80

12 Percentage of employees per employee category by gender, MeatCo 85

13 Percentage of blacks and mixed-race employees, MeatCo (2020-2023) 86

14 Ratio of the basic salary and remuneration of women to men for each employee category, by significant locations of operation 89

15 Frequency of Stakeholder Appearances as Impacted by the Organization in GRI 400 Disclosures from MeatCo Sustainability Reports (2018–2023) 100

16 Frequency of Stakeholder Appearances as Causing Impact in the Organization in GRI 400 Disclosures from MeatCo Sustainability Reports (2018–2023) . . . 106

List of Tables

1 Research question, objectives and methods alignment matrix 36

2 Example of systematic examination of qualitative data 39

3 Example of systematic examination of quantitative data 40

4 Stakeholder classification from MeatCo's GRI disclosures. 44

5 Trend over time of GRI 404 disclosures from MeatCo. 45

6 Level of Completeness in Sustainability Reporting of GRI-Based Social Sustainability Indicators (2018-2023) at MeatCo. 51

7 Evaluation of Social Sustainability Indicators in GRI-Based Reports: Evolution Over Time (MeatCo 2018-203) 54

8 MeatsCo turnover percentage by gender (2018-2023). 58

9 MeatsCo turnover percentage by age group (2018-2023). 59

10 Health and safety management system based on recognized risk management and/or management system standards/guidelines (MeatCO 2020-2023) 72

11 Percentage of employees by gender and functional category that received regular performance and development on the career evaluation during the reporting period. 82

12 Percentage of employees per employee category by age group, MeatCo (2019-2023) 90

1 INTRODUCTION

Social sustainability in organizations (SSO) is a concept that still lacks consensus. SSO derives from the broader concept of social sustainability, one of the three pillars of sustainability (environmental, economic, and social) proposed by the United Nations in 1987 (United Nations, 1987) . Sustainability is defined as the ability to meet present needs without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs.

Since then, several initiatives have been taken across different spheres of society to contribute to sustainable development. However, most initiatives have focused on the economic and environmental aspects, neglecting the social pillar (Ajmal et al., 2017), which influences how sustainability is approached (Commer et al., 2022).

Yet, problems and solutions for environmental and economic issues emerge from social relations, and since a large amount of social interaction occurs in the workplace, social sustainability can be considered a prerequisite for the other aspects of sustainability (Prieto et al., 2022).

However, studies regarding SSO have presented varying definitions, making it challenging to develop comprehensive theories on the topic. Ullah et al. (2021, p. 5) define SSO as ”amiability of the relationship between the employees and the organization on a relatively permanent basis” considering exclusively the relationship between employee and organization.

On the other hand, Commer et al. (2022, p. 168) defined it as “simply a measure of people’s welfare. It is a process for sustainable and fruitful places that support well-being by considering what individuals need from where they work and live.”, expanding the relationship of the company with the non-workers from the company, but the society as a whole that could be impacted by it.

Social sustainability in administration and business has often focused on Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) (Meseguer-Sánchez et al., 2021), which is “the concept

by which companies integrate social and environmental concerns into their commercial operations and their interaction with stakeholders on a voluntary basis" (European Commission of the Communities, 2001). Therefore, CSR encompasses issues of social sustainability; however, it is not synonymous with social sustainability, as it also includes environmental issues.

Interest in SSO has increased within the academic context (Commer et al., 2022) due to several factors: rising corporate interest in social topics such as human rights, gender equality, health and safety practices (Meseguer-Sánchez et al., 2021), the insufficiency of current economic models related to business practices to guarantee long-term social welfare Missimer and Mesquita, 2022, and the potential for SSO practices to contribute to organizational effectiveness and competitive advantage Ullah et al., 2021.

SSO is vital for sustainability performance and faces increasing pressure for proactive adoption by companies, not only for its intrinsic value but also for its contributions to local employability, engagement with native cultures (Foot & Roos, 2004), and improved financial performance (Wang et al., 2022).

Considering the importance of social issues for various stakeholders, companies must report their actions on these issues in a way that is consistent with their achievements in this area. Although many authors claim that social sustainability is the most neglected aspect of the triple bottom line academically, the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) frameworks predominantly feature social aspects.

In this sense, GRI standards aim to standardize sustainability reports to enhance transparency regarding companies' practices and their impact on sustainable development. This standardization provides credible material for assessment and informed decision-making (GRI, 2021), and has been accompanied by an increase in the num-

ber of companies disclosing their sustainable practices using the GRI framework (Crisóstomo et al., 2020).

Several studies have utilized the GRI standards. Jadhav et al. (2020) used the framework to relate sustainability disclosures to companies' financial performance. Absar et al. (2021) investigated the most frequently disclosed topics regarding human capital under the GRI standards. Yadava and Sinha, 2016, based on GRI guidelines, compared the sustainability performance of public and private sector companies.

However, the role of the GRI in those studies was limited to measuring the level of detail companies provided in each topic disclosure, rather than assessing their actual sustainability performance. This distinction is crucial considering the increasing demand for ethically produced products. In the United States, retail sales of products with sustainability claims have outperformed those without, showing 1.7% more sales growth in the same period (2018-2022) (McKinsey & NielsenIQ, 2023).

This demand for ethical products coincides with a rise in meat consumption globally (González et al., 2020). Brazil has played an increasingly important role as a meat supplier for the world. Its market share in the world exports of beef in 2017-2021 was 13,68%, pork 5,64% and chicken 29,24%, in 2000-2004, the market share was 7,06%, 3,21% and 21,95% respectively (Binotti & Bertolini, 2023). Therefore, in Brazil, the Meat and Derivatives sector from the Brazilian stock market holds significant importance due to its substantial socio-economic impact.

To maintain this position, the sector must adapt to various changes in the globalized economy. Beyond factors related to profit, it needs to fulfill the social expectations of its buyers (Sehnem et al., 2012).

Practices such as land grabbing (Varrotti et al., 2022), disregard for Indigenous rights (Bowman et al., 2021), negative health effects on workers (De-Assis et al., 2021) and the local community (Fan et al., 2020), poor working conditions (Freshour, 2019),

and child labor (Dreier, 2023) raise concerns about the sector's social sustainability performance.

In this context, Stakeholder Theory (ST) has been the most widely used theoretical framework for understanding the influence, consequences, concerns, and perspectives of different stakeholders regarding business practices. Aligning stakeholder expectations with organizational practices contributes to a more coherent approach to SSO.

This essay is organized into six main sections: introduction, theoretical background, methodological procedures, results analysis, discussion, and final considerations. The introduction provides context for the proposed theme, research question, objectives, and expected contributions. The theoretical background explores the historical development of SSO as part of sustainable development, defines ST and its main approaches, examines the relationship between SSO and ST, proposes an SSO definition based on previous studies from an ST perspective, and summarizes how ST has been used in recent SSO research. Finally, it discusses sustainability reporting with a focus on the social pillar from a stakeholder-centric perspective.

The methodological procedures section presents a detailed description of the study's design and execution. The results analysis section presents and analyzes the research findings. The discussion section provides commentary on the meaning of the results and compares them with findings from other studies. Finally, the main findings are summarized in the final considerations section, along with the study's limitations and suggestions for future research.

1.1 RESEARCH QUESTION AND OBJECTIVES

1.1.1 Guiding question for this research

How have the social sustainability reports and indicators of a company from the Meat and Derivatives sector evolved over time, and how were they influenced and been influenced by relationships with stakeholders?

1.1.2 Objectives

1.1.2.1 General objective

To analyze the evolution of social sustainability practices within a Meat and Derivatives company and to assess the dynamic relationships between these practices and stakeholders.

1.1.2.2 Specific objectives

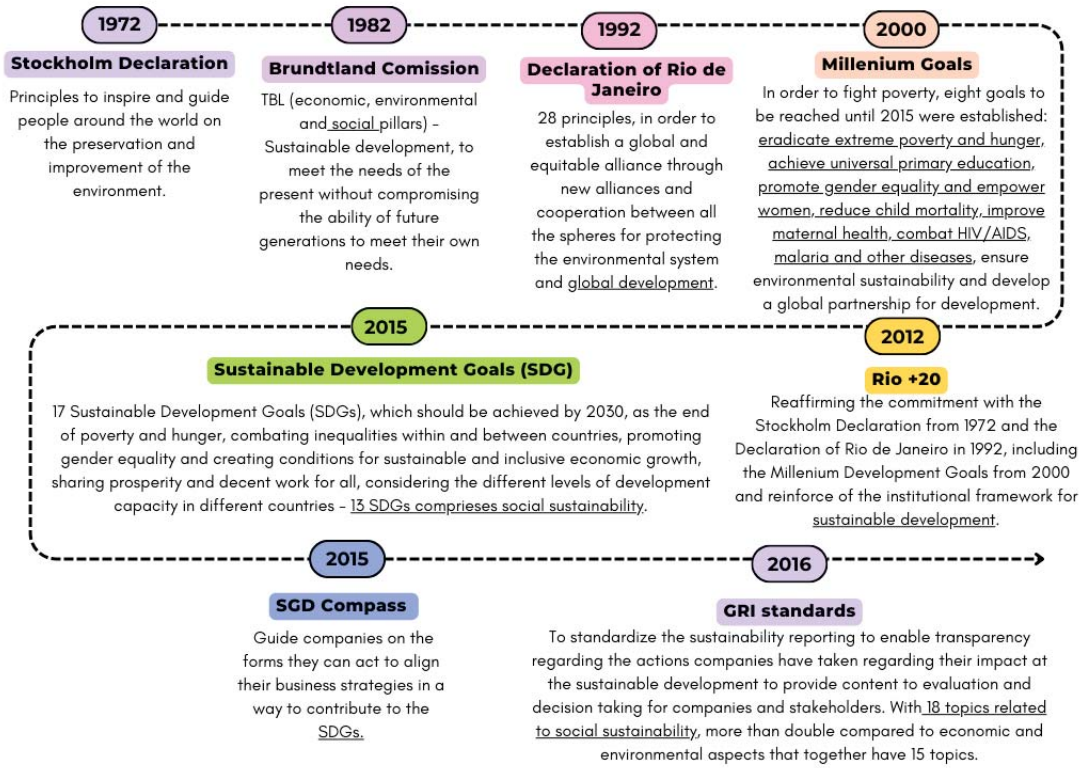
- To identify the social indicators presented in sustainability reports;
- Examine the consistency, transparency, and comprehensiveness of the GRI-based reports over the years;
- Assess whether these social sustainability indicators have changed over time, focusing on improvements or deteriorations;
- Determine which stakeholders are referenced in the sustainability reports of the company.

2 THEORETICAL BACKGROUND

2.1 SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY IN ORGANIZATIONS AS PART OF SUSTAINABLE DEVELOPMENT: HISTORY

Social sustainability is one pillar of the triple bottom line of sustainability (economic, environmental, and social) proposed by Elkington (1994) . This concept was introduced as a way to achieve sustainable development, defined as meeting the needs of the present without compromising the ability of future generations to meet their own needs (United Nations, 1987). Some of the key events that have shaped the understanding of social sustainability in organizations as part of sustainable development are summarized in Figure 1.

Figure 1: Timeline of social sustainability in organizazations.



Source: The Author, 2024.

Social sustainability is a comprehensive concept that encompasses issues related to community well-being, emancipatory democracy, citizen participation, community engagement, human services, social infrastructure, human and social capital, social

justice, community development, and equity (Cuthill, 2010).

The debate on sustainability gained increased attention due to United Nations conferences where the topic was central. In 1972, a conference on the environment resulted in the Stockholm Declaration, which emphasized the need for principles to inspire and guide people worldwide in preserving and improving the environment (United Nations, 1972).

The declaration acknowledged human beings as both a product and a shaper of the environment, capable of driving growth in various aspects. However, it also highlighted the unprecedented strain placed on the planet, negatively impacting people's well-being and economic development worldwide.

It also emphasized the urgent need for deliberate action, considering the environmental impact and the responsibility of all levels: individual, corporate, and governmental. To achieve these objectives, 26 principles were established. Three of these principles focused on social sustainability issues: Principle 1 asserted the need for freedom, equality, and adequate conditions of life for all; Principle 8 considered social development essential for a favorable living and working environment; and Principle 15 highlighted the need for planned human settlements and urbanization to maximize social benefits for everyone.

Twenty years later, the discussion once again became the subject of a new United Nations conference in Rio de Janeiro, based on the Stockholm Declaration, resulting in 28 principles to establish a global and equitable alliance through new alliances and cooperation between all spheres for protecting the environmental system and global development (United Nations, 1992).

This declaration expanded the focus on social sustainability, with seven principles relating to this concept. Principle 1 recognized that people are the central concern of sustainable development. Principle 5 asserted that eradicating poverty is indispens-

able for sustainable development. Principle 14 mandated the prevention of relocating activities that could harm human health. Principle 20 emphasized the importance of women's participation in achieving sustainable development. Principle 22 highlighted the role of Indigenous peoples and local communities in achieving sustainable development. Principle 23 addressed the protection of natural resources for people facing oppression. Finally, Principle 25 recognized peace, development, and environmental protection as interdependent and indivisible.

In 2000, to fight poverty, eight goals to be reached by 2015 were established (Millennium Development Goals), which were mostly related to social sustainability: eradicate extreme poverty and hunger; achieve universal primary education; promote gender equality and empower women; reduce child mortality; improve maternal health; combat HIV/AIDS, malaria, and other diseases; ensure environmental sustainability; and develop a global partnership for development (United Nations, 2000).

Several improvements were made, but gender inequality remained, with disadvantages for women in the labor market. Social inequality between the rich and poor persisted, environmental degradation continued with the most significant impacts on poor people, and poverty and hunger were not eradicated (United Nations, 2015).

In 2012, another conference, the United Nations Conference on Sustainable Development (Rio +20), aimed to develop solutions for sustainable development, reaffirming the commitment to the Stockholm Declaration from 1972 and the Declaration of Rio de Janeiro in 1992. It also included the Millennium Development Goals from 2000 and sought to reinforce the institutional framework for sustainable development (United Nations, 2012).

In 2015, in New York, the United Nations met again. This time, more concrete objectives were proposed in addition to principles, thus establishing 17 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) to be achieved by 2030. These goals included ending

poverty and hunger, combating inequalities within and between countries, promoting gender equality, and creating conditions for sustainable and inclusive economic growth, sharing prosperity and ensuring decent work for all, considering the different levels of development capacity in different countries (United Nations, 2015).

The SDGs are part of an agenda with 17 objectives and 169 targets to be achieved in an integrated, indivisible, and balanced way based on the economic, social, and environmental dimensions of sustainability. This agenda is considered a collective journey that requires collaboration between various actors, from governments to the private sector, recognizing that each country may face unique challenges in achieving the SDGs (United Nations, 2015).

The social dimension of sustainability is crucial to achieving the SDGs since it is impossible to reach full human potential if half of humanity lacks access to human rights and opportunities. Therefore, the social dimension focuses on ending poverty and hunger to promote human life in a dignified, equal, and healthy way (United Nations, 2015).

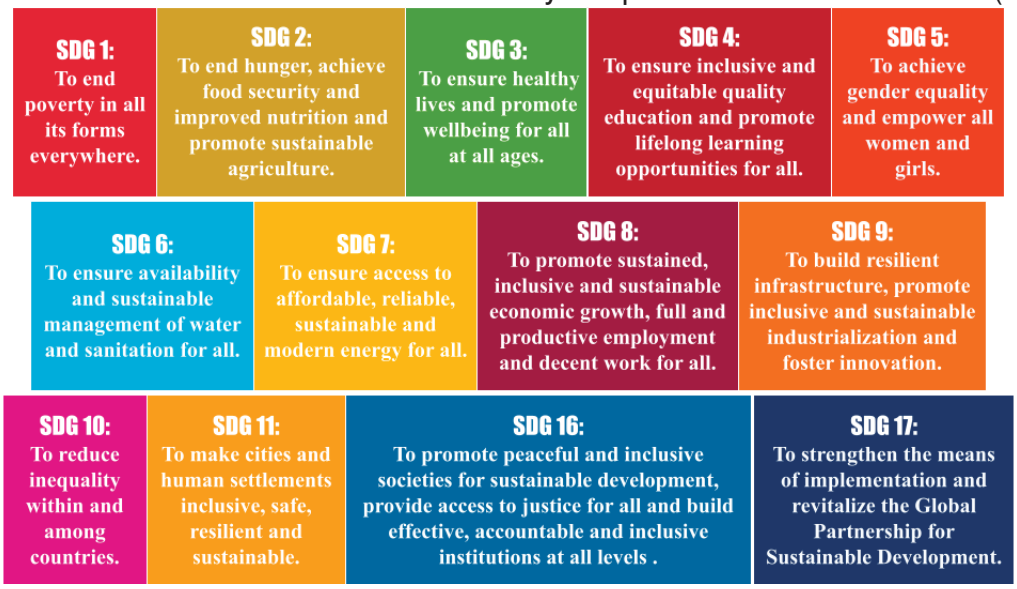
To achieve this, it is necessary to combat social inequalities, promote human rights, gender equality, and empower girls and women, so that they have access to quality education, the same job opportunities, and leadership and decision-making positions as men (United Nations, 2015).

Other critical areas include inclusive economic growth, decent work, guaranteeing the social, physical, and mental well-being of people, non-discrimination based on race, ethnicity, or culture, ending all types of exploitation against children (such as child labor), eradicating forced unemployment (especially among young people), empowering people with disabilities, those affected by HIV/AIDS, the elderly, Indigenous peoples, refugees, and internal migrants, and ensuring equitable education from childhood to higher education and vocational training. Lastly, all people must have access to life-

long learning opportunities (United Nations, 2015).

Despite the integration between the three pillars of sustainability (social, environmental, and economic), of the 17 SDGs, only four explicitly focus on the environmental aspect (12, 13, 14, and 15). The others demonstrate a clear intersection between social and economic concerns (Figure 2).

Figure 2: SDGs related to social sustainability adapted from United Nations (2015) .



Source: The Author, 2024.

The SDGs have drawn criticism for several reasons. Some goals are considered contradictory, as the current model of economic development requires natural resources, yet the SDGs advocate for reduced resource use. Additionally, the goals are seen as too broad and difficult to quantify, track, and implement effectively (Swain, 2018). Another weakness is that they are not international law, and their adoption is voluntary, meaning non-participation does not lead to sanctions (Tulder et al., 2021).

Koehler (2016) highlighted some negative aspects of the SDGs, such as the extended timeline, the lack of analysis and action to address the root causes of the current unsustainable global state, and a lack of clarity on how the goals will be achieved. The critique also points to the absence of concrete policy recommendations and suggests the agenda may be merely cosmetic, as several countries that publicly committed to

the SDGs have engaged in actions that contradict them.

Even with some negative aspects of the SDGs, inaction regarding the topics addressed in the Agenda is a threat to humanity. As poverty increases (SDG 1), health issues increase (SDG 3), and access to education (SDG 4) is diminished, birth rates increase, along with the migration of refugees. Irresponsible production and consumption (SDG 12) compromise the environment with diminished resources and excess waste, negatively impacting agriculture and increasing food insecurity (SDG 2) and inequalities (SDG 10), and so on (Cernev & Fenner, 2020).

According to the SDG monitoring report, the world is not doing what is necessary to achieve these goals. In some aspects, a setback was observed, such as increased inequalities, climate change, loss of biodiversity, and increased waste caused by human activity (United Nations, 2019).

The limited progress towards the SDGs is considered to be mainly a result of lack of commitment by large multinational companies, as they play an important role in the diffusion of large-scale SDGs, but with the lack of sanctions, stakeholder engagement is not very encouraging for actual adherence (Tulder et al., 2021).

Recognizing the important role of businesses in achieving the SDGs, GRI, the United Nations, and the World Business Council for Sustainable Development developed a guide for business action on the SDGs. Called the SDG Compass, it guides companies on how they can align their business strategies to contribute to the SDGs by following five steps: understanding the SDGs, defining priorities, setting goals, integrating, and reporting and communicating (SDG Compass, 2015).

To standardize sustainability reporting and ensure transparency about companies' actions on sustainable development, the GRI standards provide a guideline for companies to disclose their sustainability practices. This offers valuable content for evaluation and decision-making by companies and stakeholders (GRI, 2021).

Among the GRI standards that comprise the economic, environmental, and social aspects, GRI 400 is specifically related to social sustainability. It was published in 2016 and is mandatory for reports based on the GRI standards published since July 1, 2018. There are 18 topics related to social sustainability, more than double the combined 15 topics related to economic and environmental aspects (GRI, 2021).

GRI 400 encompasses employment , labor/management relations , occupational health and safety, training and education, diversity and equal opportunity, non-discrimination, freedom of association and collective bargaining, child labor, forced or compulsory labor, security practices, rights of Indigenous peoples, local communities, supplier social assessment, public policy, customer health and safety, marketing and labeling, and customer privacy (GRI, 2021).

However, despite all these initiatives to help businesses achieve their share of sustainable development, when it comes to sustainability reporting, companies can still ignore less convenient aspects and omit critical information regarding their business and operations (Sachs & Sachs, 2021).

The lack of auditing of sustainability reports also allows for significant bias in their content, which diminishes their reliability. This can be used as a tool to manipulate stakeholders' perceptions of the company without actual change (Lashitew, 2021).

Some countries, such as those in the European Union, China, and the United States, require disclosures on sustainability performance (Benameur et al., 2024). Aligned with this trend, Brazil will require publicly traded companies to disclose financial information related to sustainability, with assurance from an independent auditor, starting in 2026 (Comissão de Valores Mobiliários, 2023). Therefore, despite its limitations, sustainability reporting is facing pressure for greater transparency and reliability, which would not be possible without a starting point.

However, achieving social sustainability remains a complex challenge for businesses.

While there are critiques regarding the SDG's broad scope, difficulties in measuring them, ambiguity, and the potential manipulation in sustainability reports, they provide a crucial foundation to guide businesses' actions for a better society and planet.

2.2 STAKEHOLDER THEORY

Stakeholders are "any group or individual that can affect or is affected by the achievement of an organization's purpose" (Freeman & McVea, 1984, p. 53). They can be internal or external to the company and have different levels of influence and management attention for the company.

In the context of large organizations, stakeholders comprise owners, the financial community, activist groups, customers, customer advocate groups, unions, employees, trade associations, competitors, suppliers, government, and political groups (Freeman & McVea, 1984).

The central idea of ST is the need for companies to fulfill stakeholder needs. This theory originated around the 1960s with the claim that organizations need stakeholder support to survive (Mahajan et al., 2023). It advocates that companies' activities must be aligned with stakeholders' interests (Tjahjadi et al., 2024).

Despite over 500 different definitions of ST (Miles, 2017) it has faced criticism for lacking clarity (Fassin, 2009). Acknowledging this situation, this study adopts one definition chosen for its contemporaneity and relevance to social sustainability research.

Donaldson and Preston (1995) identified three different main approaches within ST: instrumental, descriptive, and normative. The instrumental approach links stakeholder management with corporate outcomes, while the descriptive approach explains corporate behaviors and characteristics. The normative approach examines the moral function of a company, forming the foundation of most ST literature.

In a different way, Kaler (2003, p. 74) divides ST approaches into normative and non-normative categories. The normative approach "describes and explains the phe-

nomenon of stakeholding," while the non-normative approach encompasses the instrumental and descriptive approaches. These non-normative approaches make claims about the theory by using the normative foundation of ST to explain the relationship between stakeholding phenomena and other aspects, such as corporate outcomes and behaviors.

Therefore, the normative approach appears most suitable for social sustainability studies, which primarily concern the moral dimensions of corporate behavior and are considered an end in themselves. This approach delves into companies' ethical responsibilities towards their stakeholders, providing a framework to assess social sustainability by explaining stakeholding phenomena and guiding businesses towards more socially sustainable practices.

Mahajan et al. (2023, p. 1) from a literature review, brings an updated definition of ST:

> "A theory that (i) encourages organizations to acknowledge and consider their stakeholders, which exist internally or externally to the organization, (ii) promotes understanding and managing stakeholder needs, wants, and demands, and thus (iii) represents a holistic and responsible framework that goes beyond the focus of shareholders in decision-making processes, which, in turn, (iv) enables organizations to be strategic, maximize their value creation, and safeguard their long-term success and sustainability."

This definition is predominantly normative, implying a moral obligation for companies to manage stakeholder needs responsibly. While it includes an instrumental consideration, by "maximizing their value creation", it suggests that moral considerations can benefit the company. This definition emphasizes responsibility, a holistic view, and long-term sustainability.

Fulfilling stakeholder needs could enable companies to achieve a stronger market position than those focused solely on shareholders. This broader perspective considers the company's social role in addition to its financial performance. This aligns

with Freeman and McVea (1984) , who posits that an organization's success depends on its ability to satisfy its stakeholders' needs. Therefore, ST can be a valuable tool for understanding and managing the interests of various stakeholders (Phillips et al., 2005).

To fulfill the stakeholder need, managers need to first identify them, and their respective needs. To prioritize resources and energy, Mitchell et al. (1997) proposed a stakeholder identification based on their salience (the degree of managers must prioritize competing needs from different stakeholders).

Stakeholders may have different attributes in the manager-stakeholder relationship: power, legitimacy, and urgency. Stakeholders may have one or more of those attributes, and the more cumulative attributes they have, more salient (more managers prioritize them) they are in the relationship. Based on those attributes, there are three categories of stakeholders (latent, expectant, and highly salient stakeholder), and seven subcategories (dormant, demanding, discretionary, dangerous, dependent, dominant, and definitive stakeholder) (Mitchell et al., 1997):

Stakeholders with a single attribute are categorized as "latent stakeholders", with low salience and are less likely to receive attention or even be identified by managers. This category includes "dormant stakeholders," "discretionary stakeholders," and "demanding stakeholders."

"Dormant stakeholder" possesses the power to impose on the organization, but because they lack legitimacy or urgency, their power remains unexerted. "Discretionary stakeholder" has the attribute of legitimacy, but does not have power or urgent claims. "Demanding stakeholder" has urgent claims, but no power or legitimacy.

Stakeholders with two attributes are categorized as "expectant stakeholders". They receive increased responsiveness to their interests compared to "latent stakeholders". This category includes "dominant stakeholders", "dependent stakeholders" and "dan-

gerous stakeholders."

"Dominant stakeholder" have legitimate claims and the power to impose them on the company. "Dependent stakeholder" have legitimate and urgent claimsbut lack the power to enforce them, so they rely on stakeholders that have the power to achieve their goals. "Dangerous stakeholder" have urgency and power, but lacks legitimacy, potentially leading them to take severe and illegitimate actions to achieve their goals.

Stakeholders possessing all three attributes (power, legitimacy, and urgency) are categorized as "highly salient stakeholders". The only possible combination within this category is the "definitive stakeholder". This combination requires managers to prioritize this stakeholder's claims, as the combination of a legitimate and urgent claim with the power to act upon it creates a relationship where the stakeholder may wield more influence than the managers themselves. Therefore, the stakeholders-manager relationship is important for managers to comprehend which stakeholders' claims to prioritize and to explain how managers prioritize their relationships with stakeholders (Mitchell et al., 1997).

ST underscores the vital role of stakeholders in an organization and advocates for an alignment of corporate activities with stakeholders' interests. Embracing ST can offer a holistic and responsible framework for businesses to consider within their operations.

2.3 SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY AND THE STAKEHOLDER THEORY

In recent years, studies on social sustainability in organizations (SSO) have employed various theoretical lenses, with ST being the most prevalent (see Appendix A).

2.3.1 Defining social sustainability in organizations

An analysis of the most frequent words and main ideas from 14 definitions of social sustainability in organizations (SSO) that employed a ST lens (see Appendix B)

revealed two key themes: human well-being and commitment to stakeholders (Figure 3).

Figure 3: Word Cloud created based on social sustainability in organizations definitions



Source: The Author, 2024.

The definition provided by Wang et al. (2022) focuses on SSO as the achievement of human well-being. Similarly, several definitions referenced by Goel, Ganesh, and Kaur (2020) , such as Hill and Bowen (1997), Valdes-Vasquez & Klotz (2013), Gatti et al. (2013), and Abdel-Raheem & Ramsbottom (2016), emphasize aspects that contribute to well-being, such as the protection and promotion of health, a safe work environment, training for disadvantaged people, and equity.

Guzmán-Pérez et al. (2023) utilized the definition from Labuschagne et al. (2005), which concentrates on the impact of businesses on their stakeholders. Shaw et al. (2023) takes a similar approach, emphasizing stakeholder well-being achieved through organizational policies and practices.

Di Maddaloni and Sabini (2022) highlights the importance of identifying and managing the positive and negative effects of companies on their stakeholders, as well as the necessity of stakeholder engagement in this process. This approach aligns with those presented by Surbeck & Hilger (2014, cited in Goel, Ganesh, and Kaur, 2020a)

and Toussaint et al. (2021) .

Sroufe and Gopalakrishna-Remani (2019, cited in Mondal et al., 2024) and Basiago (1999, cited in Sarrah et al., 2020) posit that SSO focuses on the need for businesses to contribute to society through their internal practices, extending beyond their direct operations. Additionally, Makov and Newman (2016, cited in Afum et al., 2022) define SSO as characterized by company practices that benefit both the company itself and society.

These diverse perspectives on SSO share a central idea: SSO refers to the practices of promoting and managing the impact of organizational activities on all affected groups and individuals, aiming to maximize positive outcomes and mitigate any negative impacts.

2.3.2 Stakeholder Theory Relationship with Social Sustainability in Organization studies

ST has emerged as a valuable lens for SSO research. Across different sectors, ST helps researchers understand the influence, consequences, concerns, and perspectives of various stakeholders regarding business practices (Cassell & Symon, 2004). By aligning stakeholder expectations with organizational practices, ST contributes to a more cohesive approach to SSO.

For instance, in the civil aviation sector, ST helped identify stakeholders' main concerns regarding SSO, suggesting that social sustainability indicators are the most relevant among other sustainability aspects (environmental and economic) (Sarrah et al., 2020). Similarly, in the healthcare sector, ST enabled the proposal of an analytical framework to analyze social sustainability from the stakeholder perspective in project management (Wang et al., 2022).

In construction projects, the ST has been instrumental in understanding the role of local communities in helping companies develop better responses to sustainability

challenges (Di Maddaloni & Sabini, 2022). Furthermore, it has facilitated the integration of social sustainability for the benefit of a larger group of stakeholders through the stakeholder salience perspective (Goel, Ganesh, & Kaur, 2020b).

ST has also been applied in supply chain management studies to identify barriers to social sustainability. These studies emphasize the role of internal and external stakeholders as significant barriers (Shaw et al., 2023). In addressing social disruptions caused by events like the COVID-19 pandemic, ST has guided strategies to mitigate social issues within the supply chain.

Similarly, to propose a general framework for excellent social practices along the food supply chain, Toussaint et al. (2021) conducted research underpinned by ST to incorporate diverse perspectives in achieving this goal. Additionally, Tran et al. (2023) applied ST to explore the impact of internationalization readiness on social sustainability practices across the supply chain at handicraft companies.

In exploring how inbound and outbound green logistic practices mediate the relationships between eco-market orientation, social sustainability, and green value competitiveness Afum et al. (2022) grounded their research on ST along with other theories.

Moreover, ST was also helpful in demonstrating the social sustainability metrics that guide hotel managers' decision-making at a hotel and those that are the most valued by stakeholders, potentially guiding managers to improve social sustainability efforts (Guzmán-Pérez et al., 2023). It has also facilitated investigations into different stakeholders' activities towards digital transformation, social sustainability, and sustainable consumption and production (Mondal et al., 2024).

In the context of corporate governance, ST has illuminated the positive relationship between women on boards of directors and social sustainability reporting (Adamu & Tyasari, 2022). Furthermore, it has been used to explain the relationship between

board role performance and sustainability reporting practices (Tumwebaze et al., 2022).

Overall, ST serves as a versatile theoretical lens for understanding and enhancing SSO across diverse organizational aspects, providing a holistic framework that considers the interests and perspectives of multiple stakeholders.

2.4 SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING: FROM STAKEHOLDERS FOR STAKEHOLDERS

Sustainability reporting standards were developed to foster transparency regarding companies' sustainability actions, enabling more effective communication for stakeholder decision-making (GRI, 2021). Sustainability reports serve as a communication tool for companies to articulate their sustainability-related practices, policies, and standards, making it crucial to understand what is communicated and implemented regarding social sustainability.

Sustainability reporting provides information for stakeholders to make informed decisions (Jayarathna et al., 2022). High-quality sustainability reports enhance businesses' reputations (Odriozola & Baraibar-Diez, 2017) as societal demand for sustainable corporate practices increases (Vila & Moya, 2023). In response, several standards have emerged to guide sustainability reporting, including its social aspects, such as the Sustainability Accounting Standards Board (SASB), International Sustainability Standards Board (ISSB), and Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) standards.

While SASB and ISSB focus on shareholders, GRI aims to provide guidance for reporting sustainability practices to a broader range of stakeholders. SASB standards focus on sustainability-related threats and opportunities that could influence a company's financial performance, with specific topics tailored to each industry (IFRS Foundation, n.d.). This information is particularly useful for investors. ISSB takes a similar approach, focusing on the needs of the financial market (IFRS Foundation, n.d.). Therefore, financial dynamics primarily drive their adoption.

In contrast, the GRI standards aim to provide guidance and information not only for shareholders but for all interested stakeholders. This standardized approach to sustainability reporting promotes transparency regarding companies' actions and their impact on sustainable development, offering valuable content for evaluation and decision-making by both companies and stakeholders. The GRI standards provide a structured framework for companies to report their sustainability practices (GRI, 2021).

These standards were developed through a consultative process involving diverse stakeholders, recognizing their crucial role in helping organizations identify their most significant impacts. This process considered intergovernmental instruments and organizational expectations regarding sustainability (GRI, 2021).

The GRI standards comprise an interconnected system of norms: Universal Standards, which apply to all organizations; Sector Standards, which apply to specific organizational sectors; and Topic Standards, which address specific material topics. These material topics represent the companies' most significant impacts on the economy, people, and the environment.

GRI's Topic Standards consist of 32 topic-specific standards, 17 of which relate to social sustainability and are situated within the GRI 400 series. These encompass employment, labor/management relations, occupational health and safety, training and education, diversity and equal opportunity, non-discrimination, freedom of association and collective bargaining, child labor, forced or compulsory labor, security practices, rights of Indigenous peoples, local communities, supplier social assessment, public policy, customer health and safety, marketing and labeling, and customer privacy (Sida, n.d.).

Each GRI 400 standard has specific requirements, summarized in Appendix C. Each standard is also linked to a primary stakeholder group, as illustrated in Figure 4.

GRI is considered the most relevant sustainability standard by its high adoption

Figure 4: Main stakeholders related with GRI 400 (Social sustainability topics).



Source: The Author, 2024.

worldwide. However, it also faces criticism for limiting the scope of sustainability in business reporting (Journeault et al., 2021). Some even question whether it provides information about actual sustainability performance or merely serves as a tool for companies to influence stakeholder perception without real action (Papoutsi & Sodhi, 2020).

Moreover, sustainability reporting presents its own challenges. A lack of clarity regarding indicators can lead to difficulties in developing reports. Additionally, the current framework may be less accessible to smaller companies. Finally, the lack of external auditing raises concerns about the reliability of the reports (Quilice et al., 2018).

On the other hand, sustainability reporting can help companies to initiate their sustainability programs, with consequent enhancements. Petrescu et al. (2020) found

that 96,5% of the managers from companies that release sustainability reports consider them foundational for their sustainability initiatives.

Consequently, sustainability reporting can lead to several improvements, such as enhanced long-term vision, innovative solutions, and a reduction of labor risks and environmental impacts. These managers also view sustainability reporting as an important bridge between the company and customers, fostering long-term loyalty.

For example, Brazilian companies benefit from sustainability reporting by improving internal management. The guidelines proposed for report elaboration provide benchmarking assistance, the opportunity to legitimize sustainability within their operations, and marketing potential (Quilice et al., 2018).

Despite their limitations, publicly released sustainability reports offer opportunities for document analysis. This enables the tracking of changes and developments without requiring permission from the companies (Bowen, 2009). Therefore, sustainability reporting is an important tool to help companies improve their sustainability practices. Even with some challenges and limitations, the potential benefits for both companies and society must be considered.

3 METHODOLOGICAL PROCEDURES

This chapter outlines the methodological procedures employed in this research, encompassing the research classification, data collection methods, analysis techniques, and company selection.

3.1 CLASSIFICATION OF THE RESEARCH

This research adopted an exploratory and descriptive approach. Exploratory research aims to enhance familiarity with the research problem, while descriptive research describes the characteristics of the studied object (Gil, 2002).

The exploratory aspect aims to enhance familiarity with the development of social sustainability practices within a Meat and Derivatives company. The descriptive aspect focuses on detailing the characteristics of these practices and their interactions with key stakeholders, providing a comprehensive understanding of how these relationships have developed over time.

This research employs a mixed-method design, combining qualitative and quantitative methods within a single study (Creswell & Creswell, 2021). This approach provides diverse perspectives to better address research questions that would be unanswerable through a single approach (Morse, 2003).

Mixed-methods research is defined by Johnson et al. (2007, p. 123) as:

> ”The type of research in which a researcher or team of researchers combines elements of qualitative and quantitative research approaches (e.g., use of qualitative and quantitative viewpoints, data collection, analysis, inference techniques) for the broad purposes of breadth and depth of understanding and corroboration.”

Morse (2003) offers a similar definition, considering mixed-methods research as the incorporation of qualitative and quantitative strategies, where a core method is supplemented by another method for a more comprehensive view of the studied situation.

This study is classified as a qualitative-dominant mixed-method, relying primarily on a qualitative perspective with the addition of quantitative data and approaches (Johnson et al., 2007).

Table 1 summarizes the justification for the chosen methods used to address the guiding question of this research, along with its general and specific objectives.

Table 1: Research question, objectives and methods alignment matrix

Research question: How have the social sustainability reports and indicators of a company from the Meat and Derivatives sector evolved over time, and how were they influenced and been influenced by relationships with stakeholders?	
General Objective: To analyze the evolution of social sustainability practices within a Meat and Derivatives company and to assess the dynamic relationships between these practices and stakeholders.	
Specific Objectives	**Method**
To identify the social indicators presented in sustainability reports Examine the consistency, transparency, and comprehensiveness of the GRI-based reports over the years.	5-point scale, in which 1 represents that the disclosure was not reported, 3 represents that it was partially reported, and 5 as fully reported based on Chen et al. (2015) procedure to perform a longitudinal analysis on the social sustainability indicators.
Assess whether these social sustainability indicators have changed over time, focusing on improvements or deteriorations.	Thematic analysis of the sustainability reports – qualitative data. Descriptive statistics – quantitative data.
Determine which stakeholders are referenced in the sustainability reports of the company.	Identify and classify the stakeholders mentioned in the reports through a thematic analysis of the sustainability reports. Stakeholders were classified as “impacted by the organization” and “causes impacts in the organization” based on the company’s claim about them in their sustainability reports to each corresponding GRI norm. Afterwards, the number of appearances of each stakeholder in each category was counted.

Source: The Author, 2024

3.2 DATA COLLECTION

This research relied on secondary data through documentary research, utilizing the selected company’s sustainability reports. Documents consist of written materials not produced at the researcher’s request, but serve as a rich and stable source of information, particularly when access to primary personnel is not feasible (Guba & Lincoln, 1981).

To ensure data quality, Scott's criteria for quality control were applied. According to Scott (2014) , four quality control criteria are essential when handling documentary sources: authenticity, credibility, representativeness, and meaning. Authenticity relates to the trustworthiness of the document's source; credibility refers to whether the document is free from distortion; representativeness concerns whether the documents used are representative of the relevant documents; and meaning pertains to the comprehensibility of the documents.

Sustainability reports, publicly available on company websites, offer credible and authentic sources for analyzing social sustainability practices, as they are officially issued by the organizations themselves. Given this research aims to examine the evolution of these practices, these reports are both relevant and representative, offering direct insights into company commitments and changes over time. Furthermore, adherence to the Global Reporting Initiative (GRI) standards ensures these reports meet high standards of transparency and comprehensibility, making them reliable and accessible for assessing corporate social sustainability progress.

The sustainability reports were collected online from the company's website between June and August 2024. The reports were coded with the company's fictitious name and the respective sustainability report year: MeatCo, 2018; MeatCo, 2019; MeatCo, 2020; MeatCo, 2021; MeatCo, 2022; MeatCo, 2023.

Data collection was then based on the identification of GRI social indicators (GRI 400: Disclosures 401-419), excluding 412 and 419, which were removed from GRI 400. GRI 403 was revised in 2018, with mandatory adherence from 2021. However, as the company adopted this standard earlier, both versions were considered. The analysis timeframe spanned from 2018 onwards, as the norms released in 2016 only mandated adherence to the new norms from 2018.

Documentary research necessitates the interpretation and synthesis of information

from the documents to provide a coherent understanding (Sá-Silva et al., 2009). The synthesis of the documents involved organizing the findings in a spreadsheet, separated by year, based on the information from the sustainability reports, as exemplified in Tables 2 and 3 (in section 3.3). When information was unavailable in its respective publication year but available in other years, it was utilized.

3.3 DATA ANALYSIS

The documents were analyzed in two ways to achieve the research objectives. To address the specific objectives of identifying social indicators presented in sustainability reports and examining the consistency, transparency, and comprehensiveness of the GRI-based reports over time, the approach outlined by Chen et al. (2015) was followed. This procedure utilizes a 5-point scale, where 1 indicates non-reporting of the disclosure, 3 represents partial reporting, and 5 signifies full reporting.

Afterwards, a longitudinal analysis of Chen et al. (2015) was conducted, and each GRI topic was evaluated as: ”no change,” ”oscillated,” ”improved,” and ”declined.” ”No change” was applied to topics for which the score remained the same throughout the years. ”Oscillated” was applied to topics for which the score oscillated throughout the years. ”Improved” was applied to topics for which the score changed from a lower to a higher score throughout the years. ”Declined” was applied to topics for which the score changed from a higher to a lower score throughout the years.

To analyze the themes, a systematic examination of each GRI norm requirement was conducted. This involved reviewing the company’s sustainability reports annually, noting relevant responses and their corresponding page references for each requirement. This approach enabled a structured, year-by-year comparison across all requirements. Examples of this systematic examination for qualitative and quantitative data are presented in Table 2 and Table 3, respectively.

To assess the evolution of the company’s social sustainability indicators, focusing

Table 2: Example of systematic examination of qualitative data

GRI 415-1 requirement	**2018**	**2019**	**2020**	**2021**	**2022**	**2023**
Total monetary value of financial and in-kind political contributions made directly and indirectly by the organization by country and recipient/beneficiary.	No information	"*[MeatCo] makes no political contributions, in accordance with applicable Brazilian laws and regulations (Federal Act 13.165/2015)*" (p.114)	"*In accordance with the Brazilian Electoral Law (Federal Law No. 13,165/2015), [MeatCo] does not support or authorize donations to candidates, political parties, or any political association.*" (p.174)	"*In the domestic and international spheres, no donations were made to election candidates, political parties or any political body whatsoever in 2021. Furthermore, in observance of the restrictions established by the Brazilian Electoral law (Federal Law nr. 13,165/2015), [MeatCo] assumes no party-political position and does not support or authorize donations to any election candidates, political parties or any political bodies.*" (p.25)	"*[MeatCo] stores the legislation of the countries in which it operates in accordance with the Company's Transparency Manual. In neither the domestic or international spheres were any donations made to election candidates, political parties or any political body whatsoever. Furthermore, in line with that set forth in Law n° 13,165/2015 (the Electoral Code), [MeatCo] does not support or authorize donations to any election candidates, political parties or any political bodies.*" (p.131)	"*We do not endorse or authorize donations to candidates, political parties, or any political associations. We comply with Brazilian legislation and the laws of the countries where we operate, in accordance with our Transparency Manual. We also have a Corporate Standard on 'Guidelines for Electoral Conduct'.*" (p.150)

Source: The Author, 2024

Table 3: Example of systematic examination of quantitative data

GRI 401-1 requirement	Categories		Subgroups	2018	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
GRI 401-1 Total number and Rate of new employee hires during the reporting period, by age group, gender and region.	Gender	Number of new hires	men	14917	12600	14801	13736	12634	15627
			women	9220	8093	13055	11867	11247	12710
		Rate of new hires (%)	men	13.84	13.3	24	24	23	31.41
			women	8.55	8.54	31	29	27	34.4
	Age group	Number of new hires	under 30 years old	17977	14928	18942	16221	14384	18805
			30-50 years old	6045	5589	8695	9062	9017	11825
			over 50 years old	115	179	219	320	480	971
		Rate of new hires (%)	under 30 years old	16.68	15.75	52	49	48	64.34
			30-50 years old	5.61	5.9	15	16	16	21.8
			over 50 years old	0.11	0.19	2	3	5	73.59
	Region	Number of new hires	Asia	2804	3	2	2	9	16
			Africa	5	3	21	13	4	2
			Europe	134	36	7	5	8	3
			Latam (except Brazil)	438	19	8	13	9	13
			Brazil	19709	19552	26544	24149	22456	29987
			Mena (including Turkey)	1047	783	1274	1421	1395	1714
		Rate of new hires (%)	Asia	2.6	0.32	20	25	44	44.44
			Africa	0	0	35	21	29	22.22
			Europe	0.12	0.04	4	14	22	10.34
			Latam (except Brazil)	0.41	0.02	17	26	21	22.92
			Brazil	18.29	20.63	28	28	25	31.39
			Mena (including Turkey)	0.97	0.83	18	20	20	25.82

Source: The Author, 2024

on improvements or deteriorations, the collected data encompassed both quantitative and qualitative information due to the nature of sustainability reports, which require numerical data for some disclosures and textual descriptions for others. For example, GRI 401-1 (GRI, 2016a) requires information on the total number of hires and turnover rates of new hires during the reporting period, categorized by age, gender, and region. GRI 403-3 (GRI, 2016c) requires a description of work health services functions that contribute to the identification, elimination, and mitigation of risks, and how the organization guarantees the quality and accessibility of these services for employees. Consequently, quantitative data was analyzed using descriptive statistics, while qualitative data was analyzed through content analysis.

To determine which stakeholders are referenced in the company's sustainability reports, stakeholders mentioned in the reports were identified and classified through content analysis. Stakeholders were classified as "impacted by the organization" or "causes impacts in the organization" based on the company's own claims in its sustainability reports for each corresponding GRI norm. Subsequently, the number of appearances of each stakeholder in each category was counted to identify their respective weights.

Thematic analysis, a method for identifying, analyzing, and reporting patterns within data by organizing and describing it in detail (Braun & Clarke, 2006), was employed. This study followed the steps for thematic analysis suggested by Nowell et al. (2017) which are: familiarizing with the data, generating initial codes, searching for themes, reviewing the themes, defining and naming them, and developing the report. These steps are iterative and reflexive, meaning the process is not linear and may involve moving back and forth between phases.

Familiarization with the data involved reviewing the reports on social sustainability. Initial codes were based on the GRI 400 disclosures and their respective related

stakeholders (Appendix C). GRI's thematic norms related to social sustainability are located in GRI 400, encompassing employment, labor/management relations, occupational health and safety, training and education, diversity and equal opportunity, non-discrimination, freedom of association and collective bargaining, child labor, forced or compulsory labor, security practices, rights of Indigenous people, local communities, supplier social assessment, public policy, customer health and safety, marketing and labeling, and customer privacy (Sida, n.d.).

Each GRI thematic norm has specific requirements that companies must comply with to claim adherence to GRI standards. This framework allowed for an assessment of whether social sustainability indicators have changed over time, focusing on improvements or deteriorations.

To analyze the themes, a systematic examination of each GRI norm requirement was conducted. This involved reviewing the company's sustainability reports annually, noting relevant responses and their corresponding page references for each requirement. This approach enabled a structured, year-by-year comparison across all requirements. Examples of this systematic examination for qualitative and quantitative data are presented in Table 2 and Table 3, respectively.

To analyze GRI 401-1 and understand the differences in hiring practices between men and women, the data was converted into a men/women ratio of new hires using the formula 1:

$$\text{man/woman ratio of new hires} = \frac{\text{number of men hired}}{\text{number of women hired}} \tag{1}$$

To analyze stakeholder references in the company's sustainability reports, each GRI disclosure was reviewed to identify and classify mentioned stakeholders. Stakeholders were categorized based on whether they were impacted by the organization or had an impact on the organization. This classification provides insights into the nature of each

stakeholder's relationship with the company, with justifications drawn directly from the report text and including relevant page references for context, as exemplified in Table 4.

To assess changes in the company's social sustainability indicators over time, with a focus on improvements or deteriorations, data from each reporting period was systematically compared, highlighting trends and shifts in performance, as exemplified in Table 5.

Each GRI topic and its requirements were analyzed longitudinally and classified as ”improvement,” ”no change,” ”decline,” or ”variation,” accompanied by justifications explaining the observed trend. Improvement was applied when the topic presented increased performance through the years. No change was applied when the topic presented no change in performance through the years. Decline was applied when the topic presented decreased performance through the years. Variation was applied when the topic presented both increased and decreased performance through the years.

Firstly, each GRI requirement within a topic was classified. Afterward, the most frequent classification within a topic was highlighted. When more than one classification appeared the same number of times with the highest appearances, all were highlighted.

Additionally, stakeholders were identified for each GRI standard, categorized based on whether the organization impacted them or they impacted the organization. The number of mentions of each stakeholder in the reports was counted, and a graphic was created to provide insights into stakeholder relationships and social sustainability indicators.

3.4 COMPANY SELECTION

The study focused on the Brazilian Meat and Derivatives sector due to its socio-economic significance in Brazil, highlighted by both domestic consumption and export

Table 4: Stakeholder classification from MeatCo's GRI disclosures.

Disclosure	Stakeholder category	Year	Impacted by the organization or causes impact on the organization	Justificative
406-1	Employees	2023	Impacted by the organization	"...we rely on a specialized company and a process that allows the whistleblower (employees or individuals external to BRF) to contact us via telephone, email, or website, ensuring anonymity if desired by the whistleblower." "In 2023, we recorded 916 closed investigation cases, with approximately 30% of cases being deemed valid, resulting in remedial action and potentially sanctions against employees." (p.33) Employees are impacted by the organization through the investigative processes, which could result in sanctions or remediation if misconduct is found.
406-1	Employees	2023	causes impact in the organization	"...we rely on a specialized company and a process that allows the whistleblower (employees or individuals external to BRF) to contact us via telephone, email, or website, ensuring anonymity if desired by the whistleblower." "In 2023, we recorded 916 closed investigation cases, with approximately 30% of cases being deemed valid, resulting in remedial action and potentially sanctions against employees." (p.33) - Employees causes impact the organization through their complaints
406-1	Society	2023	causes impact in the organization	"...we rely on a specialized company and a process that allows the whistleblower (employees or individuals external to BRF) to contact us via telephone, email, or website, ensuring anonymity if desired by the whistleblower." - External individuals are impacted by the organization because they are provided with a channel to report issues of ethics and integrity, potentially affecting how they interact with the organization.
406-1	strategic partners	2023	causes impact in the organization	"...we rely on a specialized company and a process that allows the whistleblower (employees or individuals external to BRF) to contact us via telephone, email, or website, ensuring anonymity if desired by the whistleblower." - This entity provides essential services to the transparency channels, facilitating the reporting process for stakeholders by enabling anonymous complaints and ensuring the effectiveness and accessibility of the ethics and integrity channel. Their role impacts the organization by supporting its compliance and transparency goals, enhancing stakeholder trust, and upholding reporting
406-1	Management	2023	causes impact in the organization	"The Compliance Board is responsible for investigating reports received through BRF's Transparency Channel, and decisions are based on a process that ensures anonymity and non-retaliation for reports made responsibly, as well as thorough investigation and decision-making consistent with the evidence and severity of the misconduct identified. In cases involving senior management or the Compliance department, the analysis of the cases is conducted by the Audit and Integrity Committee or by the Board of Directors, depending on each situation.". "In 2023, we recorded 916 closed investigation cases, with approximately 30% of cases being deemed valid, resulting in remedial action and potentially sanctions against employees." (p.33)high management positions are part of decision-making processes and the handling of the investigation.

Source: The Author, 2024

Table 5: Trend over time of GRI 404 disclosures from MeatCo.

GRI norm	GRI requirement	Classification (improvement, no change, decline, variation, mixed, NA)	Justification
404-1 Average hours of training per year per employee	Average hours of capacitation carried out by the employees of the organization during the period of the report, separated by gender and functional category.	Mixed	There was an increase on average hours of capacitation. Regarding to gender, men receive more training than women. This discrepancy oscillates among years, with its lowest discrepancy in 2022 and highest in 2018, 2020 and 2023. Regarding functional category, supervisors and coordinators receive more training, followed by operational and sales, interns and trainees, managers and administrative, lastly, the board of directors.
404-2 Programs for upgrading employee skills and transition assistance programs	Type and scope of implemented programs and assistance for enhancement of competencies of employees and programs of assistance for career transition to facilitate continued employability and of management of the end of career due to retirement or termination of work contract.	Mixed	MeatCo's training and development programs showed improvements from 2018 to 2022, with the creation of the MeatCo Academy, expanded online and on-site training, and increased grants for education. The company introduced new programs, including virtual training during the pandemic and specialized academies for leadership, health and safety, and production chains. However, by 2023, some programs were no longer mentioned, indicating a decline in this area. Despite this, the addition of the "Jornada da Aprendizagem" in 2023 maintained a focus on internal development, though overall some deterioration was noted in specific programs.
404-3 Percentage of employees receiving regular performance and career development reviews	Percentage of employees by gender and functional category that received regular performance and development on the career evaluation during the reporting period.	Improvement	The percentage of employees that received regular performance and development on the career evaluation increased through the years, while in general the disparity among genders decreased, except for 2020 and 2021 which the higher disparities were found. Lower hierarchical functional categories presented the lowest percentages of performance and development evaluation.

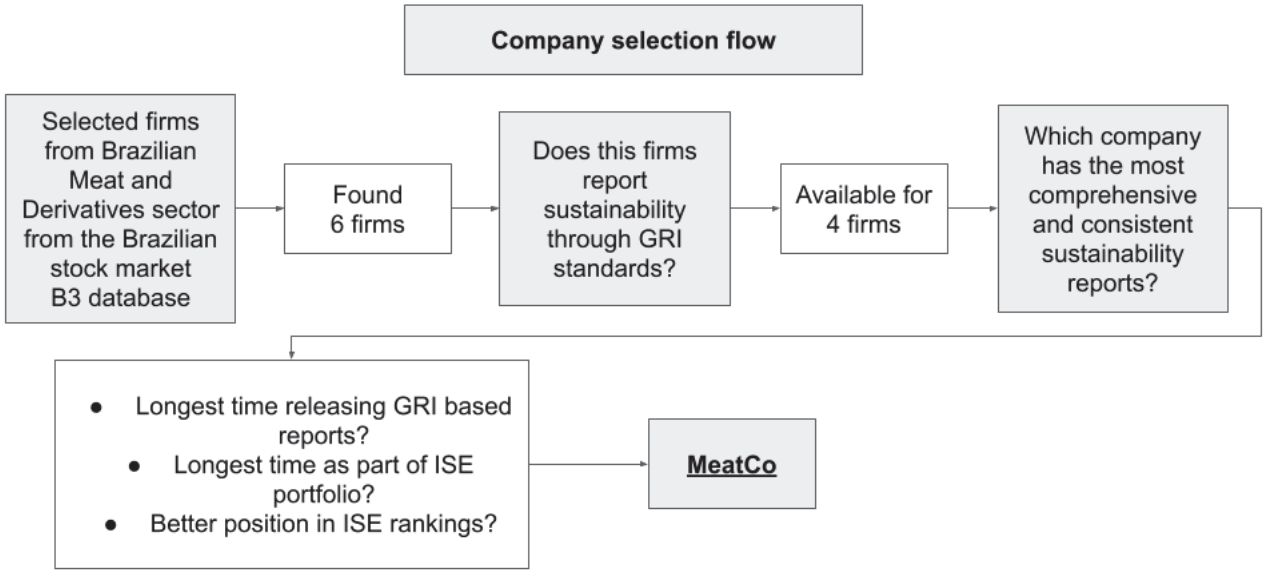
Source: The Author, 2024

activities, as well as its strong competitiveness in the international market (Xavier et al., 2020). However, certain practices within the sector raise concerns about its social sustainability performance.

The list of companies in the Brazilian Meat and Derivatives sector was retrieved from the B3 website, resulting in six companies. Of these, only four had published sustainability reports based on GRI standards since 2018.

To select the company with the most comprehensive and consistent sustainability reports, three characteristics were considered: the company's experience in releasing GRI-based reports, its duration as part of the ISE portfolio (Corporate Sustainability Index), and its position in the ISE rankings. Figure 5 presents a flow diagram illustrating the company selection process.

Figure 5: Company selection flow



Source: The Author, 2024.

MeatCo was the first company in the Meat and Derivatives sector to release sustainability reports according to GRI standards, starting in 2008. It was also the first company from the sector to be included in the Corporate Sustainability Index (Índice

de Sustentabilidade Empresarial - ISE), from its sixth edition in 2011 until its 12th edition in 2017 (B3, 2024a). Although absent from the ISE portfolio in 2018 and 2019, MeatCo returned for the 15th edition in 2020 and has remained in the portfolio through ISE 2024 (B3, 2024a).

Created in 2005 by the Brazilian Stock Exchange, the ISE aims to identify companies committed to sustainability by highlighting those that incorporate social and environmental risk management into their operations (de Neto et al., 2020). In 2021, ISE launched its first ranking, where MeatCo placed 27th with 72.79 points (B3, 2024b). In 2022, it ranked 32nd with 76.19 points, and in 2023, it held the 42nd position with 77.00 points (B3, 2024b). Within the Meats and Derivatives sector, MeatCo ranked first in 2021 and 2023, and second out of three companies in 2022 (B3, 2024b). The ISE ranking is based on a comprehensive assessment of companies' qualitative and quantitative performance, reflecting their commitment to sustainability (B3, 2024c).

4 RESULTS

4.1 ABOUT THE COMPANY

MeatCo was the first company in the Meat and Derivatives sector to enter the ISE portfolio, from its sixth edition in 2011 until its 12th edition in 2017 (B3, 2024a). During 2018 and 2019, the company was not in the ISE portfolio, but it returned for the 15th edition in 2020 and has remained until the last edition, in ISE 2024 (B3, 2024a).

The years in which the company was not in the ISE portfolio are the same as those following an operation in which the company was targeted for adulterating meat, beginning in 2017. The adulteration process consisted of changing the expiration date on the packaging and using chemical products, supposedly carcinogenic, to sell rotten meat. This scheme benefited companies and auditors from the Ministry of Agriculture who released the rotten meat for sale (Linear Comunicação, 2017)

In 2021, ISE launched its first ranking, in which MeatCo was in 27th position with 72.79 points (B3, 2024b). In 2022, it was in 32nd position with 76.19 points, and in 2023, it was in 42nd position with 77 points (B3, 2024b). In the Meats and Derivatives sector, the company was in first position in this ranking in 2021 and 2023. In 2022, it was in second position out of three (B3, 2024b). Besides that, MeatCo was also a pioneer in the sector in releasing sustainability reports according to GRI since 2008.

MeatCo is a company operating in Brazil and 127 other countries as of 2023, with its administrative headquarters in Brazil [MeatCo,2023]. It has 44 factory plants, most of them in Brazil (38), one in Paraguay, three in Turkey, and two in the Middle East. The company has more than 103 distribution centers around the world, 9.5 thousand producers, 30 thousand suppliers, and over 96 thousand employees [MeatCo,2023].

The company has 11 brands, one of which is the most valuable food company in Brazil, the fifth most chosen in the United Arab Emirates, and the seventh most chosen in Latin America [MeatCo,2023].

Their business model is based on transforming inputs into food products through channels and an omnichannel perspective, with the delivery of finished goods on a global scale [MeatCo,2023]. Their espoused commitments are safety, quality, and integrity, with the purpose of offering high-quality food that is increasingly palatable and practical to people worldwide, based on the premises of simplicity, agility, and efficiency [MeatCo,2023].

The company's share of exports from Brazil increased from 26% to 30% for chicken and from 16% to 21% for pork in 2023. It is the main exporter of chicken and pork to some Asian countries [MeatCo,2023].

The company's administration council comprises 10 members: seven men and three women [MeatCo,2023]. Their role is to develop general guidelines for the business, select the CEO and executive board, evaluate and monitor the execution of strategic planning, and determine and oversee the implementation of the sustainability strategy [MeatCo,2023]. The administration council is also responsible for protecting shareholder interests and engaging with the interests of workers, suppliers, clients, creditors, and the community [MeatCo,2023].

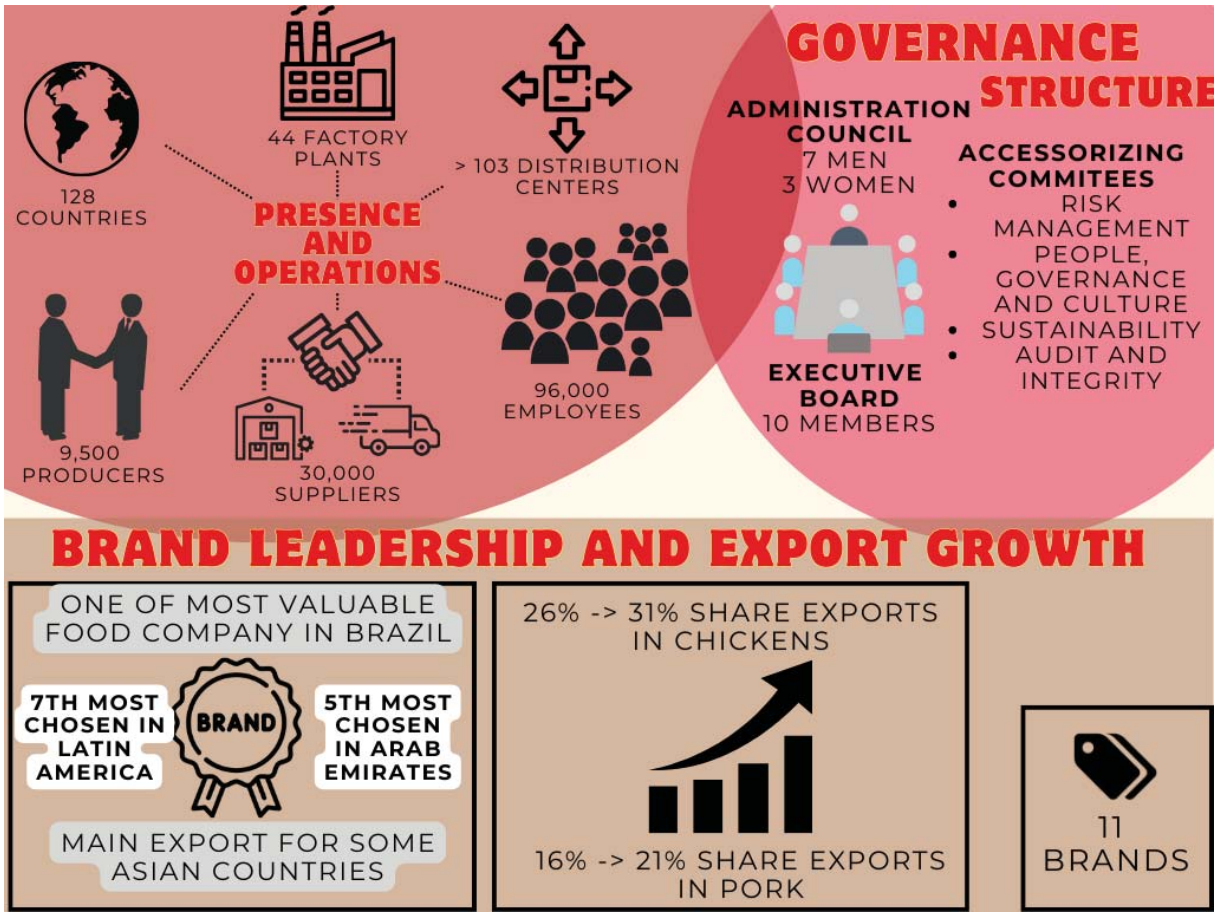
The administration council's role in meeting the interests of various stakeholders beyond shareholders demonstrates that the company has a governance vision aligned with ST. This approach considers multiple players as important for the longevity and success of the company, as endorsed by Mahajan et al. (2023, p. 1) :

> "[ST] represents a holistic and responsible framework that goes beyond the focus of shareholders in decision-making processes, which, in turn, (iv) enables organizations to be strategic, maximize their value creation, and safeguard their long-term success and sustainability".

The company's executive board is composed of 10 members [MeatCo,2023]. They are responsible for fulfilling strategic business guidelines defined by the administration council by direct leadership in their specialty areas [MeatCo,2023]. Their fiscal coun-

cil is composed of six elected members which role is to inspect the high administration based on legal requirements, social statute and internal regiment [MeatCo,2023]. The company also has four committees to accessorize the Administration Council. The active committees in 2023 were: Finance and Risk Management; People, Governance and Culture; Sustainability; Audit and Integrity [MeatCo,2023]. An overview of MeatCo's international presence, governance and brand leadership is provided in Figure 6.

Figure 6: MeatCo Global Operations, Brand Leadership and Governance structure (2023)



Source: The Author, 2024.

4.2 EVALUATION OF CONSISTENCY IN SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY REPORTING

Analysis of MeatCo's sustainability reporting from 2018 to 2023 reveals a trend of improvement in disclosure across social sustainability indicators. The total complete-

ness score increased from 40 in 2018 to 50 in 2023 (Table 6), indicating a growing commitment to transparency and alignment with GRI requirements.

Table 6: Level of Completeness in Sustainability Reporting of GRI-Based Social Sustainability Indicators (2018-2023) at MeatCo.

GRI topics	**2018**	**2019**	**2020**	**2021**	**2022**	**2023**	**Evaluation**
GRI 401: Employment	3	3	3	3	3	3	=
GRI 403: Occupational Health and Safety	3	3	3	3	3	3	=
GRI 404: Training and Education	3	3	3	3	3	3	=
GRI 405: Diversity and Equal Opportunity	3	3	3	3	3	5	+
GRI 406: Non-discrimination	1	1	1	1	1	3	+
GRI 407: Freedom of Association and Collective Bargaining	1	1	1	1	1	5	+
GRI 408: Child Labor	5	5	3	5	5	3	+/-
GRI 409: Forced or compulsory labor	5	5	3	5	5	3	+/-
GRI 413: Local Communities	3	3	3	3	3	3	=
GRI 414: Supplier Social Assessment	3	3	3	3	3	3	=
GRI 415: Public Policy	1	5	5	5	5	5	+
GRI 416: Customer Health and Safety	3	3	3	3	5	3	+/-
GRI 417: Requirements for product and service information and labeling	3	3	3	3	3	3	=
GRI 418: Customer Privacy	1	1	1	3	3	5	+
Sum	39	42	38	44	48	50	+

Note: = no change; +/- oscillated; + improved; - declined

Source: The Author, 2024

Some disclosures were not reported by the company because they were not considered material topics. This was the case for GRI 402 (Labor/Management Relations), GRI 410 (Security Practices), and GRI 411 (Rights of Indigenous Peoples).

The exclusion of these disclosures as material themes suggests that they do not significantly affect the company's sustainable development. However, the violation of

Indigenous rights in Brazil is a concern within this sector's social sustainability performance (Bowman et al., 2021). Therefore, addressing this topic in the company's sustainability reports would be highly relevant.

Some disclosures consistently received a score of "3" across all years, indicating partial reporting on topics such as GRI 401 (Employment), GRI 403 (Occupational Health and Safety), GRI 404 (Training and Education), GRI 413 (Local Communities), GRI 414 (Supplier Social Assessment), and GRI 417 (Marketing and Labeling).

GRI 406 (Non-discrimination) and GRI 407 (Freedom of Association and Collective Bargaining) were underreported until 2023 when GRI 407 achieved full disclosure. This late improvement suggests these issues were not a primary focus in MeatCo's earlier reports but have gained more recent attention.

A study analyzing the reports of two companies from 2015 to 2019 showed that one company did not disclose either topic, while the other consistently disclosed them over time (Pina et al., 2023). This demonstrates differing approaches to these topics among companies.

Improvements were observed in indicators such as GRI 415 (Public Policy) and GRI 418 (Customer Privacy), both progressing from limited or no reporting in 2018 to full disclosure by 2023. GRI 405 (Diversity and Equal Opportunity) also showed improvement, with partial disclosure from 2018 to 2022 and full disclosure in 2023. This trend reflects an increased focus on these areas in recent years in MeatCo's reports.

Pina et al. (2023) also observed this improvement in Diversity and Equal Opportunity disclosure in GRI-based reports in one of the companies they analyzed, despite that company showing no improvement in public policy and a decline in customer privacy.

GRI 416 (Customer Health and Safety) fluctuated, with partial disclosure from 2018

to 2021 and 2023, and full disclosure only in 2022. Scores for GRI 408 (Child Labor) and GRI 409 (Forced or Compulsory Labor) also fluctuated, dropping to partial disclosure in 2020 and 2023, while other years showed full disclosure. This inconsistency may indicate variable prioritization of or challenges in fully reporting on these topics.

The general improvement in reporting coincides with the global increase in sustainability reporting rates, where the social element of sustainability has become a focus for companies (KPMG, 2022). MeatCo's improvements in reporting social sustainability indicators suggest a response or alignment with this trend.

Despite MeatCo's improved commitment to GRI social sustainability disclosures, the partial and inconsistent reporting in some areas indicates opportunities for further progress to ensure full transparency and comprehensive coverage across all relevant social indicators.

One of the main objectives of the GRI standards is to provide transparent information to stakeholders to facilitate informed decision-making (GRI, 2021). High-quality sustainability reports enhance businesses' reputations, as demonstrated by Odriozola and Baraibar-Diez (2017) . Therefore, MeatCo's improved reporting on indicators such as non-discrimination, freedom of association and collective bargaining, public policy, and customer privacy may help strengthen its reputation.

However, fluctuating levels of detail in areas like child labor and forced labor raise questions about the consistency of the company's sustainability reporting. Given that the sector is already known for risks related to poor working conditions (Freshour, 2019) and child labor (Dreier, 2023), this inconsistency could impact trust and raise concerns about MeatCo's commitment to social sustainability.

Considering ST, which advocates that companies' activities must be aligned with stakeholders' interests (Tjahjadi et al., 2024), MeatCo could benefit from a consistent, transparent, and complete report. This commitment to comprehensive reporting could

improve the perception of the company regarding social issues.

Additionally, sustainability reporting can help companies initiate and enhance their sustainability programs (Petrescu et al., 2020). Incomplete information or inconsistencies in reporting may hinder the effectiveness of these programs, as it can limit the company's ability to identify, address, and improve areas of concern in its operations.

The guidelines proposed for report elaboration also offer the potential for legitimizing sustainability in company operations and enhancing its marketing potential (Quilice et al., 2018). Hence, improvements in MeatCo's sustainability reporting could strengthen its commitment to socially sustainable practices and build trust with stakeholders.

4.3 EVALUATION OF THE DEVELOPMENT OF SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY INDICATORS OVER TIME

Overall, the company demonstrated more progress than decline, but the same number of topics with improvements also showed no change. This indicates that while progress occurred, several areas stagnated (Table 7).

Table 7: Evaluation of Social Sustainability Indicators in GRI-Based Reports: Evolution Over Time (MeatCo 2018-203)

GRI topics	**Main classification**
GRI 401: Employment	Improvement/Variation
GRI 403: Occupational Health and Safety	Improvement
GRI 404: Training and Education	Mixed
GRI 405: Diversity and Equal Opportunity	Mixed
GRI 406: Non-discrimination	Deterioration
GRI 407: Freedom of Association and Collective Bargaining	Not available
GRI 408: Child Labor	No change
GRI 409: Forced or compulsory labor	No change
GRI 413: Local Communities	Decline, improvement and no change
GRI 414: Supplier Social Assessment	Improvement
GRI 415: Public Policy	No change
GRI 416: Customer Health and Safety	No change
GRI 417: Requirements for product and service information and labeling	No change
GRI 418: Customer Privacy	Improvement

Source: The Author, 2024

Although some individual topics showed improvements in completeness, this did not necessarily translate to improvements within the topic itself. For example, the ”Non-discrimination” topic actually showed an increase in the number of discrimination incidents.

4.3.1 Employment (GRI 401)

Overall, this topic showed mainly improvements and general changes that do not fit neatly into the categories of ”improvement,” ”decline,” or ”no change,” followed by decline and no change.

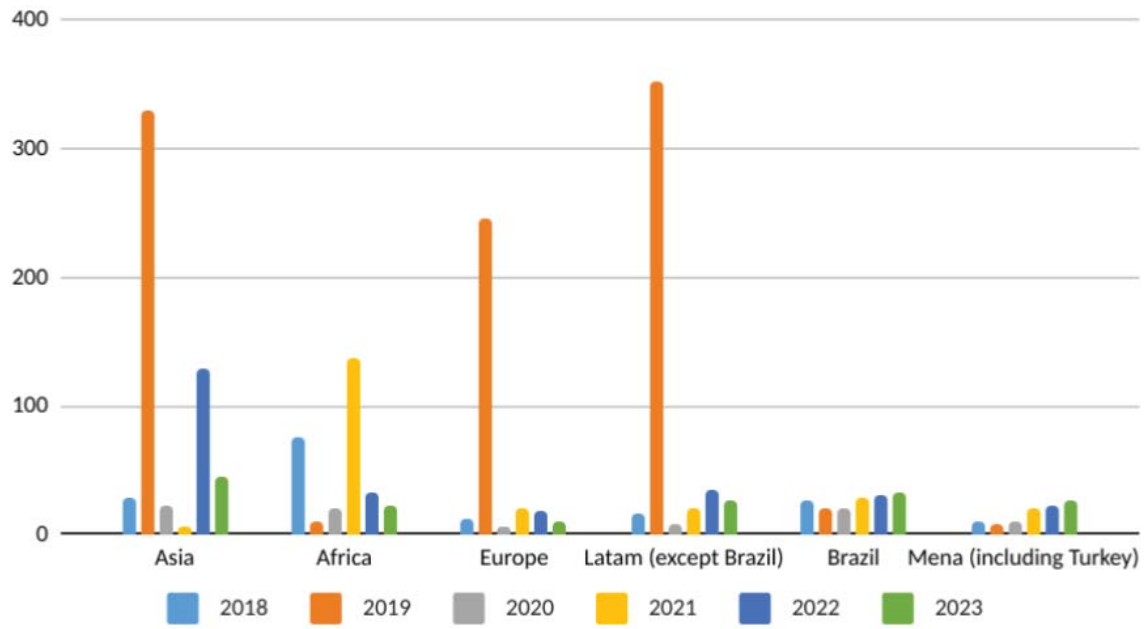
Improvements were observed in new hires regarding gender. From 2018 to 2023, there was a decrease in the discrepancy between men and women new hires, with the ratio of (men/women) new hires dropping from 1.62 to 1.23. This disparity in gender hiring in Brazil is also observed in other industries, such as the automotive industry (de Paes et al., 2021). Several explanations exist for this phenomenon, including the influence of gender bias on hiring evaluations (Hardy et al., 2022) and gender stereotypes that limit the job positions considered ”suitable for women,” often relegating them to roles related to caregiving. Motherhood can also be a disadvantage in hiring processes (Lim et al., 2022).

Turnover by region also showed improvement. After an initial peak in 2019 across multiple regions, turnover decreased in subsequent years (Figure 7). This suggests that 2019 was a challenging year, but most regions experienced reduced turnover afterward, indicating a positive trend in performance.

The discrepancy in retention rate after parental leave between genders also showed a slight improvement over the years, although women’s retention rate remains lower than men’s (Figure 8).

Some factors that affect retention after parental leave at the individual level are its duration, number of times of previous parental leave, health condition, work-family

Figure 7: MeatCo's percentage of turnover by region from 2018-2023



Source: The Author, 2024.

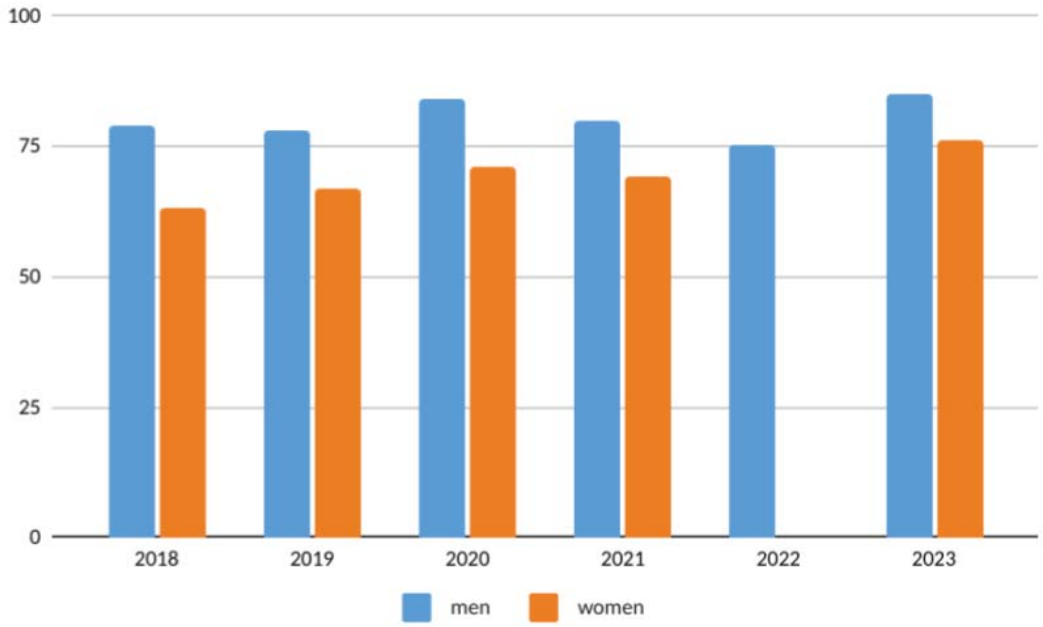
conflict, and resilience (Jung & Sung, 2022). Other aspects, such as paid parental leave and adequate childcare, must also be considered (Morgan et al., 2021).

The analysis reveals a higher uptake of parental leave by women compared to men, with a decline in overall utilization for both genders over the years. The higher uptake among women suggests that caregiving responsibilities still fall disproportionately on them, which can reinforce traditional gender roles and potentially hinder career progression for women. This may be related to the higher turnover rate for women also found in MeatCo's data.

According to a study by the Best Place Working for Parents (2023) , first-time mothers who use paid leave are 32% less likely to quit their jobs and 19% more likely to return to the same company after leave. Therefore, the decline in the overall utilization of parental leave could have significant impacts on the organization, such as increased turnover costs.

As Stock and Inglis (2021) indicate that parental leave is related to unemployment

Figure 8: Retention rates of employees that took parental leave, by gender.



Source: The Author, 2024.

duration and earnings, this decline could also point to potential barriers or a lack of support for employees taking leave, such as fear of career setbacks, lack of awareness, or insufficient encouragement from management.

Considering ST and its emphasis on organizational success by balancing the needs of all stakeholders (Tjahjadi et al., 2024), including employees, supporting parental leave can improve retention, reduce turnover costs, and enhance the company's reputation with employees and potential candidates. By considering this, the company can also meet the expectations of shareholders and communities that value socially sustainable practices.

Regarding turnover by gender, the company did not present changes, with women's turnover higher than men's, showing no improvement or deterioration in this matter from 2018 to 2023 (Table 8).

Table 8: MeatsCo turnover percentage by gender (2018-2023).

Year	**Gender**	**Turnover percentage** (%)
2018	Men	23,48
	Women	25,74
2019	Men	20,34
	Women	21,10
2020	Men	20,13
	Women	17,94
2021	Men	27,53
	Women	26,26
2022	Men	28,01
	Women	29,90
2023	Men	28,25
	Women	30,73

Source: The Author, 2024

Women's turnover tends to be higher than men's (Heon, 2012). This was also observed at MeatCo, with an average turnover rate of 24.63 for men and 25.28 for women. Turnover intention has several predictors, such as job satisfaction, organizational commitment, and empowerment (Ozkan et al., 2020).

According to social exchange theory, employees tend to evaluate the quality of their relationship with the organization. When this relationship is perceived as positive, they are less likely to leave (Kamau et al., 2021). However, research in the medical care sector found that women with young children have less intention to leave their jobs but end up leaving at higher rates than their counterparts (Bardoel et al., 2020). This demonstrates that non-organizational factors, such as social roles, can influence gender differences in employee turnover.

MeatCo's data aligns with the findings of Kamau et al. (2021) and Bardoel et al. (2020) . The fluctuation in turnover rates between genders is slightly higher for women, suggesting that MeatCo should consider addressing factors beyond those directly related to the organization, such as its relationship with female employees. The company should also consider initiatives that address external factors to promote gender equality in workforce retention.

Over time, there was a deterioration in the benefits provided to full-time employees that were not offered to temporary or part-time employees. Information on benefits such as life insurance, health plans, disability assistance, parental leave, private pensions, and share acquisition plans showed deterioration. This is because, over the years, the company shifted from offering additional, specialized benefits to full-time employees to focusing on more standard benefits.

According to Harrison et al. (2015) , the inconsistent reporting and reduced employee support presented in MeatCo's reports could make it less competitive in retaining talent. Therefore, adhering to a more consistent, employee-focused benefits strategy, despite financial constraints, could generate longer-term value by fostering a committed and skilled workforce.

New hires and turnover by age presented variation. The proportion of new hires under 30 years old has consistently decreased, from 74.5% in 2018 to 59.5% in 2023, while those aged 30-50 and above 50 have increased. The proportion of turnover for employees under 30 and those aged 30-50 has increased, while turnover for those above 50 has decreased (Table 9).

Table 9: MeatsCo turnover percentage by age group (2018-2023).

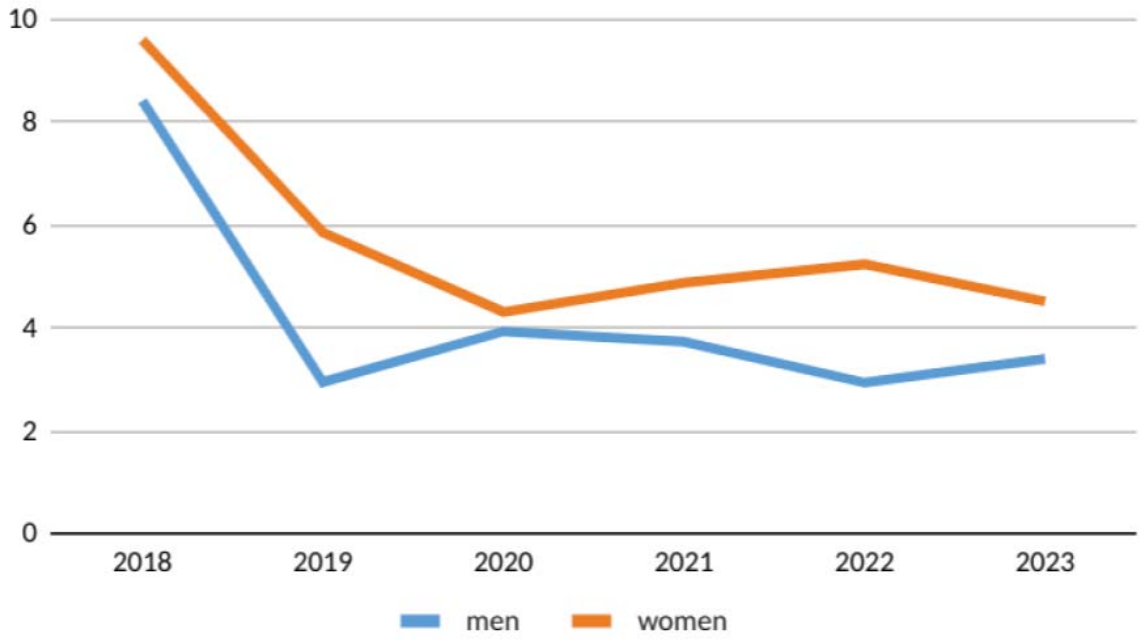
	2018	**2019**	**2020**	**2021**	**2022**	**2023**	**Average**
under 30 years old	58.99	60.94	62.53	55.48	52.87	59.51	58.39
30-50 years old	35.54	34.56	34.31	41.07	43.22	37.42	37.75
over 50 years old	5.07	4.50	3.15	3.45	3.92	3.07	3.86

Source: The Author, 2024

New hires from different regions also presented variation. There is a noticeable fluctuation in new hires across different years and regions, especially in Africa, where hiring spikes in certain years (notably 2020 and 2021)[MeatCo,2020; MeatCo, 2021]. This suggests inconsistent trends rather than steady improvement, decline, or stability across the regions.

The total number of MeatCo employees entitled to and taking parental leave has also worsened. The percentage of both men and women taking parental leave has decreased in recent years, with an overall increase in the disparity between genders (Figure 9).

Figure 9: Percentage of employees that were entitled to take parental leave and took it at MeatCo, by gender.



Source: The Author, 2024.

A study conducted through in-depth interviews with men from South Korea, Spain, and the United States showed that strong gender norms regarding men taking parental leave inhibit them from doing so (Bueno & Oh, 2022). Workplace culture, economic considerations, and a traditional gendered division of labor can also be reflected in the difference in parental leave uptake between genders (Reimer, 2020).

The total number of employees who returned to work in the reporting period after parental leave ended, and the total number of employees who returned to work after parental leave ended that were still employed 12 months after their return, were not analyzed. This information does not allow for accurate analysis due to several factors.

Employees may begin their parental leave in one year and return in the following. This time lag complicates the analysis, as the reporting period may not fully capture the parental leave cycle for all employees. For example, an employee who starts parental leave in December may return in April of the next year, leading to discrepancies in the data if only annual figures are considered.

Additionally, the most accurate analysis would be based on percentages, not gross numbers. This timing discrepancy may distort the analysis, as it can lead to undercounting or overcounting returns and retentions, creating a misleading view of the leave and return patterns. Therefore, this is a limitation imposed by the disclosure framework.

As women take parental leave more often than men, despite representing a smaller proportion of the overall workforce, this higher usage means that while women might return to work in greater numbers, it does not necessarily indicate that they return at a higher rate proportionally. Therefore, comparing the total numbers without accounting for the proportion of each gender taking leave can give a misleading impression of gender parity in returning to work after parental leave.

This analysis reveals critical insights into MeatCo's employment practices and their alignment with social sustainability objectives, specifically regarding employee retention, gender equity, and benefits. While improvements were noted, particularly in gender parity for new hires and turnover reduction in some regions, the overall findings indicate areas where inconsistency and decline may undermine long-term workforce stability and employee satisfaction.

4.3.2 Occupational Health and Safety (GRI 403)

4.3.2.1 Occupational Health and Safety (GRI 403 2016)

A deterioration was observed in injury rates (IR) without leaves, considering only employees, with a general increase. Most regions increased the amount of IR without leaves, considering only employees, except for the region called by the company “Latin America (except Brazil)” which was the only one with diminishing results, from 100 in 2018 to 0 in 2019. Africa remained the same at 0. IR in Brazil, Asia, Europe, and the Middle East increased [MeatCo,2019].

Work-related fatalities, considering only employees, also worsened, increasing from 0 in 2018 to 1 in 2019. This change was observed in Brazil, which went from zero fatalities in 2018 to one in 2019, while all other regions remained the same [MeatCo,2019].

The increase in IR without leaves and work-related fatalities is concerning and may offset other positive developments, as fatalities are a particularly sensitive metric. In America, major causes of workplace injuries and fatalities include stress from work pressure, job insecurity, work overload, drug abuse, and other psychological factors (Dodoo & Al-Samarraie, 2021).

Workplace safety is an important indicator for social sustainability in organizations (SSO) (Ajmal et al., 2017) and a key factor that influences it (Ullah et al., 2021). Therefore, addressing and improving safety incidents is crucial for companies seeking to enhance their SSO performance.

Workers with high incidence or high risk of diseases related to their occupation also presented a deterioration, between 2018 and 2019, as a shift in how MeatCo addresses occupational risks. In 2018, MeatCo identified manufacturing and agricultural areas as having the greatest occupational risk [MeatCo,2018]. In 2019, the report only mentioned that they ”are aware that some of our employees are exposed to risks that are inherent to our operations” [MeatCo, 2019, p.76], without specifying the areas themselves.

Lastly, the reporting on formal agreements with unions that cover health and safety

also declined from one year to the next. In its 2018 report, MeatCo mentioned that the collective agreement with unions includes health and safety provisions. For example, the company cited the development of standards based on a tripartite commission with representatives from trade unions [MeatCo,2023]. However, in 2019, the report only mentioned that “collective bargaining agreements with labor unions address health and safety when applicable” [MeatCo,2019, p.76]. This change in 2019 reduces transparency and the perceived level of engagement and commitment to health and safety issues.

The meat and derivatives sector is already known for the negative health impact its operations have on workers (De-Assis et al., 2021). Along with the deterioration in employees’ health and safety, this raises concerns about the company-stakeholder relationship, as injury rates without leave and work-related fatalities have increased. Additionally, the lack of information about positions with a high incidence or high risk of diseases related to the occupation and the lack of information on health and safety topics covered in formal agreements with trade unions may negatively impact employee and union relationships.

Because employee health and safety addresses concerns from most stakeholders, it should be prioritized by the company’s sustainability efforts to effectively balance the interests of different stakeholders (Amponsah-Tawiah & Mensah, 2015). Therefore, better addressing this area, in addition to improving employee health and safety, could improve relationships among stakeholders, which is necessary for organizational sustainability.

The level at which each formal joint management-worker health and safety committee typically operates within the organization and the percentage of workers whose work or workplace is controlled by the organization and who are represented by formal joint management-worker health and safety committees did not change.

In 2018 and 2019, MeatCo's formal joint management-worker health and safety committees typically operated at multiple levels within the organization, reflecting a well-structured approach to occupational health and safety (OHS). In both years, 100% of their employees were represented by formal joint management-worker health and safety committees [MeatCo,2018; MeatCo, 2019]. Work-related fatalities excluding employees remained at zero in both years.

The consistent worker representation in formal joint management-worker health and safety committees signals the importance given to employees' health and safety. However, this may not be enough, as the quality of this representation and its effectiveness significantly impact employee health and safety.

Walters and Wadsworth (2020) identified several issues related to the quality of worker representation in health and safety committees: many representatives report having little time for representational activities and for implementing necessary interventions. Additionally, most representatives do not engage in risk identification and assessments themselves, instead prioritizing the outcomes.

Considering that this information is not required by the GRI standards, the gap in capturing the quality of worker representation in health and safety committees is a failure of the reporting standard itself, since the required information does not include it. Hence, to address this gap found in the report and in Walters and Wadsworth (2020) work, more information on representatives' involvement is needed to provide a more accurate perspective on the committee's effectiveness in leading to improvements and preventative measures related to worker health and safety.

The injury rate with leaves, considering the ”all employees” category by region, showed improvement, as most regions decreased their amount of IR with leaves, except for Africa and the Middle East, which remained the same. Overall (sum of each region's injury rate with leaves divided by the number of regions), the decrease was

from 11.54 in 2018 to 1.81 in 2019. Only Africa and the Middle East had the same IR in both years. Latin America, Asia, and Europe showed a decrease.

The lost day rate by region also improved, decreasing in all regions. The sum of each region's injury rate with leaves decreased from 330 in 2018 to 83.2 in 2019. Only Africa did not change, remaining at 0 in both years.

The improvement in IR with leaves and lost day rate, considering all employees, has significant implications for workers' lives. However, the company, the public sector, and society also benefit from this improvement when considering the financial costs of work-related injuries.

According to Tompa et al. (2017) , for workers, labor injuries result in healthcare costs, lost wages and payroll benefits, household production losses, and the monetary value of health-related quality-of-life losses. Employers also face healthcare costs, insurance program costs for wage replacement, administrative costs, loss of worker productivity, and negative impacts on labor relations and reputation. The public sector incurs healthcare and administrative costs, as well as experiencing productivity and investment implications. All of these factors contribute to costs for society in general.

MeatCo's improvements in OHS practices directly contribute to its broader social sustainability efforts, improving relationships with stakeholders, reducing costs, and enhancing its overall standing as a socially sustainable organization.

Occupational disease rate and absentee rate by region lacked sufficient information to be classified. Information on types of injury, injury rate, occupational disease rate, lost day rate, absentee rate, and work-related fatalities for all employees, with a breakdown by gender, was also unavailable. In 2018, information on types of injury and IR for all workers (excluding employees) whose work or workplace is controlled by the organization, with a breakdown by region and gender, was unavailable. Therefore, those categories were not classified. The company also did not report the percentage

to which various health and safety topics are covered by these agreements.

4.3.2.2 Occupational Health and Safety (GRI 403 2018)

The scope of the company's OHS system evolved significantly over the years. In 2020, all areas were covered by the health and safety management system [MeatCo, 2020]. However, in 2021, the report stated that "92.4% of our employees were covered by the system" [MeatCo,2021, p.90], without a clear explanation of when employees are not covered.

By 2022, the OHS system had expanded to include not only employees but also service providers and direct suppliers, who are required to comply with the company's standards. Additionally, customers were included in the system. As stated in the report, "part of the routine of our sales consultants involves using the [MeatCo] Connect app to report any situations to their managers that they may observe when visiting their clients' premises (...). By doing so, the manager receiving the input can contact the client to address the issue" [MeatCo,2022, p.70].

In 2023, the company continued to emphasize the comprehensive nature of its OHS management system, stating that it covered all employees, including workers from third-party companies engaged with the organization.

This expansion to cover not only employees but also service providers, direct suppliers, and customers aligns with the concept that value creation flows between the company and its stakeholders (Freudenreich et al., 2020), recognizing the interdependence between them.

The data shows that by including suppliers and customers in its OHS management system, the company recognizes the interconnectedness of the health and safety of those involved in its value chain with its own operational success. This reflects a holistic view of the OHS management system that benefits multiple stakeholders and reduces

health and safety risks across the ecosystem.

The reporting on the results of processes used to evaluate and continually improve the OHS management system also shows improvement. In 2020, there was a single mention that treatment or mitigation of risks is developed based on the results of these processes. From 2021 onward, the reports state that the results were also discussed monthly by the Health and Safety Committees, which include members from senior management and technical areas.

Occupational health services that contribute to the identification and elimination of hazards and risks have shown consistent improvement by enhancing preventive measures and risk management systems. However, the 2023 report lacks a clear explanation of how the organization ensures the quality of and access to these services for workers.

In 2020 and 2021, MeatCo stated that it monitors risks and has a risk control management system based on the NBR 14280 standard and specific corporate standards, with accident analysis based on OSHA methodology [MeatCo,2020; MeatCo2021]. The company also consistently works on raising awareness and reinforcing prevention practices [MeatCo,2020].

The company highlighted some measures to eliminate, minimize, or mitigate such risks, such as eliminating critical activities, reducing the exposure of people to more unhealthy or dangerous tasks, investing in the adequacy and protection of machines, implementing controls through safety signage based on Regulatory Norms (NR) and Brazilian Regulatory Norms (NBR) standards, using management tools for legal and institutional training, and supplying personal protective equipment (PPE) for all activities in their operations [MeatCo,2020].

In 2021, the report added operational and administrative controls to eliminate and minimize threats, accidents, and illnesses. Risks are identified, prioritized, and dis-

cussed for monitoring and reduction. The company also has processes for systematic identification, evaluation, and mitigation in all installations, following international risk management standards from ISO 31000 [MeatCo,2021].

Another program, ”Task Risk Mapping,” was announced, involving monthly discussions and meetings with management and technical areas. The participation of employees was also highlighted through the Internal Commission for Accident Prevention (CIPA)’s monthly meetings to understand risks, adopt control measures, and prevent accidents and incidents. The ”Observation and Prevention Programs,” in which employees report irregularities, was also mentioned [MeatCo,2021].

In 2022, the company’s reporting on this topic highlighted a more preventive approach through epidemiological studies. New programs were mentioned, such as the ”Occupational Risk Management Program,” which addresses risks from physical, chemical, biological, and ergonomic agents, and the ”Respiratory Protection Program” and ”Hearing Conservation Program” to ensure employee well-being [MeatCo,2022].

The Occupational Health Medical Control Program was integrated with the Occupational Risk Management Program to monitor occupational risks. MeatCo also monitors and supports employees impacted by health issues and reinforces controls and risk management to prevent recurrences [MeatCo,2022].

In 2023, as in previous years, the company focused on a preventive health management system by maintaining the Occupational Health Medical Control and Occupational Risk Management programs to monitor risks, along with the Respiratory Protection Program. However, there was no mention of the Hearing Conservation Program or how the organization ensures the quality of and access to these services for workers [MeatCo,2023].

The increasing number of occupational health services programs demonstrates a growing focus on employee health and safety. However, the lack of clarity regarding

how the company guarantees access to and the quality of these services may raise concerns. Transparency is necessary to build stakeholder trust, which is important for stakeholders to engage in relationships with the organization, assume risks, and participate in productive exchanges (Crane, 2020).

Organizational trust has been shown to impact job satisfaction (Varihanna & Nizam, 2020). Therefore, if workers are uncertain about their access to occupational health services, their trust in the company may be negatively affected, and consequently, their job satisfaction may also suffer.

Processes for worker participation and consultation in the development, implementation, and evaluation of the OHS management system, as well as access to and communication of relevant information on OHS to workers, have shown improvements over the years.

From 2020 to 2023, MeatCo has consistently highlighted the role of CIPA in facilitating worker participation in the OHS management system. CIPA participates in monthly strategic meetings with leadership, focusing on understanding risks, control measures, and accident prevention.

CIPA's responsibility is to participate in these monthly meetings to learn about risks, control measures, and means of preventing accidents and incidents [MeatCo,2020; MeatCo,2021; MeatCo,2022; MeatCo,2023]. In 2023, the company introduced an Observation and Prevention Program, in which employees participate in the implementation of OHS by identifying and addressing colleagues who exhibit unsafe behaviors. This suggests an improvement in the processes for worker participation and consultation within the OHS management system.

Despite ongoing mentions of CIPA's involvement, there is no clear description of how relevant OHS information is communicated to all workers or how they can access this information. Additionally, the reports do not clarify CIPA's decision-making author-

ity or whether all workers are represented by CIPA.

Stakeholders may demand to be consulted and participate in decision-making processes, and the company will only succeed if it satisfies stakeholder needs and expectations (Ljubojević & Ljubojević, 2011). Therefore, stakeholder (employee) participation through CIPA is essential to ensure that workers are considered important players in OHS.

One of the foundations of stakeholder relationships is information sharing, which, when aligned with stakeholder interests, creates more value for organizations (de Langrafe et al., 2020). Therefore, the lack of information on how relevant OHS information is communicated to and accessed by all workers, CIPA's decision-making authority, and whether all workers are represented by CIPA may hinder value creation from this relationship.

The rate of high-consequence work-related injuries excluding fatalities and of recordable work-related injuries dropped from 2020 to 2023. For employees, cases decreased from 1.26 in 2020 to 0.11 in 2023, and for other workers, from 2.08 to 0. Additionally, the rate of recordable work-related injuries for employees decreased from 9.92 in 2020 to 5.31 in 2023, and for other workers, it declined from 5.82 to 2.86.

The number of cases of recordable work-related ill health also decreased from 198 in 2020 to 94 in 2023. With this decline in work-related ill health, the types of work-related ill health also diminished.

MeatCo's approach to work-related injuries reveals important points about the impact of the company on its stakeholders. ST advocates that companies must fulfill stakeholders' needs. Employees are stakeholders, and shareholders are impacted when employees are sick or absent; therefore, employee health and well-being are extremely important for the company (Mehmood et al., 2020).

The improvement in the rate of high-consequence work-related injuries (excluding

fatalities) and the rate of recordable work-related injuries demonstrates the company's commitment to continuous improvement in its OHS practices and, consequently, its attention to and compliance with stakeholder interests.

The reporting on the implementation of a health and safety management system based on recognized risk management and/or management system standards/guidelines declined. The reports shifted from explicit mentions of ISO 14001 in 2020 to more internally focused programs in subsequent years, and finally to vague descriptions of risk management systems without clear references to external standards in 2023 (Table 10).

According to ST, one of the foundations of relationships is information sharing that aligns with stakeholder interests, which creates more value for organizations (de Langrafe et al., 2020). The company's communication around legal requirements and recognized standards lacks a clear list of followed legal requirements and standards. This may lead to reduced trust among stakeholders who rely on these disclosures to gauge the company's commitment to worker safety and well-being.

The reporting on OHS training provided to workers also shows a decline in quality. Initially, in 2020 and 2021, the company provided comprehensive training, covering new employees, operational procedures, high-risk activities, and promoting internal health campaigns. However, by 2022 and 2023, some previously mentioned training programs, such as the Risk Factor program to train employees on risk awareness and mitigation and the Champion Multipliers training program [MeatCo,2021], were no longer referenced, indicating a regression in the diversity and detail of training initiatives over time.

Employees are considered important stakeholders, mainly due to their impact on other stakeholders (Crane, 2020). Their perception of the company's diminishing efforts in worker training on OHS may cause dissatisfaction and distrust. Therefore, the

Table 10: Health and safety management system based on recognized risk management and/or management system standards/guidelines (MeatCO 2020-2023)

Year	Program/Standards Applied	Description
2020	ISO 14001	”(...) our Health, Safety, and Environmental Policy (HSE Policy), which sets out guidelines for environmental management based on ISO 14001 principles. The document guides our activities and growth strategy in accordance with the applicable regulations.” [MeatCo,2020, p.115]
2021	Several different policies and programs	Introduced several specific programs: ”We also have 88 Health and Safety regulatory documents, 67 Corporate Regulations and 20 Corporate Rulings on the issue, all of which are available in the Health and Safety Management System.” ”Also forming part of the [MeatCo] Management System are the programs entitled ’Occupational Health Medical Control’ (PCMSO), ’Hearing Conservation’ (PCA), ’Ergonomics’ (PE) and the ’Management of Information on Legal Requirements.’”[MeatCo,2021, p.90].
2022	Several different policies and programs	Maintain and add new programs: ”Also forming part of this management system are: the ’Risk Management Program’ (RMP), developed in accordance with international standards (ISO 31000); the ’Occupational Risk Management Program’ (ORMP); the ’Occupational Health Medical Control Program’ (PCMSO); the ’Hearing Protection Program’ (HPP); the ’Ergonomics Program’ (EP); the ’Respiratory Protection Program’ (RPP); the ’Management of Information on Legal Requirements’, and other routines and tools, such as the Mapping of Job Risks”. [MeatCo,2022, p.70]
2023	Integrated Risk Management	Continued focus on integrated risk management systems but without explicit mention of recognized risk management standards or guidelines: ”We have risk management programs and an integrated management system that allows us to operationalize standardized routines, aiming to go beyond mere compliance with legislation and adopting the best possible practices.”[MeatCo,2023, p.87]

Source: The Author, 2024

reduction in detail about training programs may negatively impact the relationship between the company and its stakeholders.

Business owners tend to claim that workers' behavior is unsafe (Mausumi, 2017). The reduction in training programs could decrease employee participation in the company's OHS system, potentially affecting its efficiency, since employees are key stakeholders who directly influence its performance.

The percentage of employees and workers who are not employees covered by an OHS management system that has been internally and externally audited decreased from 94.4% in 2020 to 93.23% in 2023.

Some indicators have shown variations over the years that cannot be clearly classified as improvements or deteriorations. MeatCo consistently reports that its processes for identifying work-related hazards and risks are integrated into the company's Risk Management Program, following ISO 31000 international risk management standards [MeatCo,2020; MeatCo,2021; MeatCo, 2022]. However, these reports do not detail the application of the hierarchy of controls. In 2023, ISO 31000 is no longer mentioned, but for the first time, there is a description of how the hierarchy of controls is applied.

The method by which the organization ensures the quality of these processes, including the competency of the people who carry them out, also presented variation over the years. From 2020 to 2022, the quality of the process was guaranteed using a recognized international standard (ISO 31000). In 2023, the quality was guaranteed by the evaluation of the whole process by a Management System.

ISO 31000 provides guidelines on managing risks faced by organizations. Its process consists of the systematic "application of policies, procedures, and practices to the activities of communicating and consulting, establishing the context and assessing, treating, monitoring, reviewing, recording, and reporting risk" (International Organization for Standardization, 2018, p. 8).

The description of the processes used to investigate work-related incidents presented mixed results. From 2020 to 2022, there was more structured information regarding incident investigations and risk management. In 2020, MeatCo described the investigation and characterization of hazardous activities, which involves technical reports by qualified professionals. This process helps determine corrective actions and necessary improvements in the health and safety management system [MeatCo,2020].

In 2021, MeatCo indicated that they conduct investigations into all accidents and near-accidents. While the report did not provide a detailed description of the investigation process, it confirmed the practice of ongoing assessment of the health and safety system, likely including identifying hazards, assessing risks, determining corrective actions, and making improvements. The involvement of weekly and monthly meetings at all levels further supports a structured approach to incident investigation and management [MeatCo,2021].

In 2022, MeatCo described its identification of hazards and assessment of risks through various regulatory documents, corporate norms, and instructions, with corrective actions taken and improvements needed based on their OHS system explained above. However, the hierarchy of controls was not directly mentioned in their reports. In 2023, there was a clear regression, with the report solely mentioning that the management system includes mapping risk areas, and the results are debated among leadership and technical areas.

The reporting on the promotion of worker health also presented mixed results. In 2020, the company did not provide information on worker health promotion, but in 2021, it introduced several non-occupational medical and healthcare services, with additional services added in 2022. In 2023, while the gym partnerships were no longer mentioned, the company continued its health initiatives and aligned them with national Health Ministry campaigns for disease prevention, reflecting both continuity and re-

gression in the variety of services offered.

A company's actions toward any of its stakeholders can signal its trustworthiness and influence how stakeholders will engage in future interactions (Crane, 2020). Therefore, any regression in safety processes can negatively affect those future exchanges. To maintain positive relationships with stakeholders, MeatCo to demonstrate a consistent and evolving commitment to safety, according to Crane (2020) .

The rate of fatalities due to work-related injury oscillated throughout the years. For workers other than employees, it was 0.01 in 2020 and 2022 and zero in 2021 and 2023. For employees, it was 0.06 in 2023 and zero in the other years. According to Hinsberg and Lamanna (2024) , workplace fatalities are considered preventable, and when they occur, there are legal, financial, and reputational consequences, depending on how stakeholders perceive the company's responsibility for the accident, its previous reputation, and whether the company has experienced similar situations before. Therefore, this is a topic for concern, as fatalities are sensitive events that may significantly influence stakeholders' perceptions of the company's OHS practices.

A few indicators could not be classified due to a lack of information. A description of the processes for workers to report work-related hazards and hazardous situations and an explanation of how workers are protected against reprisals were only addressed in 2021.

A description of the policies and processes for workers to remove themselves from work situations that they believe could cause injury or ill health. Additionally, there is no explanation of how workers are protected from reprisals or information on which hazards may have contributed to cases of ill health during the reporting period across any of the years. Actions taken or underway to eliminate other work-related hazards and minimize risks using the hierarchy of controls was only addressed in 2020.

Some indicators did not change during the observation period, such as the report-

ing on whether the OHS management system has been implemented due to legal requirements. However, the company consistently mentions compliance with laws and regulations across the markets in which it operates.

Reporting on the joint management-worker health and safety committees' responsibilities, meeting frequency, decision-making authority, and whether and why any workers are not represented by these committees also remained unchanged. The structure and function of CIPA have remained consistent over the years in terms of responsibilities and meeting frequency, but decision-making authority is not clarified.

Stakeholders can demand to be consulted and to participate in decision-making processes, and the company will succeed only if it satisfies stakeholders' needs and expectations (Ljubojević & Ljubojević, 2011). Considering that, stakeholder (employee) participation through CIPA is essential to ensure that workers are considered important players in OHS.

One of the foundations of relationships is information sharing that aligns with stakeholder interests, which creates more value for organizations (Ljubojević & Ljubojević, 2011). Therefore, the lack of information on CIPA's decision-making authority may hinder value creation from this relationship.

MeatCo describes its approach to preventing or mitigating significant OHS impacts directly linked to its operations, products, or services through business relationships. This approach demonstrates a steady commitment to supplier relationships based on compliance with regulatory norms, reputational assessments, and a commitment to labor standards for workers. However, this topic was not consistently addressed across all years.

During the years that the topic was disclosed, MeatCo highlighted its commitment to maintaining commercial relations with suppliers that comply with corporate regulations, including reputational analysis and adherence to labor commitments. The agreements

with these suppliers explicitly include clauses focused on safeguarding workers' health and safety, underscoring MeatCo's effort to mitigate significant occupational health risks through responsible business partnerships.

As many unethical practices and violations originate with suppliers, social sustainability issues need to be addressed through the adoption of social sustainability practices throughout the supply chain (Govindan et al., 2021). Considering that suppliers and their workers both affect and are affected by the organization, they are stakeholders whose compliance with the organization's standards must be ensured to mitigate operational and reputational risks.

Despite the company demonstrating a steady commitment to relationships with suppliers based on regulatory norms, reputational analysis, and labor commitments for their workers, the lack of reporting on the topic in some years suggests that the company should consider disclosing this topic more consistently to improve its transparency and build trust with all stakeholders.

The percentage of all employees and workers who are not employees but whose work and/or workplace is controlled by the organization and who are covered by an OHS management system was 100% during all years, and all workers were included in this disclosure every year.

The number of fatalities due to work-related ill health remained at 0. Actions to eliminate hazards and minimize risks used a hierarchy of controls during all years except for 2021, for which this information was not available.

Considering ST, MeatCo's approach to OHS demonstrates a commitment to continuous improvement in some aspects. At the same time, it also reveals some gaps that could be addressed to ensure that all stakeholders' needs are fulfilled.

The expansion of health and safety management systems to include suppliers and clients, as well as improvements in managerial discussions on safety management,

reflects important advances that fulfill the interests of workers, commercial partners, and regulators.

However, the fluctuation in fatalities, regression in training, and lack of consistent information on risk management and hazard elimination are critical points that may jeopardize stakeholder trust. These areas suggest that despite improvements, inconsistencies in the application and communication of safety practices may raise concerns among stakeholders about MeatCo's commitment to OHS.

Therefore, MeatCo should adopt a more consistent and transparent approach to guarantee that OHS processes are applied and communicated clearly to stakeholders. This may strengthen trust with workers, suppliers, and regulators and will contribute to better management of OHS.

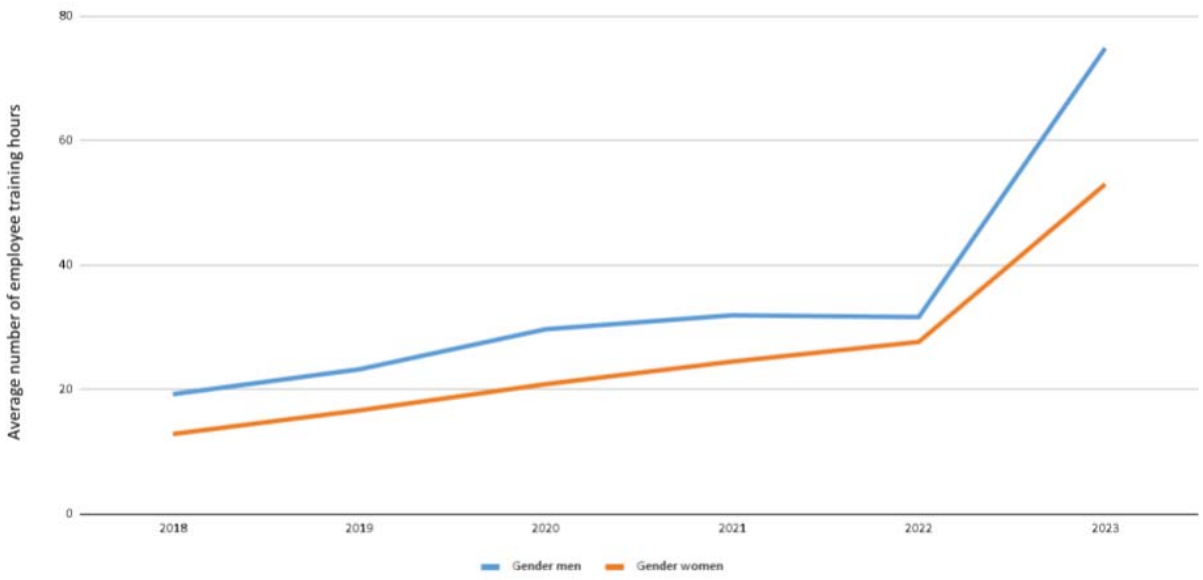
4.3.3 Training and Education (GRI 404)

Most topics within this disclosure presented mixed results over time. There was an increase in the average hours of training. Regarding gender, men receive more training than women. This discrepancy fluctuates among years, with its lowest point in 2022 and its highest in 2018, 2020, and 2023 (Figure 10).

This discrepancy indicate unequal access to training, which could be a consequence of the positions typically occupied by men. Therefore, the data does not clearly indicate whether the difference in training access between genders is due to gender itself or to the positions occupied by different genders, as diff or simply lower representation of women in the workforceerent positions in the company also showed differences in training access. To clarify this, the most accurate presentation of this data would be to provide the proportional hours of training by gender and position categories.

Companies that communicate their gender equality activities may experience a boost in their reputation (Wilton et al., 2019). Training in the workplace increases employees' competencies and consequently improves the growth rate of individuals within

Figure 10: Average hours of capacitation carried out by the employees of the organization during the period of the report, separated by gender, MeatCo (2018-2023).



Source: The Author, 2024.

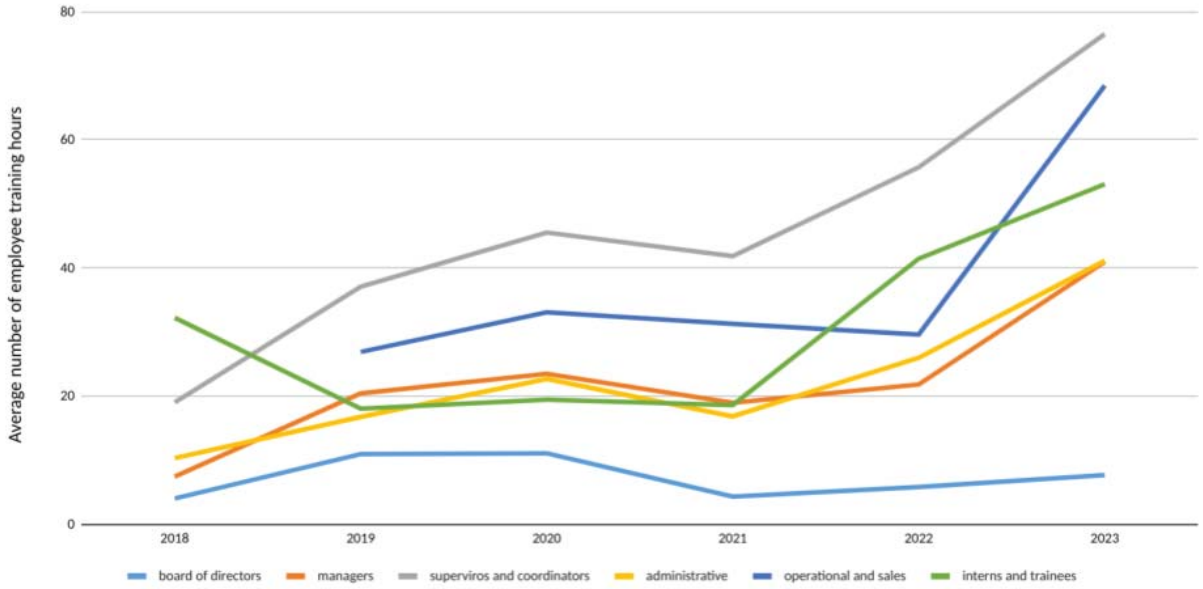
the organization (Zhang et al., 2023). Therefore, the discrepancy in training between genders may negatively impact women's outcomes in the workplace and could also negatively affect the company's reputation with external stakeholders.

To better align company practices with stakeholder needs and expectations, promoting an egalitarian distribution of training hours between genders would be necessary.

Regarding functional categories, supervisors and coordinators receive more training, followed by operational and sales staff, interns and trainees, managers and administrative staff, and lastly, the board of directors (Figure 11).

The company's prioritize training for supervisors and coordinators, operational and sales staff, and interns and trainees. These functions that may require more knowledge acquisition for their and the company's development, potentially strengthening its

Figure 11: Average hours of capacitation carried out by the employees of the organization during the period of the report, separated by gender, MeatCo (2018-2023).



Source: The Author, 2024.

managerial base for company succession.

In this case, the company would be aligned with its stakeholders' needs (workers and investors) by strategically allocating training efforts according to employee and company needs. This approach ensures that training resources are directed to maximize the impact for workers and the organization, resulting in better worker performance and engagement and contributing to the company's sustainable growth.

MeatCo's programs for upgrading employee skills showed improvements from 2018 to 2022, with the creation of the MeatCo Academy, expanded online and on-site training, and increased grants for education. The company introduced new programs, including virtual training during the pandemic and specialized academies for leadership, health and safety, and production chains.

However, by 2023, some programs were no longer mentioned, indicating a decline

in this area. Despite this, the addition of the ”Jornada da Aprendizagem” in 2023 maintained a focus on internal development, though some deterioration was noted in specific programs. The company did not address transition assistance programs.

Training and development programs help workers improve skills that may be required in the future, which leads to job satisfaction and improved employee performance (Jehanzeb & Bashir, 2013). Therefore, the emphasis on continuous learning from 2018 to 2022 contributes to a positive employee-organization relationship.

However, the reduction in programs for enhancing employees' competencies may be perceived negatively by workers, as it could represent a lower commitment to their long-term professional growth. This could jeopardize worker relationships due to the perception of limited growth and learning opportunities.

Despite the focus on continuous learning, the lack of information on programs for career transition and end-of-career management presents a gap. This raises concerns about the report's transparency, as it may imply selective reporting by only including information that is beneficial for the company. This reinforces existing criticisms of sustainability reports as tools to manipulate stakeholder perceptions without significant improvements.

The percentage of employees who received regular performance and development evaluations increased, while the disparity between genders generally decreased, except in 2020 and 2021, when higher disparities were found. Lower-level hierarchical functional categories presented the lowest percentages of performance and development evaluation (Table 11).

Career development has a significant effect on job satisfaction (Zuhri et al., 2023), provides positive engagement at work (Robertson, 2013), and enables workers to advance within the organization (Loyarte-López et al., 2020).

The gender and hierarchical gaps found in regular performance and career de-

Table 11: Percentage of employees by gender and functional category that received regular performance and development on the career evaluation during the reporting period.

	2018			2019			2020			2021			2022			2023		
Categories	Men	Women	Total	Men	Women	Total	Men	Women	Total	Men	Women	Total	Men	Women	Total	Men	Women	Total
Board	59	60	59	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100
Higher Management	79	97	92	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100
Supervisors	71	61	69	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100
Administrative	77	68	73	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	100	99.83	99.86	99.84	99.83	99.86	99.84
Operational	8	8	9	16	12.76	14.81	39	18	30	48.67	24.71	38.81	83.66	74.92	79.96	83.66	74.92	79.96
Total	18	16	17	22.86	21.56	22.38	46	27	38	55.15	34.76	46.71	79.53	79.08	79.35	79.53	79.08	79.35

Source: The Author, 2024

velopment evaluations may negatively impact job satisfaction and career progression opportunities for women and lower-level workers. Therefore, based on the information from the reports, MeatCo should prioritize implementing more equitable practices to ensure fair evaluation of professional development for women and lower-level workers, thereby protecting its relationship with these employees.

4.3.4 Diversity and Equal Opportunity (GRI 405)

This disclosure presented mostly mixed results, with improvements and deteriorations within the same topic. The percentage of women in governance bodies and employee categories, broken down by gender, showed that female representation in governance bodies increased from 2019 to 2021, decreased in 2022, and increased again in 2023.

MeatCo has a very low percentage of women in governance bodies, including the board of directors, executive board, and fiscal council, compared to men, although there was a slight increase in female representation on the board of directors and executive board.

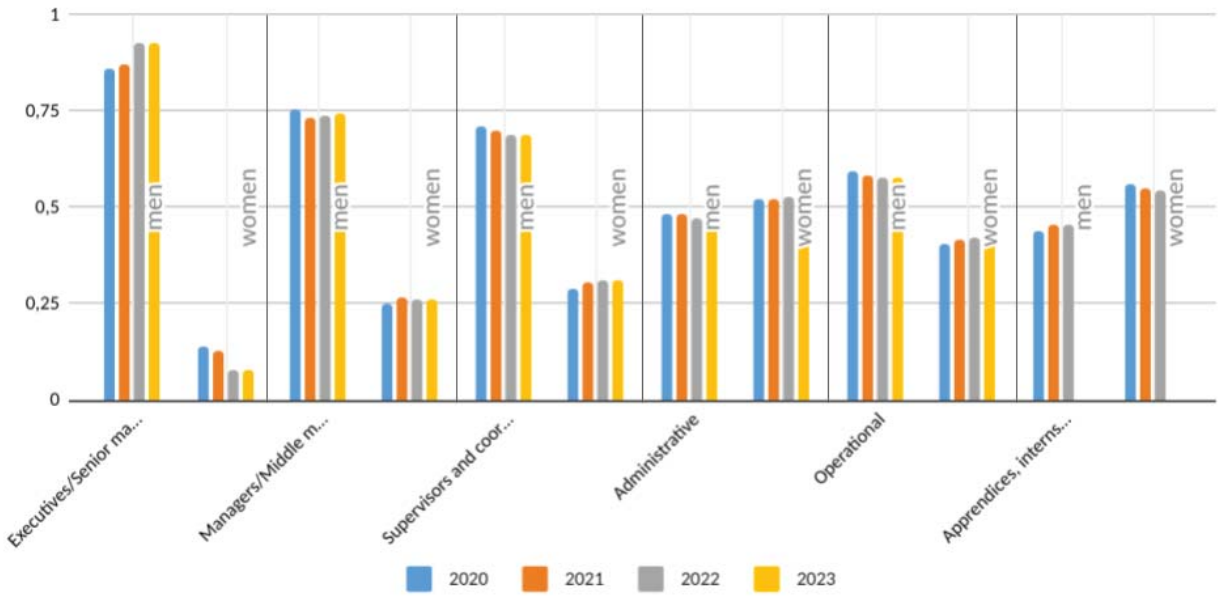
From 2019 to 2021, there was an increase in women in governance bodies, from 9.1% to 18.8%. However, this decreased to 7.6% in 2022 and increased again to 14.29% in 2023. On the board of directors, women comprised 10% in 2018 and 20% in 2020. On the executive board, women's representation rose from 0% in 2018 to 10% in 2020. On the fiscal council, it increased from 0% in 2018 to 23% in 2020.

At MeatCo, there is a substantial gender gap in higher-level hierarchical employee categories, where men significantly outnumber women. Conversely, women are predominant in the lowest hierarchical employee category (Figure 12).

In general, management positions are mainly composed of men (60.9%) (Cembranel et al., 2020). Even though women usually have higher qualifications than men, they face more barriers related to male-dominated codes for professional advancement (Miltersteiner et al., 2020).

Compared to the global scenario, in which women comprised 32% of senior leadership positions (director, vice-director, C-suite) in 2023, and when looking solely at C-suite positions, it drops to 25%, the annual representativity increases globally by 1% a year in leadership roles (World Economic Forum, 2023). MeatCo is far behind in

Figure 12: Percentage of employees per employee category by gender, MeatCo



Source: The Author, 2024.

achieving gender equality.

The analysis reveals a concerning lack of diversity in governance bodies and leadership positions at the company studied. Further efforts are needed to dismantle barriers and promote a more inclusive environment at all levels.

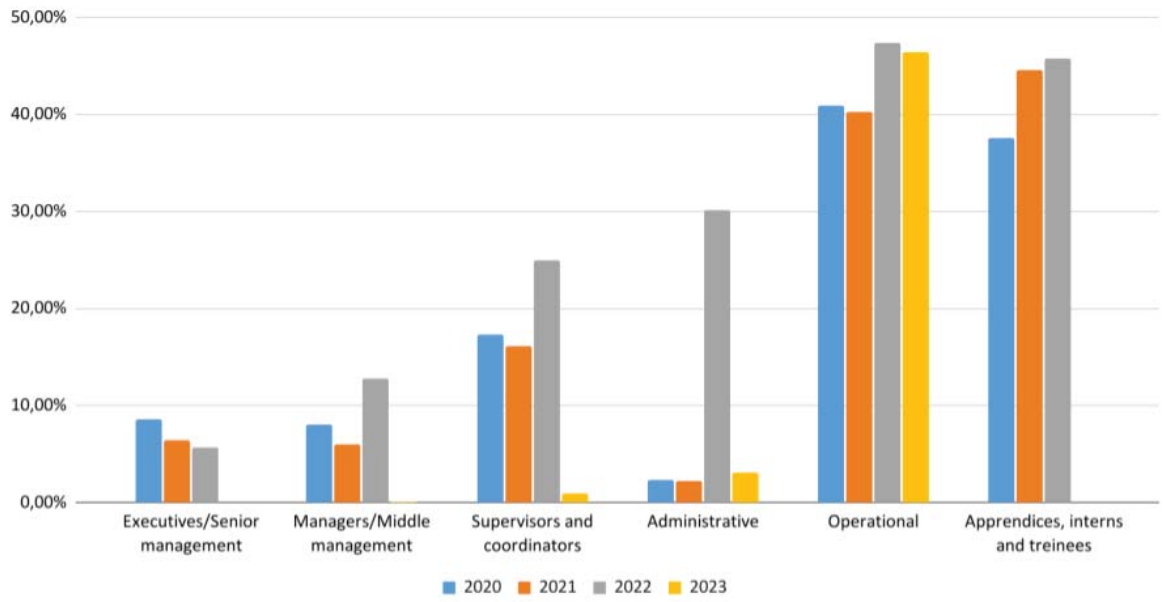
The presence of women in high-level hierarchical positions may present a conflict for stakeholders. The inclusion of women in governance could enhance social and environmental sustainability efforts, aligning with long-term sustainability goals (Bannò et al., 2023) and the values of certain stakeholders. However, according to Jeong and Harrison (2017) and P. M. Lee and James (2007) negative investor perceptions of women in C-level positions may create financial pressures that undermine or limit support for female leadership.

Regarding race, there were also mixed results. Throughout the reported years, there was a decrease in the participation of black and mixed-race individuals on the

board of directors, from 6.9% in 2020 to 5.7% in 2022. This information is not available for 2023.

An increase was observed among managers/middle management and supervisors/coordinators, and administrative staff from 2020 to 2022. However, there was a drastic decrease in supervisors, coordinators, and administrative staff in 2023. The number of operational staff, interns, apprentices, and trainees increased from 2020 to 2022 (Figure 13).

Figure 13: Percentage of blacks and mixed-race employees, MeatCo (2020-2023)



Source: The Author, 2024.

Therefore, a significant gap exists between white and black/mixed-race employees in higher hierarchical categories, where white employees are far more prevalent. This difference is significantly smaller at the lowest hierarchical levels (Figure 13).

A discrepancy in the results is found in the administrative category in 2022. While 2.27% of employees in this category were identified as Black or mixed race in 2021, this figure jumps to 30.11% in 2022 and then drops to 3.11% in 2023. This unusual

data may be due to errors in the preparation of the sustainability report, as it is unlikely that the participation of Black and mixed-race individuals in this position increased so dramatically in 2022 only to be followed by a significant decrease the following year.

Despite black and mixed-race people being a major part of the workforce in Brazil, they are a minority in managerial positions (29.5%) (IBGE, 2022), which are even less represented at MeatCO (25.8%). However, black women are the minority in leadership roles (Freitas et al., 2022). Therefore, the intersection of these minority groups would be important to track along with other minority groups.

The findings reveal a lack of diversity regarding race within the industry. Black and mixed-race individuals are significantly underrepresented, particularly in leadership positions. While there is a slight decrease in white employees over time, the overall picture remains one of racial disparity.

Considering intersectionality theory, which explains how the overlap of different diversity categories may result in greater disparities (McBride et al., 2015), further efforts are needed to increase opportunities and ensure equitable representation for racial minorities throughout the industry, especially at leadership levels. Investigating the intersection of race and gender, particularly for Black women, would provide a more accurate view of the situation of this specific population.

Regarding people with disabilities (PwD), there were also mixed results. The average representation from 2020 to 2022 shows that the employee category with the most PwD employees is executives/senior managers (5.2%), followed by operational staff with an average representation of 3%, supervisors and coordinators (1.8%), managers/middle management (1.5%), administrative staff (0.2%), and apprentices, interns, and trainees (0.1%). In general, there was an increase in their overall participation from 2.03% in 2020 to 2.3% in 2022.

However, in 2023, there was a significant decrease in their participation, with 0%

of PwD in executive/senior management positions. Supervisors had 0.08% representation, and managers/middle management had 0.02%. Only operational staff saw a slight increase in 2023 to 3.34%, with a drop in overall participation in 2023 to 1%.

There are different kinds and levels of disabilities, which may affect how disability impacts individuals' daily activities. In Brazil, PwD have less than half the occupation rate of those without disabilities, and their income is 69% of that of non-PwD individuals (IBGE, 2023). The analysis reveals low but slightly increasing representation of PwD employees at MeatCo until 2022, followed by a significant drop in 2023. Notably, PwD individuals are concentrated in higher-level employee categories, such as executives and senior managers.

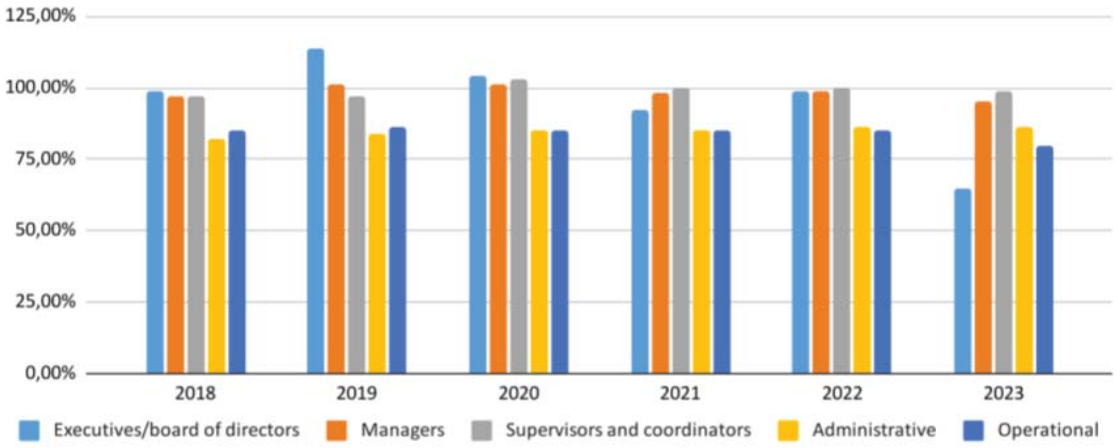
The proportion of base salary and remuneration received by women and men for each functional category by relevant operational units also presented mixed results. For executives/board of directors, there was close parity in most years, with women even earning more than men in some years until 2022. However, the disparity increased drastically in 2023.

In general, the higher the hierarchical level, the lower the pay gap (Figure 14).This finding aligns with those of de Sant'Anna et al. (2022) , suggesting that efforts to reduce pay disparities may be more effective at senior levels within organizations.

The average salary for women across all years and employee categories is 92% of men's salaries, a smaller difference than the average in Brazil. According to Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística (2024) , in 2024, women earned 78.9% of the salary of a man in the same position. However, further efforts are needed to achieve true pay equity.

The percentage of people who comprise governance bodies and employees by functional category and age group showed variation that cannot be classified as either improvement or deterioration. There was an increase in individuals above 50 years old

Figure 14: Ratio of the basic salary and remuneration of women to men for each employee category, by significant locations of operation



Source: The Author, 2024.

in all functional categories, except for trainees and apprentices, which saw an increase in workers aged 30-50. In all functional categories, the percentage of workers under 30 years old decreased (Table 12)

In 2023, MeatCo added information on the percentage of migrants and refugees in its employee categories. Migrants and refugees were present only in the administrative (0.01%) and operational (7.99%) categories.

Despite the improvement in report completeness from 2018 to 2023, the decrease in the representation of women, blacks and mixed-race people, and PwD individuals in executive and senior management positions from 2020 to 2023 represents a setback for diversity and equal opportunity. This may indicate a lack of organizational support for these groups to either achieve or maintain these positions.

Emily (2024) found that the gender pay gap has negative consequences in the

Table 12: Percentage of employees per employee category by age group, MeatCo (2019-2023)

Employee category	Age group	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023
Executives/Senior management	under 30 years old	0%	0%	0%	0%	0%
	30-50 years old	79.25%	79.31%	78.21%	75.47%	62.26%
	over 50 years old	20.75%	20.69%	21.79%	24.53%	37.74%
Managers/Middle management	under 30 years old	5.31%	2.33%	2.42%	1.61%	0.87%
	30-50 years old	85.91%	87.29%	88.67%	89.18%	84.99%
	over 50 years old	8.78%	10.38%	8.91%	9.21%	14.14%
Supervisors and coordinators	under 30 years old	9.79%	11.71%	10.02%	8.85%	8.00%
	30-50 years old	81.89%	80.60%	83.31%	83.20%	82.61%
	over 50 years old	8.32%	7.69%	6.67%	7.95%	9.39%
Administrative	under 30 years old	37.05%	38.13%	35.28%	35.50%	35.87%
	30-50 years old	57.41%	56.51%	60.48%	60.16%	58.57%
	over 50 years old	5.54%	5.36%	4.24%	4.34%	5.56%
Operational	under 30 years old	35.39%	36.24%	34.08%	31.60%	30.74%
	30-50 years old	53.54%	52.56%	55.60%	56.68%	54.65%
	over 50 years old	11.07%	11.20%	10.32%	11.72%	14.61%
Apprentices, interns and trainees	under 30 years old	99.00%	98.73%	98.94%	98.42%	no information
	30-50 years old	1.00%	1.27%	1.06%	1.58%	no information
	over 50 years old	0%	0%	0%	0%	no information

Source: The Author, 2024

workplace, as it reduces job satisfaction and trust in organizational fairness among female employees. This, in turn, lowers overall morale, leading to decreased motivation, engagement, and ultimately, lower productivity and higher turnover.

Therefore, the increased wage gap between genders in some work groups may also be seen as a setback for equal opportunities for women, which could affect worker engagement, productivity, and talent retention. Among external stakeholders, such as investors, the gender gap has also been shown to negatively affect their relationship with companies. Austin et al. (2021) found that investors are more willing to invest in companies with gender pay equity.

To improve its diversity and equal opportunities, as well as its relationships with stakeholders, MeatCo should strengthen policies and practices that promote continuous inclusion and equality of opportunity.

4.3.5 Non-discrimination (GRI 406)

The only year the company disclosed this topic was 2023. However, this year's report included information on the total number of discrimination incidents during the reporting period since 2021. From 2021 to 2023, the number of reported discrimination incidents nearly doubled, from 55 to 104. The status of these incidents and the actions taken were combined with data on other complaints, such as fraud and theft. Therefore, this information was not analyzed.

As there was an increase in the total number of incidents of discrimination during the reporting period, this topic was classified as presenting a decline over the years. However, the total number of incidents is not the most accurate measure, since the number of incidents may be related to the size of the workforce or awareness campaigns about the topic, which may lead to increased incident reporting or social awareness, not necessarily more incidents themselves. The increase in discrimination incidents itself demonstrates a worsening of this issue and necessitates action to reduce it.

Perceived discrimination in the workplace impacts organizational commitment, job satisfaction, and organizational citizenship behavior (Ensher et al., 2001). Therefore, reducing discrimination in the workplace should be an imperative for the company to strengthen the worker-company relationship.

4.3.6 Freedom of Association and Collective Bargaining (GRI 407)

From 2018 to 2022, the company did not disclose this information. In 2023, a statement clarified that there were no recorded instances of rights violations or risks to freedom of association and collective bargaining. Freedom of association and collective bargaining are essential rights for workers, as they protect and improve workers' conditions (Prasad, 2009). Having this information provided for only one year does not allow for a classification of trends over time and can lead to uncertainty among stakeholders, especially workers and unions, who may question whether the company monitors this risk consistently.

4.3.7 Child Labor (GRI 408) and Forced or Compulsory Labor (GRI 409)

Most topics within these disclosures presented no change. Information on operations and suppliers considered to have significant risks for incidents of child labor and forced or compulsory labor was provided only in 2021 and 2022, identifying agriculture and grains as the risk areas. Similarly, information on countries or geographic areas with operations and suppliers considered at risk was provided only in 2021 and 2022, identifying Brazil and overseas locations. These topics did not show any changes.

Information on operations and suppliers considered to have a significant risk for incidents of child labor, in terms of both the type of operation (such as a manufacturing plant) and the supplier, was only provided in 2022. Therefore, it was not possible to classify this topic.

The company presented improvements in the measures taken to contribute to the

effective abolition of child and forced labor. These improvements progressed from initial mitigation measures in 2021 to a solidified commitment through the establishment of a human rights corporate policy aimed at curbing occurrences of child and forced labor. In 2023, the company implemented a comprehensive, structured approach to monitoring its supply chain.

In 2021, the company claimed to have measures to mitigate these risks through regulations, reputation assessments, and historical reviews within its administrative processes related to child and forced labor.

In 2022, the company claimed to have a human rights corporate policy to curb occurrences of child and forced labor as part of its measures intended to contribute to the effective abolition of child labor. In 2023, the company introduced the ”Programa de Monitoramento de Cadeia,” a program to monitor its supply chain to inhibit child and forced labor.

Non-conformity with labor aspects can lead to a cultural rupture with stakeholders, including workers, and may negatively impact the organization’s reputation (Silveira et al., 2023). Therefore, the company’s approach to inhibiting child and forced labor is essential for maintaining healthy relationships with stakeholders and protecting its reputation.

4.3.8 Local Communities (GRI 413)

Most topics within this disclosure were not evaluated, as they were either not provided in any year or the information was provided in a single year, precluding comparison. This includes the percentage of operations with implemented local community engagement, impact assessments, and/or development programs, including the use of: social impact assessments (including gender impact assessments) based on participatory processes, environmental impact assessments and ongoing monitoring, public disclosure of results of environmental and social impact assessments, stakeholder en-

gagement plans based on stakeholder mapping, broad-based local community consultation committees and processes that include vulnerable groups, works councils, OHS committees, and other worker representation bodies to deal with impacts, and formal local community grievance processes. It was also not possible to classify operations with significant actual and potential negative impacts on local communities, including the location of operations.

One topic, the general percentage of operations with implemented local community engagement, impact assessments, and/or development programs, showed a decline. This is evidenced by the decrease from 91% in 2019, where operations benefited from local development programs and community engagement, to 53.25% in 2020, where operations were involved in community-focused engagement and impact assessments. However, from 2021 to 2023, the company again stopped reporting percentages and only listed the actions and locations involved.

Reporting on local community development programs based on local communities' needs showed improvement from 2019 onward. The company implemented programs to address food security, nutrition, and social inclusion, such as the "Cozinhas Solidárias" program and "Education for the Future" initiative, which continued and expanded in consecutive years with other projects and partnerships.

Reporting on the significant actual and potential negative impacts of operations showed no change, as it was mentioned only in 2019 and 2021, citing infrastructure challenges, risks of sexual exploitation of children and adolescents, and competition for resources with the community.

Despite the improvement in reporting on local community development programs based on local communities' needs, the lack of transparency on other topics and the reported decrease in the percentage of operations with implemented local community engagement suggest a missed opportunity to strengthen relationships with the local

community.

4.3.9 Supplier Social Assessment (GRI 414)

This disclosure also presented mostly topics that were not evaluated, as the information was provided in a single year only, precluding comparison. This includes key details such as the significant actual and potential negative social impacts identified in the supply chain, the percentage of suppliers identified as having significant actual and potential negative social impacts with which improvements were agreed upon as a result of assessment, the percentage of suppliers identified as having significant actual and potential negative social impacts with which relationships were terminated as a result of assessment, and the reasons for such terminations. The absence of this data limits the ability to assess trends or improvements over time.

Two topics showed improvement. The number of suppliers assessed for social impacts increased from 474 in 2018 to 35,225 in 2022. However, there was a lack of reported data in 2021 and 2023, indicating a potential gap in the reporting process or the unavailability of this data.

The number of suppliers identified as having significant actual and potential negative social impacts also improved, decreasing from six in 2021 to three in 2022. However, the information from 2018 to 2020 and 2023 lacks details on suppliers specifically identified with negative social impacts, indicating possible data gaps or unavailability of detailed analysis during those years.

The percentage of new suppliers screened using social criteria showed no change, as 100% of suppliers were screened using social criteria in all years except for 2021, when it was 98%.

The inconsistencies found in the company's reporting make it challenging to assess continuous progress and transparency in social impact assessments across the supply chain. As many unethical practices and violations originate with suppliers, social

sustainability issues need to be addressed through the adoption of social sustainability practices throughout the supply chain (Govindan et al., 2021). Considering that suppliers both affect and are affected by the organization, they are stakeholders whose compliance with the organization's standards must be ensured to mitigate operational and reputational risks.

4.3.10 Public Policy (GRI 415)

In 2018, the company did not disclose this topic. However, since 2019, the company has maintained a position of not engaging in any political contributions, in accordance with Brazilian legislation (Law No. 13,165/2015 from the Electoral Code). Therefore, this disclosure was classified as presenting no change.

Corporate contributions can pose threats to democracy by influencing policy in favor of donors and enabling the success of candidates who are not aligned with citizens' preferences (Peveri & Pardelli, 2024). Therefore, by not engaging in political contributions, the company may strengthen trust among stakeholders such as employees, investors, and clients, who may interpret this as a commitment to business ethics.

4.3.11 Customer Health and Safety (GRI 416)

Most topics in this disclosure showed no change, such as the percentage of significant product and service categories for which health and safety impacts were assessed for improvement. Since 2019, 100% of the products have been assessed for improvement. However, the total number of incidents of non-compliance with regulations and/or voluntary codes concerning the health and safety impacts of products and services was only mentioned in 2018 and 2022, with zero incidents in both years.

Additionally, the total number of incidents of non-compliance with regulations resulting in fines or penalties showed a concerning increase, nearly doubling from 2018 to 2023. This increase in non-compliance indicates a lack of adherence to regula-

tions, which could undermine consumer trust, as consumers expect products that meet health and safety standards.

However, the total number of incidents of non-compliance with regulations and/or voluntary codes concerning the health and safety impacts of products and services within the reporting period in general decreased from 165 in 2018 to 70 in 2020.

Lastly, the total number of incidents of non-compliance with regulations and/or voluntary codes concerning the health and safety impacts of products and services within the reporting period, by incidents of non-compliance with voluntary codes, were provided only in 2020, 2022, and 2023 with slight variations from 70 to 0 and 75, respectively. The lack of disclosure of some information in some years may suggest inconsistencies in the organization's efforts to address and be transparent on the topic, which may concern the impacted stakeholders.

4.3.12 Marketing and Labeling (GRI 417)

Most topics presented no change, as all those that comprise the information required by the organization's procedures for product and service information and labeling, as well as the sourcing of components of the product or service, show no change over the years.

Regarding the sourcing of components of products for product and service information and labeling, the organization appears to have a consistent procedure for checking sourcing compliance, ensuring alignment with internal standards and regulations with verification of all materials and packaging.

The content, particularly regarding substances that might produce an environmental or social impact, is screened and compliant with regulations, reviewed by multiple departments from 2018 to 2021. About the safe use of the product or service, the company claims that labeling addresses safe use from 2018 to 2021. During 2022 and 2023, the company did not provide this information.

Over the years, labeling has consistently informed users about recycling and disposal. Product packaging includes recycling instructions in accordance with ABNT NBR 13230 standards. Additional information is included regarding specific markets (e.g., Halal certification, recycling symbols, health and animal welfare details). This additional content helps meet the needs of diverse market regulations and customer expectations. From 2019 onward, 100% of products, raw materials, and packaging are assessed for compliance, ensuring that labeling meets legal and safety requirements.

The company's approach to product and service information and labeling has consistently met or exceeded the prevailing standards throughout the reporting period. This sustained adherence to best practices indicates that the existing protocols are robust and effective, leaving minimal scope for improvement within the current framework. Therefore, maintaining this high level of compliance is recommended rather than implementing further changes.

Three topics presented improvements, as the total number of incidents of non-compliance with regulations and/or voluntary codes concerning product and service information and labeling decreased from 60 in 2019 to one in 2023. Incidents of non-compliance with regulations resulting in a warning also improved by their decrease from 54 in 2019 to zero in 2022. However, this information was not available in the other years. The total number of incidents of non-compliance with regulations and/or voluntary codes concerning marketing communications, including advertising, promotion, and sponsorship, also decreased from four in 2020 to two in 2023.

Other three topics presented regressions, as the total number of incidents of non-compliance with regulations resulting in a fine or penalty increased from six in 2019 to 13 in 2020, not informed in the other years. Incidents of non-compliance with voluntary codes also increased from zero in 2022 to one in 2023. The same with incidents of non-compliance with voluntary codes, which increased from zero in 2022 to two in

2023.

The number of incidents of non-compliance with regulations resulting in a fine or penalty and a warning were informed only in 2020, not allowing a comparison through time.

The consistent approach to product and service information and labeling has fully addressed the expected standards over the years. This strong foundation, coupled with improvements in several key areas, demonstrates a dedicated effort towards better compliance. These improvements include addressing non-compliance with regulations and voluntary codes concerning product and service information, as well as reducing incidents of non-compliance resulting in warnings. Furthermore, progress has been made in addressing non-compliance related to marketing communications, including advertising, promotion, and sponsorship.

However, some setbacks highlight an unbalanced approach that may compromise the trust of clients, investors, and regulators. Therefore, the company could have a more balanced and consistent approach in its conformity practices to guarantee those incidents to be minimized and that stakeholders' relationships are not harmed by a lack of transparency or regulatory violations.

4.3.13 Customer Privacy (GRI 418)

Customer privacy has improved over the years. From 2018 to 2020, this information is not provided. In 2021, the total number of substantiated complaints received concerning breaches of customer privacy was seven, all of which were from outside parties and substantiated by the organization. In 2022 and 2023, the company registered no complaints or events involving violations of privacy or loss of client data.

The absence of complaints or privacy violations in 2022 and 2023 suggests that, following the complaints in 2021, the company implemented effective corrective actions. This is crucial for maintaining client trust and mitigating risks to its reputation.

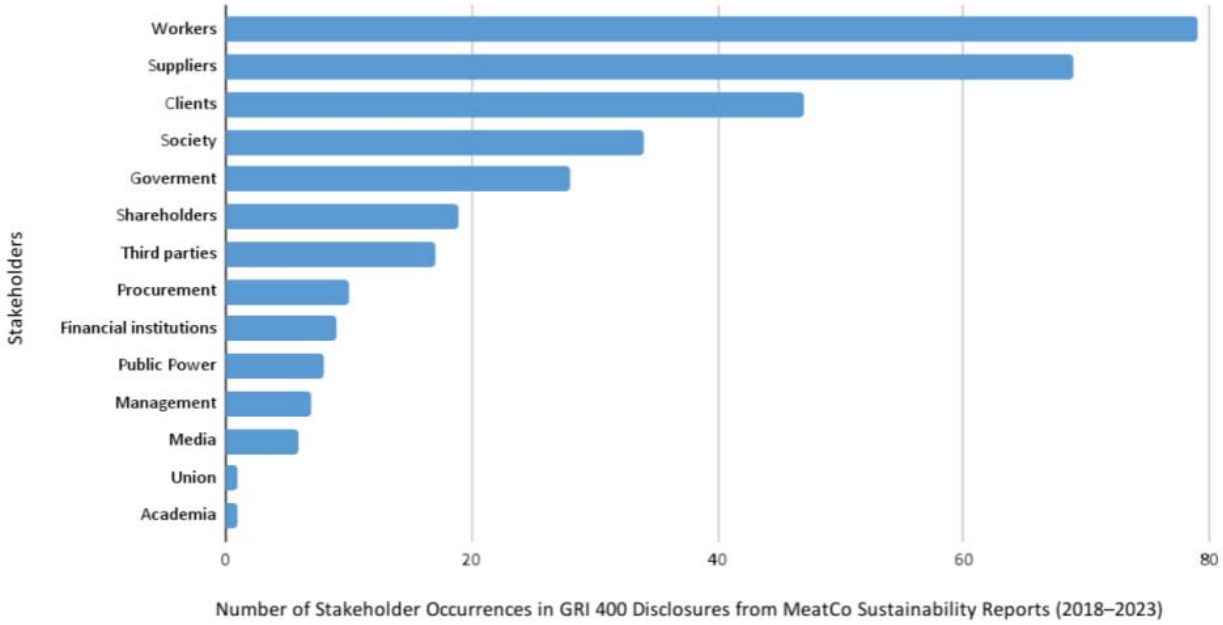
Therefore, it is vital for the company to continue its commitment to zero privacy issues to preserve customer confidence and safeguard its reputation.

4.4 STAKEHOLDER IDENTIFICATION AND ANALYSIS IN MEATCO'S SOCIAL SUSTAINABILITY REPORTS

This section focuses on the identification and analysis of stakeholders mentioned in the sustainability reports as being impacted by and causing an impact on the organization's social sustainability indicators.

The most recurring stakeholder identified as impacted by the organization was workers, followed by suppliers, clients, society, government, shareholders, third parties, procurement, financial institutions, public power, management, media, unions, and academia (Figure 15).

Figure 15: Frequency of Stakeholder Appearances as Impacted by the Organization in GRI 400 Disclosures from MeatCo Sustainability Reports (2018–2023)



Source: The Author, 2024.

Workers are the most frequently mentioned stakeholders as impacted by the organization across the reports. This highlights the company's awareness of worker-related

issues, mainly in OHS (GRI 403), training and education (GRI 404), and diversity and equal opportunities (GRI 405).

OHS appear to have mainly improved through the years, while training and education and diversity and equal opportunities presented mostly mixed results. This may suggest that the company has enhanced its commitment to satisfying workers' needs.

Workers are considered an important stakeholder mainly due to their impact on other stakeholders (Crane, 2020). Their perception of the company's efforts in OHS training and education, and diversity and equal opportunities may impact their relationship with the company.

Suppliers were the second most mentioned impacted stakeholder. This demonstrates the company's awareness of its impact on suppliers, mainly related to child and forced labor (GRI 408 and 409) and supplier social assessment (GRI 414). Social performance is a matter of great concern in the buyer-supplier relationship (Asif, 2020). At MeatCo, suppliers were highly affected by the organization's policies that require suppliers to adhere to ethical practices.

Child and forced labor presented mostly no change in their approach over time. However, supplier social assessment presented mostly improvements, as it increased the number of suppliers assessed for social impact and decreased the number of suppliers with a negative impact.

Many unethical practices and violations originate with suppliers, social sustainability issues need to be addressed through the adoption of social sustainability practices throughout the supply chain (Govindan et al., 2021). Considering that, they must comply with the organization's standards to mitigate operational and reputational risks.

Clients were the third most mentioned impacted stakeholder. This highlights the company's awareness of client-related issues, mainly in customer health and safety (GRI 416), requirements for product service, information and labeling (GRI 417), and

customer privacy (GRI 418).

Customer health and safety requirements for product service, information, and labeling presented mostly no changes in their indicators, with only improvements in customer privacy. Despite that, most customer health and safety requirements for product service, information, and labeling have already had the most successful approaches. This suggests that, unlike workers, customers have previously been more consistently regarded as essential stakeholders for the company's success, with their expectations generally met earlier on.

This is contradictory to the company's previous history with the usage of supposedly carcinogenic products to sell rotten meat investigated by Operation Carne Fraca, which began in 2017 (Linear Comunicação, 2017), in which the company was entitled to pay a fine and implement an improvement plan in their Integrity Program [MeatCo,2023].

The approach to customer issues, with a considerably favorable approach towards clients, may be part of the company's approach to "reinforce Integrity, Quality and Safety as non-negotiable requirements of our way of working" [MeatCo,2018, p.47], mainly as an answer to the high number of negative media given to this topic (Linear Comunicação, 2017).

Therefore, the company's focus on customers appears to be a strategic response to the reputational damage from the Carne Fraca scandal. By focusing on customers, it may signal an attempt by the organization to rebuild customer trust and portray itself as reliable despite the heightened scrutiny of the company and industry.

Society appeared in fourth place as the most recurrent stakeholder impacted by the organization, mainly related to local communities (GRI 413). As the topic presented declines, improvements, and no change in its indicators equally, the expansion of initiatives with new projects and partnerships over the years demonstrates an improvement in the society-company relationship. On the other hand, the diminishing

percentage of operations with implemented local community engagement, impact assessments, and/or development programs reflects an inconsistent commitment to community and social engagement. This inconsistency can negatively impact communities, as community-based programs are essential for the targeted communities (Ceptureanu et al., 2018).

Government appeared in fifth place as the most recurrent stakeholder impacted by the organization, mainly in the OHS (GRI 403) and local community (GRI 413) disclosures. However, the company claims to impact the government related to its OHS in its materiality matrix, considering it at its ”limits of impacts” outside the company [MeatCo,2021, p.7], without further explanation.

There was an identified positive and negative impact on the government. The negative impact on the government was highlighted by the company through increased strain on infrastructure and public services, which has led to challenges such as resource competition, road infrastructure stress, and exposure of vulnerable groups, particularly children and adolescents, to exploitation risks along highways. The company's positive impact is through partnerships with educational departments, like the Secretariat of Education in Vitória de Santo Antão, which have enabled initiatives to improve school meal programs and reduce food waste.

In developing countries, public-private partnerships are used to extend services usually considered a government responsibility (Saidu & Kwahar, 2024). Despite several challenges faced in public-private partnerships, such as navigating complex regulatory frameworks, financial uncertainties, and cultural and organizational differences that lead to divergent priorities and decision-making processes, these collaborations promote innovation, knowledge sharing, and improved societal outcomes (Ebulue et al., 2024).

Shareholders, strategic partners, and third parties presented a more moderate re-

currence. Shareholders' main impact was through customer health and safety (GRI 416), which has shown no changes in its indicators over time. Shareholders were solely considered as impacted by the organization according to its own materiality matrix, with no further explanation. However, considering customers as impacted by this topic and the company's negative history due to Carne Fraca and how it was related to higher drops in stocks as negative news on this topic arose (de Sousa et al., 2021), it can be inferred that shareholders are indirectly impacted by MeatCo's performance in areas related to customer health and safety.

Strategic partners' main impact was through local communities (GRI 413), which simultaneously presented topics with decline, improvement, and no change. The organization's strategic partnerships span a range of NGOs, social organizations, educational institutions, and government-linked entities, all focused on social transformation and community support.

Key partners include Gastromotiva, SESC's Mesa Brasil Program, Comida Invisível, Unicef, Ayrton Senna Institute, Gama Academy, Digital House, Quintessa, Prosas, José Egydio Setúbal Foundation, and governmental and tech-driven collaborations, such as with GovTech Lemobs. These strategic partners are impacted by the organization by benefiting from organizational support.

Third parties' (contractors and outsourced workers) main impact was through OHS (GRI 403), which showed mostly improvements over time. Third parties are impacted by organizations as they are subject to the organization's OHS protocols. They receive training like employees and are also covered by the company's safety management systems.

Other stakeholders, such as procurement, financial institutions, public power, management, and media, appeared less frequently as impacted stakeholders, noted only within the organization's materiality matrix. Their roles were linked to different disclo-

sures but without further explanation of the specific impacts or interactions with the company.

Unions and academia appeared only once. The organization's impact on unions appeared in the disclosure on freedom of association and collective bargaining (GRI 407), as the company can uphold rights related to freedom of association and collective bargaining since the organization actively ensures that union rights are respected and that open dialogue is promoted across operational regions. However, it was not possible to classify the topic related to its evolution or regression due to a lack of information, which may demonstrate the company's minimal effort toward fulfilling this stakeholder's needs.

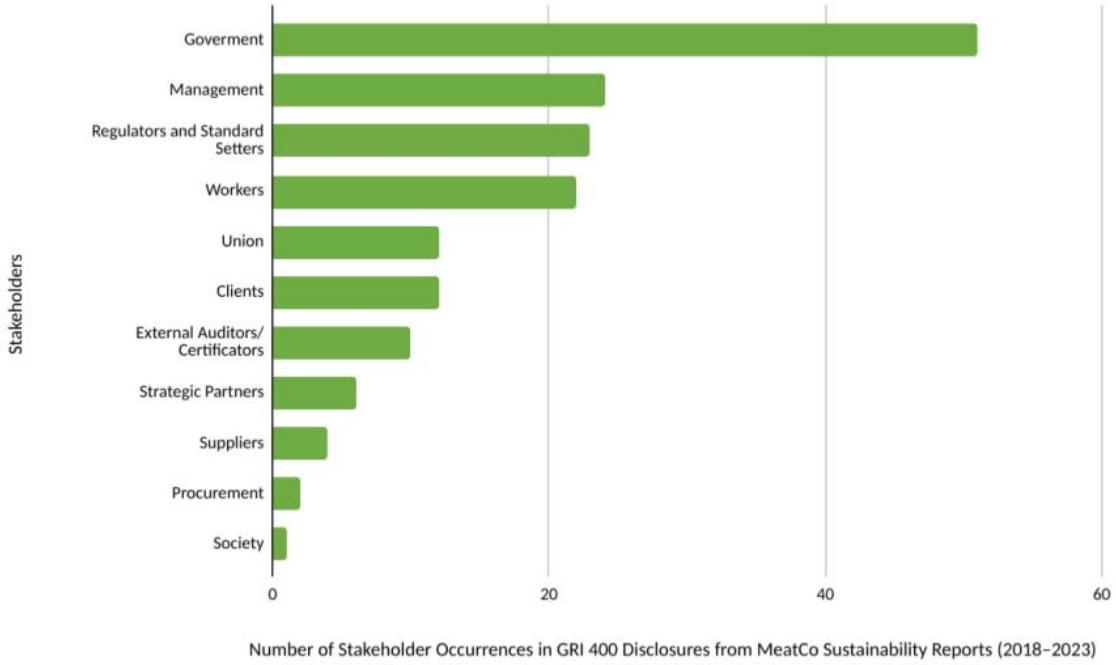
Academia was only impacted by the company related to local communities (GRI 413) due to its participation with the company in two scientific academic articles published about food loss and waste in 2022 and another to be published in 2024, according to the 2023 report, demonstrating a more recent relationship.

MeatCo's sustainability reports from 2018 to 2023 demonstrate a varied approach to stakeholders impacted by the organization, with workers, suppliers, and clients receiving the most consistent attention. The company's emphasis on these stakeholders may reflect the GRI framework itself, not necessarily the company's prioritization.

The most recurring stakeholder identified as causing an impact on the organization was the government, followed by management, regulators and standard-setters, workers, unions, clients, external auditors/certifiers, strategic partners, suppliers, procurement, and society (Figure 16).

The government is the most frequently mentioned stakeholder that causes an impact on the organization across the reports. This highlights its role in organizational social sustainability practices, mainly in OHS (GRI 403) and requirements for product and service information and labeling (GRI 417).

Figure 16: Frequency of Stakeholder Appearances as Causing Impact in the Organization in GRI 400 Disclosures from MeatCo Sustainability Reports (2018–2023)



Source: The Author, 2024.

OHS appear to have mainly improved through the years, while requirements for product and service information and labeling presented mostly no change in their indicators. This may suggest that the company has enhanced its commitment to complying with government rules, mainly those toward employees through laws and regulations such as NR (Brazil's Regulatory Norms) and NBR 14280, which impact the organization by setting mandatory health and safety standards.

Since the company has maintained a steady approach to product and service information and labeling requirements, it consistently meets government regulations related to customer standards. From 2018 onward, MeatCo has complied with both national and international labeling requirements, covering recycling and allergen information for markets such as Brazil and aligning with specific regional requirements, like packaging standards for the European Community and labeling for exports to China. Failure to

meet these standards could result in fines, penalties, or warnings.

Management was the second most mentioned stakeholder as causing an impact on the company. This demonstrates its large role in organizational social sustainability practices, mainly related to OHS (GRI 403) and employment (GRI 401).

Managers were represented by Employee Health and Safety (EHS) Committees of Vice-Presidents, Regional Management/Directors, Boards and Units/Executives and Business Units, Executive Committee with Vice-Presidencies, Health and Safety Work Board, and Operational Committee, mentioned by the company in its report as being part of a structured system of various levels of health and safety committees and forums that ensure the monitoring and control of work across all areas and processes. Their role in the overall governance of health and safety indicates that they have a significant influence on the organization's practices and operations.

The company claims to provide employment-related benefits to employees, both voluntary and mandatory under collective bargaining agreements. Considering that collective negotiation agreements are normative instruments resulting from employee and employer unions to represent each party's wishes (P. S. Martins & Saraiva, 2020), managers were included as related stakeholders who impact the organization through their decisions regarding employee benefits.

Regulators and Standard Setters were the third most mentioned stakeholder as causing an impact on the company. This demonstrates their large role in organizational social sustainability practices, mainly related to OHS (GRI 403), and Marketing and Labeling (GRI 417).

Regulators and standardizers such as OSHA and ABNT also influence the organization through the application of specific OHS standards, which help calculate injury rates and manage safety risks. The system of rules applied in the calculation method was the Brazilian standard NBR 14280, and the indicators are managed in accordance

with Corporate Standard NC 20.1.003, Investigating Accidents, Incidents, and Deviations. ISO (ISO 31000) has also been shown to shape MeatCo's health and safety practices.

According to Abbott and Snidal (2021) , the state has been seen as the major regulator of businesses. However, considering the globalization of production, its reach is limited. Therefore, international regulations and standards emerge to fill this gap. Those standards influence managerial practices (Weaver & Clark, 2015) through their expertise and enforcement by public and private actors (Kerwer, 2005).

OSHA is the Occupational Safety and Health Administration from the United States, established to protect workers' safety and health since 1970, which provides standards, which are regulations to improve workplace health and safety (Reid, 2022).

NBR 14280 is a norm on work accidents, register procedures, and classification developed by the Brazilian Association of Technical Norms [Associação Brasileira de Normas Técnicas - ABNT], whose goal is to identify and register related labor accident facts to provide orientation to prevention without indicating corrective measures or reference to the causes of the accidents (ABNT, 2001).

ISO 31000 provides guidelines on managing risks faced by organizations. Its process consists of the systematic "application of policies, procedures, and practices to the activities of communicating and consulting, establishing the context and assessing, treating, monitoring, reviewing, recording, and reporting risk" (International Organization for Standardization, 2018, p. 8).

Standard setters such as ABNT NBR 13230 influence how MeatCo designs its product packaging to include instructions on recycling categories, ensuring that consumers are informed of proper disposal methods to reduce environmental impact. Compliance with this standard affects MeatCo's labeling, packaging design, and potentially its production processes, as each packaging component must be clearly categorized

for recycling. This alignment helps the organization meet regulatory expectations and supports its environmental responsibility efforts.

Standard setters and regulators influence the organization's context, which guides how situations are structured, such as managerial practices toward more ethical behaviors (Weaver & Clark, 2015). Therefore, MeatCo's compliance with national and international standards and regulators demonstrates its efforts related to an ethical approach in its operations and management.

Workers were the fourth most mentioned stakeholder as causing an impact on the company. This demonstrates their large role in organizational social sustainability practices, mainly related to employment (GRI 401) and OHS (GRI 403).

Considering that Collective Negotiation Agreements are normative instruments that result from employees and employers unions to represent each party's wishes (P. S. Martins & Saraiva, 2020), employees were considered related stakeholders who impact the organization through their decisions regarding employee benefits.

Employees, through collective bargaining representation, influence the shaping of labor policies and decisions. This perspective on employees influencing the organization through collective bargaining is evident across all reports, highlighting their position in shaping and being shaped by the organization's approach to labor-related issues.

Based on human capital theory, employees represent human capital, without which the company would be unable to function (Puri & Borok, 2002). Therefore, their expectations should be considered just as much as those of financial capital investors. This aligns with ST, which advocates for managing the interests of all stakeholders (Tjahjadi et al., 2024). Additionally, employees share the same interests as the company and shareholders in the company's growth and profitability, seeking to enjoy the returns on their investments (Puri & Borok, 2002).

Unions and clients were the fifth most mentioned stakeholders as causing an impact

on the company. This demonstrates the union's role in organizational social sustainability practices, mainly related to employment (GRI 401), OHS (GRI 403), and diversity and equal opportunities (GRI 405). Clients' roles are linked to customer health and safety (GRI 416) and marketing and labeling (GRI 417).

Considering that Collective Negotiation Agreements are normative instruments that result from employees and employers unions to represent each party's wishes (P. S. Martins & Saraiva, 2020). Unions were considered related stakeholders who impact the organization through their decisions regarding employee benefits. Unions cause impacts in the organization through collective bargaining agreements, with a particular emphasis on how these agreements shape employee benefits and labor relations.

Unions participate in ongoing dialogue with the company to ensure safety measures meet legal and worker expectations. As an example, in 2020, the company disclosed its commitment to an "open and constant dialogue with unions, federations, confederations, and class entities that represent them. This is true for the various professional categories" [MeatCo,2020, p.129]. This implies that labor influences do exert pressure on the company's operations and policies.

Trade can be seen as a driver of social sustainability by promoting employee welfare, training, and socially responsible industrial restructuring (Preuss et al., 2006). Therefore, their involvement ensures that the company meets employees' expectations, which are important to fulfill. Just like financial investors, human capital investment is essential for a company's long-term viability (Puri & Borok, 2002).

Based on MeatCo's reports, its clients are impacted by the company's customer health and safety regulatory compliance, which, when non-compliant, results in fines and penalties, leading them to cause an impact on the company that faces repercussions from regulatory bodies. The organization is also influenced by clients due to the need to meet specific standards for specific markets, such as Islamic markets, espe-

cially Halal certification. This requirement reflects the organization's response to client demands in regions where Islamic dietary standards are critical.

Considering that the quality of a firm's relationship with clients shows a significant correlation with customer reputation, where how customers are treated by the company impacts whether they will continue using its products (Brønn, 2007), addressing client expectations related to health and safety, as well as the specific needs of different markets, allows MeatCo to foster a strong relationship with its clients.

External auditors/certifiers and strategic partners were less frequently mentioned as causing an impact on the organization. External auditors/certifiers were only mentioned in relation to OHS (GRI 403) and Marketing and Labeling (GRI 417). Strategic partners' most significant impact was related to Local Communities (GRI 413).

External auditors/certifiers' roles involve verifying compliance with standards, which can lead to changes in organizational processes, policies, and systems to meet those standards (Prajogo et al., 2020). The organization is required to adhere to the criteria set by these external parties, and their audits can have significant impacts on operations, certifications, and overall performance. Therefore, they have a direct influence on the organization's actions and outcomes.

Schilling-Vacaflor et al. (2021) argue that external audits, while presenting some inherent flaws due to the use of private firms to monitor company actions, are considered a legitimate mechanism for enforcing social sustainability. Therefore, external audits increase the credibility of company sustainability reports (Friske et al., 2023). Hence, they are crucial to an organization's overall commitment to transparency and accountability in its social sustainability efforts.

Based on the reports, certifiers impact MeatCo's product offerings, mainly when targeting specific markets, which leads to a need to align the company with the requirements of those markets, such as culturally and religiously significant markets, ensuring

that the products meet the expectations of these regions.

Even though the effectiveness of certifications has been questioned due to a lack of data on how they function in specific contexts (Schilling-Vacaflor et al., 2021), certifications can enable stronger brand assurance, stakeholder satisfaction, competitive development, and capabilities to contribute to improving social sustainability practices (Chkanikova & Robert, 2021). Therefore, applying for certifications can enhance the organization's reputation as socially sustainable in the market.

Strategic partners are considered to impact the organization, as their collaboration in implementing social initiatives has enhanced the company's community impact. This approach is extremely important to address social sustainability issues, as it is not possible for a single company to address complex problems (MacDonald et al., 2022).

Suppliers, procurement, and society were the least mentioned stakeholders as causing an impact on the organization. Suppliers were only mentioned in relation to child (GRI 408) and forced labor (GRI 409). Many unethical practices and violations originate with suppliers. Therefore, social sustainability issues need to be addressed through the adoption of social sustainability practices throughout the supply chain (Govindan et al., 2021). Considering this, suppliers can significantly impact the organization on those topics, as any non-compliance or unethical labor practices among suppliers pose ethical, legal, and reputational risks for the organization.

Procurement was only mentioned in relation to marketing and labeling (GRI 417). Procurement is an activity or process related to obtaining goods and services in the company (Masudin et al., 2021). In MeatCo, they are internal stakeholders who impact the organization by ensuring that all materials used in manufacturing comply with current legislation and pass multiple levels of internal approval through procurement departments.

Society was only mentioned in relation to non-discrimination (GRI 406). It may im-

pact the organization through the transparency channel, as it has access to a channel to report any discrimination-related concerns. Society's expectations for firms to act responsibly have risen (Lépineux, 2005), and a company's social performance may be in response to social pressures, which can be delivered by activists (Baron, 2009). Its peripheral role in impacting the organization demonstrates a gap in MeatCo's stakeholder engagement by underemphasizing societal expectations that can drive shifts in social sustainability in the company.

MeatCo's sustainability reports from 2018 to 2023 demonstrate a varied approach to stakeholders that impact the organization, with the government, management, regulators, and standard-setters causing the most impact on the organization's social sustainability indicators.

Their strong influence can highlight that the company's social sustainability indicators are addressed primarily to meet regulatory requirements rather than a proactive commitment to social sustainability because these stakeholders establish the legal and operational frameworks that the company must adhere to, indicating a compliance-driven approach, which may lead to missed opportunities for deeper, more proactive engagement with stakeholders for more effective measures toward social sustainability in the organization (Miller & Serafeim, 2014).

5 DISCUSSION

As argued by Crane (2020) , transparency and trust are needed with all stakeholders. Despite the overall improvement in completeness in social sustainability reports and indicators, there was still a lack of information regarding certain topics. For example, the way the company guarantees access to and the quality of its occupational health services may lead to concern about the company's transparency and trust with impacted stakeholders.

Lashitew (2021) already mentioned that sustainability reports could be used as a tool to manipulate stakeholders' perceptions of the company without actual improvements. Therefore, the lack of information jeopardizes transparency, since it may infer a selective report by reporting only what is beneficial for the company, reinforcing that criticism.

Sometimes, the evolution with increased completeness on a certain topic is accompanied by a setback on the social sustainability indicator itself. For example, regarding the ratio of basic salary and remuneration of women to men (GRI 405-2), despite an improvement in report completeness from 2018 to 2023, at the executive/board of directors level for most years, there was close parity, with some years where women were even paid more than men until 2022. In 2023 the disparity increased drastically. Among managers and operational groups until 2022, the pay gap was narrowing, in 2023, it increased.

This demonstrates that in studies on social sustainability to identify if there is a progression of social sustainability in organizations, solely analyzing the completeness of the reports is not enough, as this information reflects improvements in transparency or reporting mechanisms, but without deeper scrutiny into how the practices translate into real-world changes, this analysis may mask underlying regressions.

Several studies have used the GRI framework. However, they were limited to mea-

suring the level of detail companies provided at each topic disclosure rather than their actual sustainability performance. For example, Jadhav et al. (2020) used the GRI framework to relate sustainability disclosures to companies' financial performance. Absar et al. (2021) investigated the most disclosed topics regarding resource-human capital under the GRI standards. Yadava and Sinha (2016) , based on GRI guidelines, compared public and private sector companies' performance on sustainability.

Considering that one of the purposes of GRI standards is to allow academics and analysts to use the reported information for research or benchmarking (GRI, 2021), some aspects of the standards could benefit from further development and enhancement for this purpose.

One of the weaknesses found in the reports analyzed is that the standards change over time, which leads to the discontinuation of information on some topics, jeopardizing the analysis of evaluation over time. This was also highlighted by Pina et al. (2023) during the comparison between two companies. Therefore, a longer timeframe for analysis could help provide a more accurate evaluation. Other forms of improvement in the standard itself should be considered to maintain the continuation of information.

Some information required is in gross numbers, which may mask the actual information. For example, The total number of employees who returned to work in the reporting period after parental leave ended, and the total number of employees who returned to work after parental leave ended that were still employed 12 months after their return, were not analyzed. This information does not allow for accurate analysis due to several factors.

Employees may begin their parental leave in one year and return in the following. This time lag complicates the analysis, as the reporting period may not fully capture the parental leave cycle for all employees. For example, an employee who starts parental leave in December may return in April of the next year, leading to discrepancies in the

data if only annual figures are considered.

The most accurate analysis would be based on percentages, not gross numbers. This timing discrepancy may distort the analysis, as it can lead to undercounting or overcounting returns and retentions, creating a misleading view of the leave and return patterns. Therefore, this is a limitation imposed by the disclosure framework.

Additionally, the lack of clarity about some indicators leads to difficulties during the development of the report, a difficulty also found in Quilice et al. (2018) research. In the reports analyzed, it may have impacted how some information was not clearly comparable across years at the same company, since the information on some topics was based on different regional units each year, making it difficult to evaluate accurately, as yearly variations may be due to changes in the regions used to report the data, rather than actual differences in the results themselves.

Proactive engagement with stakeholders is required for more effective measures toward social sustainability in the organization (Miller & Serafeim, 2014). Overall, MeatCo's sustainability practices are largely shaped by the need to comply with external regulations, which indicates that while compliance is a strong driver, there may be missed opportunities for deeper, more proactive engagement with stakeholders.

Regulators and standard-setters were the most recurrent stakeholders mentioned as causing an impact on Occupational Health and Safety (GRI 403). The government was the most recurrent stakeholder mentioned as causing an impact on training and education (GRI 404) and customer privacy (GRI 418). Those were the same topics that presented the most improvements in their indicators.

As proposed by Miller and Serafeim (2014) Miller and Serafeim (2014), to drive meaningful change, MeatCo should focus not only on enhancing the completeness of its reports but also on fostering deeper engagement with stakeholders and ensuring that sustainability practices lead to tangible, long-lasting improvements across its

operations.

6 FINAL CONSIDERATIONS

Several practices in the meat and derivatives sector raise concerns related to social sustainability, mainly related to land grabbing (Varrotti et al., 2022), disrespect for Indigenous rights (Bowman et al., 2021), negative health effects on workers (De-Assis et al., 2021) and local communities (Fan et al., 2020), poor working conditions (Freshour, 2019), and child labor (Dreier, 2023).

While demand for ethical products has increased (McKinsey & NielsenIQ, 2023), global meat consumption has also risen (González et al., 2020), with Brazilian companies playing an increasingly significant role as suppliers (Binotti & Bertolini, 2023). However, maintaining this position requires navigating various shifts in the global economy. Beyond profit-related factors, Brazilian meat suppliers must also meet the social expectations of their buyers (Sehnem et al., 2012).

Considering that ST has been the most used theoretical background to facilitate understanding the influence, consequences, concerns, and perspectives of different stakeholders regarding business social sustainability practices, this study aimed to examine how the social sustainability practices of a company in the meat and derivatives sector have evolved over time, as well as how these practices have both influenced and been shaped by relationships with stakeholders.

For this purpose, one company was selected based on its potential to provide the most comprehensive and consistent sustainability reports, considering three characteristics: how long the company has released GRI-based sustainability reports, how long the company has been part of the ISE portfolio, and which company had better positions in ISE rankings, which led to the selection of a company fictitiously named MeatCo.

MeatCo's sustainability reports from 2018 to 2023 were analyzed, considering GRI 400 standards, which are GRI's social sustainability indicators. The analysis was based

on the identification of social sustainability indicators presented in the sustainability reports, an examination of the consistency, transparency, and comprehensiveness of the GRI-based reports over the years, an assessment of whether these social sustainability indicators have changed over time, focusing on improvements or deteriorations, and a determination of which stakeholders were referenced in the social sustainability reports of the company.

The social sustainability indicators presented in the sustainability reports comprised most of the GRI 400 topics, excluding some disclosures that were not in the company's material topics. That was the case for GRI 402 (Labor/Management Relations), GRI 410 (Security Practices) and GRI 411 (Right of Indigenous People).

The exclusion of these disclosures as material themes would suggest that they neither impact nor are impacted by the company's sustainable development. However, the violation of Indigenous rights in Brazil is a key issue that raises concerns regarding social sustainability in this sector (Bowman et al., 2021). Therefore, it is crucial for the company to address this topic in its sustainability reports. Between 2018 and 2023, MeatCo's reporting reveals a progressive alignment with GRI standards, showing both advancements in transparency and increased completeness in specific areas. However, this commitment to social sustainability shows mixed results, with improvements often offset by stagnant areas and, at times, setbacks.

For example, while MeatCo improved the completeness of certain disclosures, ensuring more comprehensive reporting on specific indicators, this did not consistently correlate with a positive outcome in those areas. The "Non-discrimination" indicator illustrates this complexity: despite enhanced reporting, an increase in incidents suggests that challenges in implementation persist. This gap between reporting improvements and practical outcomes underscores the ongoing need for actionable strategies alongside transparency.

The evolution of MeatCo's social practices has also been shaped by stakeholder dynamics. Workers emerged as the most frequently impacted stakeholder, followed by a broad group including suppliers, clients, society, and the government. This reflects the company's direct and indirect social responsibilities.

At the same time, stakeholders like the government, regulators, and management influenced MeatCo's practices by setting expectations and requirements. This could be observed by the recurrence of those stakeholders as causing an impact on the organization, mainly on those with the most improvements in social sustainability indicators. These parties were instrumental in shaping social sustainability commitments, primarily through regulatory compliance pressures.

Sá-Silva et al. (2009) and Bell (2002) reinforced that governments and regulations play a significant role in facilitating the adoption of social sustainability policies in companies. It highlights the importance of regulatory entities in pushing forward SSO.

This research presented some theoretical contributions related to expanding the understanding of completeness in sustainability reports and actual social sustainability impacts. It shows that increased completeness does not mean actual improvements in social sustainability indicators. A methodological proposal was also provided to overcome this analysis based on sustainability completeness to social sustainability indicators.

By analyzing MeatCo's alignment with GRI standards, the study reveals limitations in voluntary reporting frameworks for driving real change. It suggests that while these frameworks encourage transparency, they may allow selective reporting that emphasizes positive aspects while neglecting areas with little improvement. This reinforces discussions on the need for external auditing to improve the reliability of sustainability reports (Quilice et al., 2018).

The findings highlight the instrumental role of government and regulators in ad-

vancing corporate social sustainability. Thus, more targeted policies and regulations focused on social sustainability indicators could significantly enhance companies' practices in this area.

MeatCo's more reactive approach to social sustainability places it in the first of Miller and Serafeim (2014) 's three sustainability stages: the compliance stage. This stage, characterized by a focus on meeting minimum requirements and regulatory obligations, represents the initial point of engagement with sustainability for most companies. In contrast, the final stage, the innovation stage, is marked by increased stakeholder interaction and greater alignment between the business model and sustainability goals. Company leaders contend that at this stage, both the company's positive societal impact and its financial returns increase.

Therefore, this "diagnosis" of the current situation of the company's social sustainability stage provides a foundation for strategic planning and goal-setting toward a more integrated and impactful approach. By identifying MeatCo's position at the compliance stage, leadership gains clarity on the gap between current practices and the innovation stage, where sustainability is deeply embedded in the business model and generates meaningful social impact alongside financial returns. Hence, this study provides empirical evidence of the need for greater interaction with stakeholders for better alignment between business models and sustainability goals.

This study also suggests that GRI requirements, to provide analysis and comparison across years and companies, should have more specific orientations and more accurate guidelines for reporting.

One of the study's limitations is related to the lack of triangulation of data sources, as the analysis was based solely on the company's sustainability reports. Including other sources, such as interviews with stakeholders, could provide a more comprehensive view of the company's social sustainability practices. A broader sample of

companies could offer comparative insights. Therefore, amplifying the sample would allow a better understanding of the sector itself.

Another limitation is the temporal scope of the study, which only covers the years 2018 to 2023. A longer timeframe could provide a more complete picture of how the company's social sustainability practices have evolved, capturing potential shifts in response to changing regulations, market trends, or stakeholder expectations.

Additionally, the analysis only considered the stakeholders referenced in the company's reports, which may not fully capture the range of groups impacted by the company's operations. Stakeholders who are not explicitly mentioned in the reports may still be significantly impacted by or have a significant impact on the company's social sustainability practices.

The study compares the company's performance over time but lacks a comparative benchmark against industry peers or leading companies in social sustainability. Without understanding how MeatCo's practices measure up to other companies in the same sector, it is difficult to assess whether the company is making significant progress or simply conforming to industry standards.

Therefore, future studies could increase their scope to include other companies from this sector to allow a more accurate assessment of whether MeatCo is making genuine progress in social sustainability or merely aligning with minimum industry expectations. A comparative analysis would provide valuable insights into best practices, highlight areas where the company might be lagging, and identify potential leaders in the sector.

Given the company's longer history with GRI-based sustainability reporting, its inclusion in the ISE portfolio, and its higher ranking within the ISE, one might expect it to demonstrate the most advanced social sustainability performance in the sector. However, its classification at a lower level of transformation, characterized by a reac-

tive, compliance-based approach, reveals the need for more proactive efforts within the sector. This includes strategically integrating social sustainability into business operations and committing more deeply to creating positive social outcomes.

However, this conclusion should be validated by future studies, M. N. S. P. Martins et al. (2016) found that the ISE may reflect a company's size and profitability more than its actual social investments. Future research could explore whether companies with different profiles in terms of size and profitability might demonstrate better social sustainability indicators.

Following the methodology of evaluating the reports used in this study, future studies could benchmark the social sustainability indicators from sustainability reports of other companies against industry peers and, further, seek to comprehend the challenges faced by the companies and how the companies with greater improvements addressed those challenges. This would offer valuable insights into the specific obstacles faced by businesses and the best practices for overcoming them.

To understand which issues stakeholders prioritize and how companies' social sustainability efforts align (or conflict) with stakeholder expectations beyond the sustainability reports, interviewing key stakeholders, such as local communities, regulators, and employees, could help understand their perspectives on social sustainability practices.

To reinforce the findings from the present study on the crucial role of government and regulations in improving social sustainability indicators, it could be investigated whether companies that adhere to stricter regulations exhibit better social sustainability performance than those in less regulated markets.

Also, the role of digital tools such as blockchain, AI, and IoT in enhancing social sustainability efforts could also be studied to offer insight into how technology can improve transparency and practices within the sector.

Some findings, such as PwD individuals being concentrated in higher-level employee categories, such as executives and senior managers, could be researched to understand the reasons behind this pattern and identify potential barriers to employment for PwD individuals in more entry-level jobs.

After the preparation of this work, the author used Gemini® in order to improve readability and language of the manuscript. After using this tool, the author reviewd and edited the content as needed and take full responsability for the content of the publication.

References

Abbas, Z., Khan, A. G., Smaliukienė, R., Zámečník, R., Hussain, K., & Mubarik, S. (2022). Green hrm pursuit of social sustainability in the hotels: Amo theoretical perspective. *Quality - Access to Success*, *23*, 41–50. https://doi.org/10.47750/QAS/23.190.05

Abbott, K. W., & Snidal, D. (2021). The governance triangle: Regulatory standards institutions and the shadow of the state. In *The spectrum of international institutions* (pp. 52–91). Routledge.

ABNT, A. B. N. T. .-. (2001). Nbr 14280: Cadastro de acidente de trabalho - procedimento e classificação.

Absar, M. M. N., Dhar, B. K., Mahmood, M., & Emran, M. (2021). Sustainability disclosures in emerging economies: Evidence from human capital disclosures on listed banks' websites in bangladesh. *Business and Society Review*, *126*, 363–378. https://doi.org/10.1111/basr.12242

Adamu, A. I., & Tyasari, I. (2022). Social sustainability reporting and board structures in the healthcare industry. *Indonesian Journal of Sustainability Accounting and Management*, *6*. https://doi.org/10.28992/ijsam.v6i1.485

Afum, E., Agyabeng-Mensah, Y., Baah, C., Asamoah, G., & Kusi, L. Y. (2022). Eco-market orientation in the logistics industry: A conveyor belt for achieving organizational outcomes via green logistics practices. *International Journal of Logistics Management*, *33*, 712–734. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJLM-07-2021-0383

Agyabeng-Mensah, Y., Afum, E., Acquah, I. S. K., Dacosta, E., Baah, C., & Ahenkorah, E. (2020). The role of green logistics management practices, supply chain traceability and logistics ecocentricity in sustainability performance. *International Journal of Logistics Management*, *32*, 538–566. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJLM-05-2020-0187

Ajmal, M. M., Khan, M., Hussain, M., & Helo, P. T. (2017). Conceptualizing social sustainability in the business operations.

Akbar, S., & Ahsan, K. (2020). Investigation of the challenges of implementing social sustainability initiatives: A case study of the apparel industry. *Social Responsibility Journal*, *17*, 343–366. https://doi.org/10.1108/SRJ-09-2019-0291

Alghababsheh, M., Butt, A. S., & Ali, S. M. (2023). The role of buyers justice in achieving socially sustainable global supply chains: A perspective of apparel suppliers and their workers. *Journal of Purchasing and Supply Management*, *29*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pursup.2023.100820

Alghababsheh, M., & Gallear, D. (2021). Socially sustainable supply chain management and suppliers' social performance: The role of social capital. *Journal of Business Ethics*, *173*, 855–875. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-020-04525-1

Amponsah-Tawiah, K., & Mensah, J. (2015). Harmonising stakeholder interests: The role of occupational health and safety. *African Journal of Business Management*, *9*(9), 394–401.

Antwi-Boateng, C., Mensah, H. K., & Asumah, S. (2023). Eco-intellectual capital and sustainability performance of smes: The moderating effect of eco-dynamic capability. *Cogent Business and Management*, *10*. https://doi.org/10.1080/23311975.2023.2258614

Arianpoor, A., Salehi, M., & Daroudi, F. (2023). Nonfinancial sustainability reporting, management legitimate authority and enterprise value. *Social Responsibility Journal*, *19*, 1900–1916. https://doi.org/10.1108/SRJ-09-2022-0374

Asif, M. (2020). Supplier socioenvironmental compliance: A survey of the antecedents of standards decoupling. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, *246*, 118956. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2019.118956

Austin, C. R., Bobek, D. D., & Harris, L. L. (2021). Does information about gender pay matter to investors? an experimental investigation. *Accounting, Organizations and Society*, *90*, 101193. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.aos.2020.101193

Awan, U., & Khan, S. A. R. (2021). Mediating role of sustainable leadership in buyersupplier relationships: An supply chain performance: An empirical study. *Logforum*, *17*, 97–112. https://doi.org/10.17270/J.LOG.2021.546

B3. (2024a). Carteiras e questionários [Accessed: 2024-08-11]. https://iseb3.com.br/carteiras-e-questionarios

B3. (2024b). Esg web service [Accessed: 2024-08-11]. https://esgws.b3.com.br/

B3. (2024c). Metodologia do ise b3 [Accessed: 2024-08-11]. https://iseb3.com.br/metodologia

Bannò, M., Filippi, E., & Trento, S. (2023). Women in top echelon positions and their effects on sustainability: A review, synthesis and future research agenda. *Journal of management and governance*, *27*(1), 181–251.

Bardoel, E. A., Russell, G., Advocat, J., Mayson, S., & Kay, M. (2020). Turnover among australian general practitioners: A longitudinal gender analysis. *Human Resources for Health*, *18*, 1–12.

Baron, D. P. (2009). A positive theory of moral management, social pressure, and corporate social performance. *Journal of Economics & Management Strategy*, *18*(1), 7–43.

Bell, D. V. (2002). The role of government in advancing corporate sustainability.

Benameur, K. B., Mostafa, M. M., Hassanein, A., Shariff, M. Z., & Al-Shattarat, W. (2024). Sustainability reporting scholarly research: A bibliometric review and a future research agenda. *Management Review Quarterly*, *74*, 823–866. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11301-023-00319-7

Best Place Working for Parents. (2023). National trends report 2023 [Accessed: 2024-10-11]. https://bestplace4workingparents.com/wp-content/uploads/2024/01/national-trends-report-2023-sm-1.pdf

Binotti, F., & Bertolini, G. R. F. (2023). Competitiveness of animal protein exports from brazil and its relationship to sustainability competitividade das exportações de proteína animal do brasil e sua relação com a sustentabilidade. *Revista de Contabilidade do Mestrado em Ciências Contábeis da UERJ*, *28*, 28–44.

Bowen, G. A. (2009). Document analysis as a qualitative research method. *Qualitative Research Journal*, *9*, 27–40. https://doi.org/10.3316/QRJ0902027

Bowman, K. W., Dale, S. A., Dhanani, S., Nehru, J., & Rabishaw, B. T. (2021, June). Environmental degradation of indigenous protected areas of the amazon as a slow onset event. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cosust.2021.04.012

Braun, V., & Clarke, V. (2006). Using thematic analysis in psychology. *Qualitative research in psychology*, *3*(2), 77–101.

Brønn, P. S. (2007). Relationship outcomes as determinants of reputation. *Corporate Communications: An International Journal*, *12*(4), 376–393.

Bueno, X., & Oh, E. (2022). How do men talk about taking parental leave? evidence from south korea, spain, and the us. *Engaged fatherhood for men, families and gender Equality*, 165.

Cassell, C., & Symon, G. (2004). Using templates in the thematic analyses of text. SAGE Publications.

Castaldi, S., Wilhelm, M. M., Beugelsdijk, S., & van der Vaart, T. (2023). Extending social sustainability to suppliers: The role of gvc governance strategies and supplier country institutions. *Journal of Business Ethics*, *183*, 123–146. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-022-05083-4

Cembranel, P., Floriano, L., & Cardoso, J. (2020). Mulheres em cargos de liderança e os seus desafios no mercado de trabalho. *Revista de Ciências da Administração*, *22*(57).

Ceptureanu, S. I., Ceptureanu, E. G., Luchian, C. E., & Luchian, I. (2018). Community based programs sustainability. a multidimensional analysis of sustainability factors. *Sustainability*, *10*(3), 870.

Cernev, T., & Fenner, R. (2020). The importance of achieving foundational sustainable development goals in reducing global risk. *Futures*, *115*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.futures.2019.102492

Chen, L., Feldmann, A., & Tang, O. (2015). The relationship between disclosures of corporate social performance and financial performance: Evidences from gri reports in manufacturing industry. *International Journal of Production Economics*, *170*, 445–456. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijpe.2015.04.004

Chi, Z., Venkatesh, M., & Ohana, M. (2024). The impact of normative institutions on socially sustainable supply chain management: The role of individual cultural values. *International Journal of Operations and Production Management*, *44*, 790–812. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJOPM-10-2022-0691

Chkanikova, O., & Robert, S. (2021). Third-party sustainability certifications in food retailing: Certification design from a sustainable supply chain management perspective. *Journal of Cleaner Production*, *282*, 124344.

Comissão de Valores Mobiliários. (2023). Resolução cvm nº 193, de 20 de outubro de 2023. www.cvm.gov.br

Commer, P. J., Sci, S., Contreras, F., & Abid, G. (2022). Social sustainability studies in the 21st century: A bibliometric mapping analysis using vosviewer software.

Crane, B. (2020). Revisiting who, when, and why stakeholders matter: Trust and stakeholder connectedness. *Business & Society*, *59*(2), 263–286.

Creswell, J. W., & Creswell, J. D. (2021). *Projeto de pesquisa-: Métodos qualitativo, quantitativo e misto*. Penso Editora.

Crisóstomo, V. L., Forte, H. C., & Prudêncio, P. D. A. (2020). Uma análise da adesão de organizações brasileiras à gri como método de divulgação de informações de responsabilidade social corporativa. *REVISTA AMBIENTE CONTÁBIL - Universidade Federal do Rio Grande do Norte - ISSN 2176-9036*, *12*, 47–73. https://doi.org/10.21680/2176-9036.2020v12n2id19005

Cuthill, M. (2010). Strengthening the 'social' in sustainable development: Developing a conceptual framework for social sustainability in a rapid urban growth region in australia. *Sustainable Development*, *18*, 362–373. https://doi.org/10.1002/sd.397

de Langrafe, T. F., Barakat, S. R., Stocker, F., & Boaventura, J. M. G. (2020). A stakeholder theory approach to creating value in higher education institutions. *The Bottom Line*, *33*(4), 297–313.

de Nagata, V. M. N., de Carvalho, M. M., & de Oliveira, M. M. (2023). How does innovative dynamic capability favour sustainability? a study for brazilian industry. *Technology Analysis and Strategic Management*. https://doi.org/10.1080/09537325.2023.2209222

de Neto, R. C. S., de Lima, C. R. M., Bazil, D. G., de Veras, M. O., & de Guerra, J. B. S. O. A. (2020). Sustainable development and corporate financial performance: A study based on the brazilian corporate sustainability index (ise). *Sustainable Development*, *28*(4), 960–977.

de Paes, L. F., Gonçalves, A. P. V., & Ferreira, V. R. (2021). Trabalho e gênero nas indústrias automotivas do sul fluminense. *Política & Sociedade*, *20*, 244–276. https://doi.org/10.5007/2175-7984.2021.e73395

de Sant'Anna, A. S., Diniz, D. M., de Neto, A. M. C., Santos, C. M. M., & Lima-Souza, É. (2022). Professional women in the transition to the fourth industrial revolution: A brazilian gaze. *Revista de Carreiras e Pessoas*, *12*(1), 9–30.

de Sousa, A. B. V., de Neto, F. A. S., de Pinto, L. H. S., & Ximenes, M. R. R. (2021). Impacto das noticias nas decisoes de investidores no cenario da operacao carne fraca.

De-Assis, M. P., Barcella, R. C., Padilha, J. C., Pohl, H. H., & Krug, S. B. F. (2021). Health problems in agricultural workers occupationally exposed to pesticides. https://doi.org/10.47626/1679-4435-2020-532

Devi, Y., A, S., Koshta, N., & Chaudhuri, A. (2023). The role of operations and supply chains in mitigating social disruptions caused by covid-19: A stakeholder dynamic capabilities view. *International Journal of Logistics Management*, *34*, 1219–1244.

Di Maddaloni, F., & Sabini, L. (2022). Very important, yet very neglected: Where do local communities stand when examining social sustainability in major construc-

tion projects? *International Journal of Project Management*, *40*, 778–797. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijproman.2022.08.007

Dodoo, J. E., & Al-Samarraie, H. (2021). A systematic review of factors leading to occupational injuries and fatalities. *Journal of Public Health*, 1–15.

Donaldson, T., & Preston, L. E. (1995). The stakeholder theory of the corporation: Concepts, evidence, and implications. *Source: The Academy of Management Review*, *20*, 65–91. https://www.jstor.org/stable/258887

Dreier, H. (2023). Alone and exploited, migrant children work brutal jobs across the u.s. the new york times. *The New York Times*. www.nytimes.com/2023/02/25/us/unaccompanied-migrant-child-workers-exploitation.html

Ebulue, C. C., Ebulue, O. R., & Ekesiobi, C. S. (2024). Public-private partnerships in health sector innovation: Lessons from around the world. *International Medical Science Research Journal*, *4*(4), 484–499.

Elkington, J. (1994). Towards the sustainable corporation: Win-win-win business strategies for sustainable development. *California Management Review*, *36*(2), 90–100. https://doi.org/10.2307/41165746

Emily, C. (2024). Impact of gender pay gap on workplace productivity and employee morale in canada. *International Journal of Sociology*, *8*, 24–35. https://doi.org/10.47604/ijs.2831

Ensher, E., Grant-Vallone, E., & Donaldson, S. (2001). Effects of perceived discrimination on job satisfaction, organizational commitment, organizational citizenship behavior, and grievances. *Human Resource Development Quarterly*, *12*, 53–72. https://doi.org/10.1002/1532-1096(200101/02)12:13.0.CO;2-G

European Commission of the Communities. (2001). Green paper: Promoting a european framework for corporate social responsibility.

Fan, D., Mao, Y., Xu, L., & Wang, W. (2020). Effects of livestock and poultry breeding pollution on health risks: Evidence from a hog breeding case in rural china. *Chinese Journal of Population Resources and Environment*, *18*, 342–349. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cjpre.2021.04.008

Fassin, Y. (2009). The stakeholder model refined. *Journal of Business Ethics*, *84*, 113–135. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-008-9677-4

Fernandes, V., Kuzey, C., Uyar, A., & Karaman, A. S. (2023). Board structure policy, board diversity and social sustainability in the logistics and transportation sector. *International Journal of Physical Distribution and Logistics Management*, *53*, 62–92. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJPDLM-09-2021-0415

Fontana, E., Atif, M., & Heuer, M. (2023). Implementing social sustainability through market pressures: An inter-organizational network analysis in the pakistani apparel supply chain. *International Journal of Physical Distribution and Logistics Management*, *53*, 156–180. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJPDLM-07-2021-0265

Foot, D. K., & Roos, S. (2004, August). *Teaching business sustainibility* (Vol. VOLUME 1: FROM THEORY TO PRACTICE). Routledge. https://doi.org/10.4324/9781351281805

Freeman, R. E., & McVea, J. (1984). A stakeholder approach to strategic management. http://papers.ssrn.com/paper.taf?abstract_id=263511

Freitas, G., Santos, J., & Jacinto, P. (2022). Inserção da mulher negra no mundo do trabalho: Uma revisão de literatura. *Boletim de Conjuntura (BOCA)*, *9*(26), 47–63.

Freshour, C. (2019, October). Cheap meat and cheap work in the us poultry industry: Race, gender, and immigration in corporate strategies to shape labor. The MIT Press. https://doi.org/10.7551/mitpress/11868.001.0001

Freudenreich, B., Lüdeke-Freund, F., & Schaltegger, S. (2020). A stakeholder theory perspective on business models: Value creation for sustainability. *Journal of business ethics*, *166*(1), 3–18.

Friske, W., Hoelscher, S. A., & Nikolov, A. N. (2023). The impact of voluntary sustainability reporting on firm value: Insights from signaling theory. *Journal of the Academy of Marketing Science*, *51*(2), 372–392.

Gardazi, S. S. N., Hassan, A. F. S., & Johari, J. B. (2020). Board of directors attributes and sustainability performance in the energy industry. *Journal of Asian Finance, Economics and Business*, *12*, 317–328. https://doi.org/10.13106/JAFEB.2020.VOL7.NO12.317

Gil, A. C. (2002). *Como elaborar projetos de pesquisa*. Editora Atlas SA.

Goel, A., Ganesh, L. S., & Kaur, A. (2020a). Benefits formulation in construction projects: An exploratory study through a social sustainability perspective. *IIM Kozhikode Society and Management Review*, *9*, 162–176. https://doi.org/10.1177/2277975219896510

Goel, A., Ganesh, L. S., & Kaur, A. (2020b). Social sustainability considerations in construction project feasibility study: A stakeholder salience perspective. *Engineering, Construction and Architectural Management*, *27*, 1429–1459. https://doi.org/10.1108/ECAM-06-2019-0319

Goel, A., Ganesh, L., & Kaur, A. (2020). Project management for social good: A conceptual framework and research agenda for socially sustainable construction project management. *International journal of managing projects in business*, *13*(4), 695–726.

González, N., Marquès, M., Nadal, M., & Domingo, J. L. (2020, November). Meat consumption: Which are the current global risks? a review of recent (2010–2020) evidences. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.foodres.2020.109341

Govindan, K., Shaw, M., & Majumdar, A. (2021). Social sustainability tensions in multi-tier supply chain: A systematic literature review towards conceptual framework development. *Journal of cleaner production*, *279*, 123075.

GRI. (2016a). Gri 401: Employment 2016.

GRI. (2016b). Gri 402: Labor/management relations 2016.

GRI. (2016c). Gri 403: Occupational health and safety 2016.

GRI. (2016d). Gri 404: Training and education 2016.

GRI. (2016e). Gri 405: Diversity and equal opportunity 2016.

GRI. (2016f). Gri 406: Non-discrimination 2016.

GRI. (2016g). Gri 407: Freedom of association and collective bargaining 2016.

GRI. (2016h). Gri 408: Child labor 2016.

GRI. (2016i). Gri 409: Forced or compulsory labor 2016.

GRI. (2016j). Gri 410: Security practices 2016.

GRI. (2016k). Gri 411: Rights of indigenous peoples 2016.

GRI. (2016l). Gri 413: Local communities 2016.

GRI. (2016m). Gri 414: Supplier social assessment 2016.

GRI. (2016n). Gri 415: Public policy 2016.

GRI. (2016o). Gri 416: Customer health and safety 2016.

GRI. (2016p). Gri 417: Marketing and labeling 2016.

GRI. (2018). Gri 403: Occupational health and safety 2018.

GRI. (2021). Gri 1: Foundation 2021.

Guba, E. G., & Lincoln, Y. S. (1981). *Effective evaluation: Improving the usefulness of evaluation results through responsive and naturalistic approaches.* Jossey-Bass.

Guzmán-Pérez, B., Mendoza-Jiménez, J., & Pérez-Monteverde, M. V. (2023). Measuring the social sustainability of hotels: A case study from the canary islands. *International Journal of Contemporary Hospitality Management*, *35*, 512–532. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJCHM-05-2021-0610

Hardy, J. H., Tey, K. S., Cyrus-Lai, W., Martell, R. F., Olstad, A., & Uhlmann, E. L. (2022). Bias in context: Small biases in hiring evaluations have big consequences. *Journal of Management*, *48*(3), 657–692. https://doi.org/10.1177/0149206320982654

Harrison, J. S., Freeman, R. E., & de Abreu, M. C. S. (2015). Stakeholder theory as an ethical approach to effective management: Applying the theory to multiple contexts. *Revista brasileira de gestão de negócios*, *17*(55), 858–869.

Heon, L. T. (2012). Gender differences in voluntary turnover: Still a paradox? *International Business Research*, *5*(10), 19.

Hinsberg, K. L., & Lamanna, A. J. (2024). Crisis communication in construction: Organizational strategies for worksite fatalities. *Journal of safety research*, *88*, 145–160.

Hohn, M. M., & Durach, C. F. (2021). Additive manufacturing in the apparel supply chain — impact on supply chain governance and social sustainability. *International Journal of Operations and Production Management*, *41*, 1035–1059. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJOPM-09-2020-0654

Huq, F. A., & Stevenson, M. (2020). Implementing socially sustainable practices in challenging institutional contexts: Building theory from seven developing country supplier cases. *Journal of Business Ethics*, *161*, 415–442. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-018-3951-x

IBGE, I. B. G. E. .-. (2022). Desigualdades sociais por cor ou raça no brasil: Estudos e pesquisas: Informação demográfica e socioeconômica • n.48 2a edição. https://www.ibge.gov.br/estatisticas/sociais/populacao/

IBGE, I. B. G. E. .-. (2023). Pessoas com deficiência 2022 - pesquisa nacional por amostra de domicílios contínua. http://www.planalto.gov.br/ccivil_03/ato2007-2010/2009/decreto/d6949.htm

IFRS Foundation. (n.d.). Sasb standards. https://sasb.ifrs.org/standards/download

Instituto Brasileiro de Geografia e Estatística. (2024). Estatísticas de gênero: Indicadores sociais das mulheres no brasil [Accessed: 2024-06-21].

International Organization for Standardization. (2018). Iso 31000:2018 - risk management – guidelines (2nd ed.)

Jadhav, A., Rahman, S., & Ahsan, K. (2020). Sustainability practices disclosure of top logistics firms in australia. *International Journal of Logistics Management*, *33*, 244–277. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJLM-09-2021-0452

Jayarathna, C. P., Agdas, D., Dawes, L., & Miska, M. (2022). Exploring sector-specific sustainability indicators: A content analysis of sustainability reports in the logistics sector. *European Business Review*, *34*, 321–343. https://doi.org/10.1108/EBR-02-2021-0047

Jehanzeb, K., & Bashir, N. A. (2013). Training and development program and its benefits to employee and organization: A conceptual study. *European Journal of business and management*, *5*(2).

Jeong, S.-H., & Harrison, D. A. (2017). Glass breaking, strategy making, and value creating: Meta-analytic outcomes of women as ceos and tmt members. *Academy of Management Journal*, *60*(4), 1219–1252.

Johnson, R. B., Onwuegbuzie, A. J., & Turner, L. A. (2007). Toward a definition of mixed methods research. *Journal of mixed methods research*, *1*(2), 112–133.

Journeault, M., Levant, Y., & Picard, C. F. (2021). Sustainability performance reporting: A technocratic shadowing and silencing. *Critical Perspectives on Accounting*, *74*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cpa.2019.102145

Jung, Y.-E., & Sung, M.-H. (2022). Do parenting stress, work-family conflict, and resilience affect retention intention in korean nurses returning to work after parental leave?: A cross-sectional study. *Korean Journal of Women Health Nursing*, *28*(1), 18–26.

Kaler, J. (2003). Differentiating stakeholder theories. *Journal of Business Ethics*, *46*(1), 71–83. https://doi.org/10.1023/a:1024794710899

Kamau, O., Muathe, S., & Wainaina, L. (2021). Demographic factors and turnover intentions of teachers in public secondary schools in kenya. *International Journal of Research in Business and Social Science (2147-4478)*, *10*(4), 363–374.

Kelling, N. K., Sauer, P. C., Gold, S., & Seuring, S. (2021). The role of institutional uncertainty for social sustainability of companies and supply chains. *Journal of Business Ethics*, *173*, 813–833. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-020-04423-6

Kerwer, D. (2005). Rules that many use: Standards and global regulation. *Governance*, *18*(4), 611–632.

Khan, M. N., Rafi-Ul-Shan, P. M., Akhtar, P., Khan, Z. N., & Shamim, S. (2023). Exploring the impact of institutional forces on social sustainability of logistics service

providers: Insights from a highly terrorism-affected region. https://doi.org/10.1108/CG-05
Koehler, G. (2016). Assessing the sdgs from the standpoint of eco-social policy: Using the sdgs subversively. *Journal of International and Comparative Social Policy*, *32*, 149–164. https://doi.org/10.1080/21699763.2016.1198715
KPMG. (2022). Big shifts, small steps: Survey of sustainability reporting 2022 [Accessed: 3 March 2022]. https://assets.kpmg.com/content/dam/kpmg/dk/pdf/dk-2022/dk-SSR-Report_FINAL_web.pdf
Lashitew, A. A. (2021, March). Corporate uptake of the sustainable development goals mere greenwashing or an advent of institutional change? https://doi.org/10.1057/s42214-020-00092-4
Le, T. M. T. (2022). Unpacking selective decoupling in global supply chains: A stakeholder salience perspective on social issues in vietnam's garment factorie. *Supply Chain Forum*, *23*, 347–362. https://doi.org/10.1080/16258312.2022.2102935
Lee, C. M. J., Che-Ha, N., & Alwi, S. F. S. (2021). Service customer orientation and social sustainability: The case of small medium enterprises. *Journal of Business Research*, *122*, 751–760. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2019.12.048
Lee, P. M., & James, E. H. (2007). She'-e-os: Gender effects and investor reactions to the announcements of top executive appointments. *Strategic Management Journal*, *28*(3), 227–241. https://doi.org/10.1002/smj.575
Lépineux, F. (2005). Stakeholder theory, society and social cohesion. *Corporate Governance: The international journal of business in society*, *5*(2), 99–110.
Lim, J. J., Dai, J., & Paulraj, A. (2022). Collaboration as a structural aspect of proactive social sustainability: The differential moderating role of distributive and procedural justice. *International Journal of Operations and Production Management*, *42*, 1817–1852. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJOPM-06-2021-0402
Linear Comunicação. (2017). Operação carne fraca: Relatório analítico de repercussão em mídia.
Ljubojević, Ĉ., & Ljubojević, G. (2011). Improving the stakeholder satisfaction by corporate governance quality. *Škola biznisa ", br*, *1*, 22–35.
Loyarte-López, E., García-Olaizola, I., Posada, J., Azúa, I., & Flórez, J. (2020). Sustainable career development for r&d professionals: Applying a career development system in basque country. *International Journal of Innovation Studies*, *4*(2), 40–50.
MacDonald, A., Clarke, A., & Huang, L. (2022). Multi-stakeholder partnerships for sustainability: Designing decision-making processes for partnership capacity. In *Business and the ethical implications of technology* (pp. 103–120). Springer.
Mahajan, R., Lim, W. M., Sareen, M., Kumar, S., & Panwar, R. (2023). Stakeholder theory. *Journal of Business Research*, *166*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2023.114104
Martins, M. N. S. P., Campos, A. L., & Martins, F. S. (2016). Influência dos investimentos sociais para inclusão de empresas no índice de sustentabilidade empresarial (ise). *Revista de Gestão Social e Ambiental-RGSA*, *10*(1), 58–71.
Martins, P. S., & Saraiva, J. (2020). Assessing the legal value added of collective bargaining agreements. *International Review of Law and Economics*, *62*, 105904. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.irle.2020.105904
Masudin, I., Aprilia, G. D., Nugraha, A., & Restuputri, D. P. (2021). Impact of e-procurement adoption on company performance: Evidence from indonesian manufacturing industry. *Logistics*, *5*(1), 16.
Mausumi, N. (2017). Stakeholder roles in improving occupational health and safety (ohs): A case study of bangladesh garment industry. *International Journal of Business Research and Management (IJBRM)*, *8*(3), 51–61.
McBride, A., Hebson, G., & Holgate, J. (2015). Intersectionality: Are we taking enough notice in the field of work and employment relations? *Work, employment and society*, *29*(2), 331–341.

McKinsey & NielsenIQ. (2023). Consumers care about sustainability-and back it up with their wallets a joint study from mckinsey and nielseniq examines sales growth for products that claim to be environmentally and socially responsible.

Mehmood, K. K., Rasheed, R., & Jaan, J. (2020). How does stakeholders pressure affect organization performance and employee wellbeing? study of multiple mediating roles. *Journal of Business and Social Review in Emerging Economies*, *6*(1), 55–68.

Meseguer-Sánchez, V., Gálvez-Sánchez, F. J., López-Martínez, G., & Molina-Moreno, V. (2021). Corporate social responsibility and sustainability. a bibliometric analysis of their interrelations. *Sustainability (Switzerland)*, *13*, 1–18. https://doi.org/10.3390/su13041636

Miles, S. (2017). Stakeholder theory classification: A theoretical and empirical evaluation of definitions. *Journal of Business Ethics*, *142*, 437–459. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-015-2741-y

Miller, K., & Serafeim, G. (2014). Chief sustainability officers: Who are they and what do they do?

Miltersteiner, R. K., OLIVEIRA, F. B. D., Hryniewicz, L. G. C., SANT'ANNA, A. D. S., & Moura, L. C. (2020). Female leadership: Perceptions, reflections, and challenges in public administration. *Cadernos EBAPE. BR*, *18*, 406–423.

Missimer, M., & Mesquita, P. L. (2022). Social sustainability in business organizations: A research agenda. *Sustainability (Switzerland)*, *14*. https://doi.org/10.3390/su14052608

Mitchell, R. K., Agle, B. R., & Wood, D. J. (1997). Toward a theory of stakeholder identification and salience: Defining the principle of who and what really counts. https://www.jstor.org/stable/259247

Mohsin, M., Shamsudin, M. N., Jaffri, N. R., Idrees, M., & Jamil, K. (2024). Unveiling the contextual effects of total quality management to enhance sustainable performance. *TQM Journal*. https://doi.org/10.1108/TQM-05-2023-0124

Mondal, S., Singh, S., & Gupta, H. (2024). Achieving technological transformation and social sustainability: An industry 4.0 perspective. *IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management*, *71*, 6623–6635. https://doi.org/10.1109/TEM.2023.3246637

Morgan, A. C., Way, S. F., Hoefer, M. J., Larremore, D. B., Galesic, M., & Clauset, A. (2021). The unequal impact of parenthood in academia. *Science Advances*, *7*(9), eabd1996.

Morse, J. M. (2003). Principles of mixed methods. *Handbook of mixed methods in social & behavioral research*, *189*.

Nath, S. D., Eweje, G., & Barua, S. (2023). Drivers and barriers for implementing social sustainability in supply chains: A qualitative investigation of a developing country's multi-tier suppliers. *International Journal of Logistics Management*. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJLM-03-2022-0121

Nowell, L. S., Norris, J. M., White, D. E., & Moules, N. J. (2017). Thematic analysis: Striving to meet the trustworthiness criteria. *International journal of qualitative methods*, *16*(1), 1609406917733847.

Odriozola, M. D., & Baraibar-Diez, E. (2017). Is corporate reputation associated with quality of csr reporting? evidence from spain. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, *24*(2), 121–132. https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.1399

Onofrei, G., Nguyen, H., Yang, Y., & Filieri, R. (2023). Entrepreneurial orientation and the triple bottom line: Does supply chain learning matter? *IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management*. https://doi.org/10.1109/TEM.2023.3295061

Ozkan, A., Elci, M., Karabay, M., Kitapci, H., & Garip, C. (2020). Antecedents of turnover intention: A meta-analysis study in the united states. *E a M: Ekonomie a Management*, *23*(1).

Papoutsi, A., & Sodhi, M. S. (2020). Does disclosure in sustainability reports indicate actual sustainability performance? *Journal of Cleaner Production*, *260*, 121049. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jclepro.2020.121049

Petrescu, A. G., Bîlcan, F. R., Petrescu, M., Holban Oncioiu, I., Türkeș, M. C., & Căpuşneanu, S. (2020). Assessing the benefits of the sustainability reporting practices in the top romanian companies. *Sustainability*, *12*(8). https://doi.org/10.3390/su12083470

Peveri, J., & Pardelli, G. (2024). State capacity, informality, and clientelism. *Informality, and Clientelism(July 18, 2024)*.

Phillips, R. A., Freeman, R. E., & Wicks, A. (2005). What stakeholder theory is not. *Business Ethics Quarterly*, *13*, 479–502.

Pina, S., Costa, C. S., Monte, A., Maia, T. S. V., Correia, P. M. A. R., & Resende, S. A. L. (2023). Social responsibility practices in the public sector–the case of local companies in portugal. *Revista da FAE*, *26*(1).

Prajogo, D., Nair, A., & Castka, P. (2020). The effects of external auditors and certification bodies on the operational and market-oriented outcomes of iso 9001 implementation. *IEEE Transactions on Engineering Management*, *69*(4), 1447–1458.

Prasad, V. V. D. (2009). Collective bargaining—its relationship to stakeholders. *Indian Journal of Industrial Relations*, 195–202.

Preuss, L., Haunschild, A., & Matten, D. (2006). Trade unions and csr: A european research agenda. *Journal of Public Affairs: An International Journal*, *6*(3-4), 256–268.

Prieto, L., Amin, M. R., & Canatay, A. (2022). Examining social sustainability in organizations. *Sustainability (Switzerland)*, *14*. https://doi.org/10.3390/su141912111

Puri, P., & Borok, T. (2002). Employees as corporate stakeholders.

Quilice, T. F., Cezarino, L. O., Alves, M. F. R., Liboni, L. B., & Caldana, A. C. F. (2018). Positive and negative aspects of gri reporting as perceived by brazilian organizations. *Environmental Quality Management*, *27*, 19–30. https://doi.org/10.1002/tqem.21543

Rahman, M. S., Bag, S., Gupta, S., & Sivarajah, U. (2023). Technology readiness of b2b firms and ai-based customer relationship management capability for enhancing social sustainability performance. *Journal of Business Research*, *156*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jbusres.2022.113525

Reid, L. (2022). The development of osha.

Reimer, T. (2020). Why fathers don't take more parental leave in germany: Comparing mechanisms in different work organizations. *Community, Work & Family*, *23*(4), 419–438.

Robertson, P. J. (2013). The well-being outcomes of career guidance. *British Journal of Guidance & Counselling*, *41*(3), 254–266.

Rogers, Z. S., Golara, S., & Carter, C. R. (2023). Moving beyond the four walls: The evolving impact of supplier sustainability on firm value. *Journal of Purchasing and Supply Management*, *29*. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.pursup.2023.100858

Sachs, J. D., & Sachs, L. E. (2021, March). Business alignment for the "decade of action". https://doi.org/10.1057/s42214-020-00090-6

Saidu, M. B., & Kwahar, N. (2024). Public private partnership and the performance of tertiary health institutions in benue state, nigeria. *International Academic Journal of Business School Research*, *8*(9), 134–146.

Samadhiya, A., & Agrawal, R. (2023). Total productive maintenance and sustainability performance: Resource-based view perspective. *Benchmarking*. https://doi.org/10.1108/BIJ-10-2022-0635

Sarrah, M. A., Ajmal, M. M., & Mertzanis, C. (2020). Identification of sustainability indicators in the civil aviation sector in dubai: A stakeholders' perspective. *Social Responsibility Journal*, *17*, 648–668. https://doi.org/10.1108/SRJ-06-2019-0203

Sá-Silva, J. R., de Almeida, C. D., Guindani, J. F., et al. (2009). Pesquisa documental: Pistas teóricas e metodológicas. *Revista brasileira de história & ciências sociais*, *1*(1), 1–15.

Schilling-Vacaflor, A., Lenschow, A., Challies, E., Cotta, B., & Newig, J. (2021). Contextualizing certification and auditing: Soy certification and access of local communities to land and water in brazil. *World Development*, *140*, 105281.

Scott, J. (2014). *A matter of record: Documentary sources in social research*. John Wiley & Sons.

SDG Compass. (2015). The guide for business action on the sdgs. www.sdgcompass.org

Sehnem, S., Fischer, A., Alberton, A., Mauro, R., & Agnol, D. (2012). Análise do desempenho de empresas do segmento de carnes e derivados listadas na bm&fbovespa performance analysis of companies in meat and meat products segment listed at bovespa. *Revista Eletrônica de Administração e Turismo-ReAT —*, *1*, 36–55.

Shaharudin, M. R., Hamid, N. Z. A., Abdullah, D., Ahmad, N., Hassam, S. F., & Fauzi, N. H. H. A. (2022). Factors affecting social sustainability performance amongst malaysian manufacturing companies. *International Journal of Business and Society*, *23*, 1874–1887. https://doi.org/10.33736/ijbs.5217.2022

Shaw, M., Majumdar, A., & Govindan, K. (2023). How are the barriers of social sustainability perceived in a multi-tier supply chain? a case of textile and clothing industry. *Operations Management Research*, *17*. https://doi.org/10.1007/s12063-023-00406-8

Sida, S. I. D. C. A. (n.d.). The gri standards a guide for policy makers.

Silveira, S., Pessoa, R., & Cardoso, J. (2023). O compliance trabalhista como ferramenta na construção do trabalho decente. *Revista Jurídica*, *3*(75).

Stock, W. A., & Inglis, M. (2021). The longer-term labor market impacts of paid parental leave. *Growth and Change*, *52*(2), 838–884.

Swain, R. B. (2018). A critical analysis of the sustainable development goals. In W. Leal Filho (Ed.), *Handbook of sustainability science and research* (pp. 341–355). Springer International Publishing. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-319-63007-6_20

Thomas, R., Darby, J. L., Dobrzykowski, D., & van Hoek, R. (2021). Decomposing social sustainability: Signaling theory insights into supplier selection decisions. *Journal of Supply Chain Management*, *57*, 117–136. https://doi.org/10.1111/jscm.12247

Tjahjadi, B., Soewarno, N., Karima, T. E., & Sutarsa, A. A. P. (2024). Socially friendly business strategy and social sustainability performance: Roles of spiritual capital and social management process. *Social Responsibility Journal*, *20*, 804–824. https://doi.org/10.1108/SRJ-11-2022-0496

Tompa, E., Kalcevich, C., McLeod, C., Lebeau, M., Song, C., McLeod, K., Kim, J., & Demers, P. A. (2017). The economic burden of lung cancer and mesothelioma due to occupational and para-occupational asbestos exposure. *Occupational and environmental medicine*, *74*(11), 816–822.

Toussaint, M., Cabanelas, P., & Blanco-González, A. (2021). Social sustainability in the food value chain: An integrative approach beyond corporate social responsibility. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, *28*, 103–115. https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.2035

Tran, T. H. U., Lau, K. H., & Ong, C. E. (2023). Mediating role of internationalization readiness in the adoption of social sustainability practices: Evidence from vietnamese handicraft companies. *Business Strategy and Development*, *6*, 241–256. https://doi.org/10.1002/bsd2.236

Tseng, M. L., Tran, T. P. T., Wu, K. J., Tan, R. R., & Bui, T. D. (2022). Exploring sustainable seafood supply chain management based on linguistic preferences: Collaboration in the supply chain and lean management drive economic benefits. *International Journal of Logistics Research and Applications*, *25*, 410–432. https://doi.org/10.1080/13675567.2020.1800608

Tulder, R. V., Rodrigues, S. B., Mirza, H., & Sexsmith, K. (2021, March). The un's sustainable development goals: Can multinational enterprises lead the decade of action? https://doi.org/10.1057/s42214-020-00095-1

Tumwebaze, Z., Bananuka, J., Orobia, L. A., & Kinatta, M. M. (2022). Board role performance and sustainability reporting practices: Managerial perception-based evidence from uganda. *Journal of Global Responsibility*, *13*, 317–337. https://doi.org/10.1108/JGR-08-2021-0072

Turker, D., & Ozdemir, G. (2020). Modeling social sustainability: Analysis of hospitality e-distributors. *Sustainability Accounting, Management and Policy Journal*, *11*, 799–824. https://doi.org/10.1108/SAMPJ-02-2019-0035

Uddin, M. H., Razzak, M. R., & Rahman, A. A. (2023). Sustainable supply chain management practices, dynamic capabilities and competitive advantage: Evidence from bangladesh ready-made garments industry. *Business Strategy and Development*, *6*, 176–188. https://doi.org/10.1002/bsd2.232

Ullah, Z., Sulaiman, M. A. B. A., Ali, S. B., Ahmad, N., Scholz, M., & Han, H. (2021). The effect of work safety on organizational social sustainability improvement in the healthcare sector: The case of a public sector hospital in pakistan. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, *18*. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph18126672

United Nations. (1972). Environment programme stockholm declaration. https://wedocs.unep.org/bitstream/handle/20.500.11822/29567/ELGP1StockD.pdf

United Nations. (1987). Report of the world commission on environment and development: Our common future towards sustainable development 2. part ii. common challenges population and human resources 4. https://sustainabledevelopment.un.org/content/documents/5987our-common-future.pdf

United Nations. (1992). A/conf.151/26/vol.i: Rio declaration on environment and development. http://www.un.org/documents/ga/conf151/aconf15126-1annex1.htm

United Nations. (2000). "we the peoples: The role of the united nations in the 21st century" presented to general assembly by secretary-general press release ga/9704 we the peoples: The role of the united nations in the 21st century presented to general assembly by secretary-general. https://press.un.org/en/2000/20000403.ga9704.doc.html

United Nations. (2012). Outcome document of the united nations conference on sustainable development. https://sustainabledevelopment.un.org/content/documents/733FutureWeWant.pdf

United Nations. (2015). Transforming our world: The 2030 agenda for sustainable development united nations united nations transforming our world: The 2030 agenda for sustainable development. https://sustainabledevelopment.un.org/content/documents/21252030%20Agenda%20for%20Sustainable%20Development%20web.pdf

United Nations. (2019). The sustainable development goals report. https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/report/2019/The-Sustainable-Development-Goals-Report-2019.pdf

Varihanna, H. H., & Nizam, A. (2020). Effects of organizational trust and justice on job satisfaction and their consequences on organizational citizenship behavior. *East Afr. Sch. J. Econ. Bus. Manag*, *3*, 389–395.

Varrotti, A. P. S., Ramírez, D. C., & Serpe, P. C. (2022). Land grabbing and agribusiness in argentina: Five critical dimensions for analysing corporate strategies and its impacts over unequal actors. *Review of Agricultural, Food and Environmental Studies*, *103*, 417–437. https://doi.org/10.1007/s41130-022-00182-2

Verma, R., Arya, V., Thomas, A., Bolognesi, E., & Mueller, J. (2023). Does startup culture in the emerging country grow around societal sustainability? an empirical study through the lens of co-creational capital and green intellect. *Journal of Intellectual Capital*, *24*, 1047–1074. https://doi.org/10.1108/JIC-07-2022-0162

Vila, M., & Moya, S. (2023). Social sustainability reporting in european business schools. *Sustainability Accounting, Management and Policy Journal*, *14*(1), 242–264. https://doi.org/10.1108/SAMPJ-02-2022-010

Wadood, S. A., Chatha, K. A., Jajja, M. S. S., & Pagell, M. (2022). Social network governance and social sustainability-related knowledge acquisition: The contingent

role of network structure. *International Journal of Operations and Production Management*, *42*, 745–772. https://doi.org/10.1108/IJOPM-08-2021-0543

Walters, D., & Wadsworth, E. (2020). Participation in safety and health in european workplaces: Framing the capture of representation. *European Journal of Industrial Relations*, *26*(1), 75–90.

Wang, X., Yang, M., Park, K., Um, K. H., & Kang, M. (2022). Social sustainability of a firm: Orientation, practices, and performances. *International Journal of Environmental Research and Public Health*, *19*. https://doi.org/10.3390/ijerph192013391

Weaver, G. R., & Clark, C. E. (2015). Behavioral ethics, behavioral governance, and corruption in and by organizations. In *Debates of corruption and integrity: Perspectives from europe and the us* (pp. 135–158). Springer.

Wilton, L. S., Sanchez, D. T., Unzueta, M. M., Kaiser, C., & Caluori, N. (2019). In good company: When gender diversity boosts a company's reputation. *Psychology of Women Quarterly*, *43*(1), 59–72.

World Economic Forum. (2023). Global gender gap report. https://www.weforum.org/publications/global-gender-gap-report-2023/

Xavier, L. M., Oliveira, E. R., Santos, G. C., & de dos Santos, D. L. J. S. (2020). Análise da relação entre variáveis macroeconômicas e indicadores de desempenho econômico-financeiro das empresas do segmento de carnes e derivados. *Revista de Administração e Negócios da Amazônia*, *12*, 121–142. https://doi.org/10.18361/2176-8366/rara.v12n3p5-25

Yadava, R. N., & Sinha, B. (2016). Scoring sustainability reports using gri 2011 guidelines for assessing environmental, economic, and social dimensions of leading public and private indian companies. *Journal of Business Ethics*, *138*, 549–558. https://doi.org/10.1007/s10551-015-2597-1

Yasin, R., Huseynova, A., & Atif, M. (2023). Green human resource management, a gateway to employer branding: Mediating role of corporate environmental sustainability and corporate social sustainability. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*, *30*, 369–383. https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.2360

Zhang, X., Wu, H., Huang, X., Wu, Q., & Wu, Y. (2023). How does online employee training enhance organizational growth? the benefits of integrating educational technology into workplace learning. *Industrial and Commercial Training*, (ahead-of-print).

Zhou, M., Long, X., & Govindan, K. (2024). Unveiling the value of institutional pressure in socially sustainable supply chain management: The role of top management support for social initiatives and organisational culture. *Corporate Social Responsibility and Environmental Management*. https://doi.org/10.1002/csr.2710

Zuhri, M., Fahmy, R., & Lukito, H. (2023). Performance evaluation: An intervening model of job satisfaction, transformational leadership and career development. *Journal Publicuho*, *6*(2), 366–376.

Appendices

A Theoretical lenses used in SSO studies.

Theories	Authors that used the theories	Number of articles
Stakeholders theory	Wang et al., 2022; Shaw et al., 2023; Di Maddaloni and Sabini, 2022; Tran et al., 2023; Guzmán-Pérez et al., 2023; Adamu and Tyasari, 2022; Goel, Ganesh, and Kaur, 2020a; Mondal et al., 2024; Tumwebaze et al., 2022; Sarrah et al., 2020; Toussaint et al., 2021; Devi et al., 2023; Afum et al., 2022.	13
Institutional theory	Huq and Stevenson, 2020; Nath et al., 2023; Chi et al., 2024; Castaldi et al., 2023; Zhou et al., 2024; Khan et al., 2023; Fernandes et al., 2023; Kelling et al., 2021; Fontana et al., 2023.	9
Resource-based view	Verma et al., 2023; Tjahjadi et al., 2024; Akbar and Ahsan, 2020; Shaharudin et al., 2022; Mohsin et al., 2024; C. M. J. Lee et al., 2021; Awan and Khan, 2021; Samadhiya and Agrawal, 2023.	8
Dynamic capabilities theory	Devi et al., 2023; Rahman et al., 2023; Antwi-Boateng et al., 2023; Uddin et al., 2023; de Nagata et al., 2023.	5
Upper echelon theory	Zhou et al., 2024; Fernandes et al., 2023; Gardazi et al., 2020.	3
Knowledge based view	Mondal et al., 2024; Onofrei et al., 2023; Chi et al., 2024.	3
Transaction cost economics	Wadood et al., 2022; Shaw et al., 2023.	2
Stakeholder salience	Le, 2022; Goel, Ganesh, and Kaur, 2020a.	2
Natural resource-based theory	Agyabeng-Mensah et al., 2020; Shaharudin et al., 2022.	2
Resource dependence	Hohn and Durach, 2021; Toussaint et al., 2021.	2

Theories	Authors that used the theories	Number of articles
Signaling theory	Yasin et al., 2023; Thomas et al., 2021.	2
Social capital theory	Wadood et al., 2022; Alghababsheh and Gallear, 2021	2
Ability motivation opportunity	Abbas et al., 2022	1
Collaboration theory	Tseng et al., 2022	1
Competitive advantage theory	Yasin et al., 2023	1
Equity theory	Alghababsheh et al., 2023	1
Feminist theories	Fernandes et al., 2023	1
Intellectual capital based view	Verma et al., 2023	1
Legitimacy theory	Toussaint et al., 2021	1
Neo-institutional theory	Akbar and Ahsan, 2020	1
Psychological distance	Rogers et al., 2023	1
Research based View	de Nagata et al., 2023	1
Resource advantage theory	Afum et al., 2022	1
Social exchange theory	Lim et al., 2022	1
Stakeholder dynamic capabilities	Devi et al., 2023	1
Systems theory	Turker and Ozdemir, 2020	1
Theory of capital structure	Arianpoor et al., 2023	1

B Definitions of Social sustainability in organizations by studies through stakeholder theorey lense

Authors, year and article's page	Definition	Authors cited
Wang et al. (2022, p. 2439)	Most scholars defined the concept based on the ability and state. In other words, social sustainability is regarded as a final state the realization of human well-being. It is achieved when the state is realized.	Author's own definition
Shaw et al. (2023, p. 3)	Social sustainability encompasses the well-being of human and social capital within the organisation and beyond. A socially sustainable organisation not only takes care of human resources within the organisation by promoting equity, justice, participative policies and practices but also shows its commitment to the well-being of society and community and other stakeholders.	Galuppo et al., 2014
Di Maddaloni and Sabini (2022, p. 778)	Social sustainability definition which is about identifying and managing business impact on people, both positive and negative, and where the quality of a company's relationships and engagement with its stakeholders is critical.	UN Global Compact, 2021
Tran et al. (2023, p. 241)	To fulfill and promote social responsibilities along their supply chains in the pursuit of sustainable development.	Klassen & Vereecke, 2012; Sodhi et al., 2022
Guzmán-Pérez et al. (2023, p. 515)	Company's impact on the social environment in which it operates, along with the company's connection with its interest groups.	Labuschagne et al., 2005
Goel, Ganesh, and Kaur (2020, p. 703)	Improving the quality of human life, making provision for social self-determination and cultural diversity, protecting and promoting human health through a healthy and safe working environment, implementing skills training and capacity enhancement of disadvantaged people, seeking fair or equitable distribution of	Hill & Bowen, 1997

Authors, year and article's page	Definition	Authors cited
Goel, Ganesh, and Kaur (2020, p. 703)	Engagement among employees, local communities, clients, and the supply chain to ensure meeting the needs of current and future populations and communities.	Herd-Smith & Fewings, 2008
Goel, Ganesh, and Kaur (2020, p. 703)	Relates to personal characteristics, which may include education, skills, experience, consumption, income, and employment.	Gatti et al., 2013
Goel, Ganesh, and Kaur (2020, p. 703)	A series of processes for improving the health, safety, and well-being of current and future generations.	Valdes-Vasquez & Klotz, 2013
Goel, Ganesh, and Kaur (2020, p. 703)	The social, societal, and human engagement, impact, and vulnerabilities in a project.	Surbeck & Hilger, 2014
Goel, Ganesh, and Kaur (2020, p. 703)	Contributing to the objectives of creating healthy, livable, equitable, diverse, vital, and sustainability-aware workforces and communities.	Abdel-Raheem & Ramsbottom, 2016
Mondal et al. (2024, p. 3)	Social implications of the company's socially sustainable practices and policies and the measure of growth and development-promoting circumstances existing inside organizations to accomplish different social objectives for the organization.	Sroufe & Gopalakrishna-Remani, 2019
Sarrah et al. (2020, p. 651)	It refers to a system of social organization with the role of alleviating poverty. & Basiago, 1999	
Toussaint et al. (2021, p. 105)	SS concerns the management of social resources, including people's skills and abilities, relationships and social values (Sarkis, Helms, & Hervani, 2010), but also employees' working conditions (De Giovanni, 2012; Emmelhainz & Adams, 1999), or social reputation to measure social performance (Gimenez & Tachizawa, 2012).	Sarkis, Helms & Hervani, 2010; De Giovanni, 2012; Emmelhainz & Adams, 1999; Gimenez & Tachizawa, 2012

Authors, year and article's page	Definition	Authors cited
Afum et al. (2022, p. 720)	SS is the measure of the extent to which the implementation of the sustainable/green practices has positively influenced firms' reputation and improve the welfare of both employee and other stakeholders such as suppliers, customers, end-consumers and the society.	Makov and Newman, 2016

C Initial template for analysis: stakeholders related to GRI 400 Disclosures and report requirements (GRI, 2016a-q and 2018)

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Employee	401: Employment (GRI, 2016a)	
	401-1: New employee hires and employee turnover	Total number of hires and turnover and rates of new hires during the report period by age, gender and region. The age is oriented to be divided as lower than 30 years old, from 30 to 50, and beyond 50.
	401-2: Benefits provided to full-time employees that are not provided to temporary or part-time employees	To inform at least benefits of life insurance, health plan, disability assistance, parental leave, private pension, and share acquisition plan by relevant operations unit, as well as its definition.
	401-3: Parental leave	Total number of employees entitled to parental leave, that took it, that returned to the work after the end of the parental leave, and those that remained for 12 months after their return, return and retention rates from parental leave, all separated by gender.
Employee	402: Labor/Management Relations (GRI, 2016b)	
	402-1: Minimum notice periods regarding operational changes	Period in weeks that are given for employees before the implementation of operational changes that may affect them substantially, and when the organization has collective bargaining agreements, they must report if the deadline for notice are specified in the collective agreements.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Employee and Unions	403: Occupational Health and Safety 2016 (GRI, 2016c)	
	403-1: Workers representation in formal joint management–worker health and safety committees	The level at which each formal joint management-worker health and safety committee typically operates within the organization.
		Percentage of workers whose work, , or workplace, is controlled by the organization, that are represented by formal joint management-worker health and safety committees.
	403-2: Types of injury and rates of injury, occupational diseases, lost days, and absenteeism, and number of work-related fatalities	Types of injury, injury rate (IR), occupational disease rate (ODR), lost day rate (LDR), absentee rate (AR), and work-related fatalities, for all employees, with a breakdown by: i. region; ii. gender.
		Types of injury, injury rate (IR), and work-related fatalities, for all workers (excluding employees) whose work, or workplace, is controlled by the organization, with a breakdown by: i. region; ii. gender.
		The system of rules applied in recording and reporting accident statistics.
	403-3: Workers with high incidence or high risk of diseases related to their occupation	Whether there are workers whose work, or workplace, is controlled by the organization, involved in occupational activities who have a high incidence or high risk of specific diseases.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Employee and Unions	403-4: Health and safety topics covered in formal agreements with trade unions	Whether formal agreements (either local or global) with trade unions cover health and safety.
		If so, the extent, as a percentage, to which various health and safety topics are covered by these agreements.
	403: Occupational Health and Safety 2018 (GRI, 2018)	
	403-1: Occupational health and safety management system	Declaration about health and security in the workplace system that was implemented, including if the system implemented was due to legal requirements, and a list of those requirements and if the implemented system was implemented based on recognized norms from risk management and a list of them, and a description of the scope of workers, activities and workplace contemplated by the management of health and safety of workers, and explanation in cases it is not applied should be justified.
	403-2: Hazard identification, risk assessment, and accident investigation	Description of processes used to identify and evaluate danger and risks in the routine and eventual basis, as well as hierarchy of controls and forms to eliminate and mitigate risks, including how the organization guarantee the quality of those process, competency of whom execute them and their results;
		A description of the processes for workers to report dangers and risks situations, besides an explanation about the protections of workers against reprisals;

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Employee and Unions	403-2: Hazard identification, risk assessment, and accident investigation	Description of policies and processes for workers to be absent in situations they believe can cause an accident or illness, besides an explanation about the protections of workers against reprisals;
		Description of processes used to investigate work accidents and processes to identify danger and evaluate risks to determine corrective actions.
	403-3: Occupational health services	Description of work health services functions that contribute to identification, elimination and mitigation of risks, and how the organization guarantees the quality and access of these services by employees.
	403-4: Worker participation, consultation, and communication on occupational health and safety	Description of the process for workers to participate in the work safety and health and when there is an existence of formal committees of health and safety, the frequency, responsibility and decision power must be described.
	403-5: Worker training on occupational health and safety	Description of capacitations on work health and security offered for workers including specific and generic occupational risks.
	403-6: Promotion of worker health	Explanation about how the organization makes the access of workers to medical services and health easier and the scope of the offered access, and a description of programs and services to promote workers health.
	403-7: Prevention and mitigation of occupational health and safety impacts directly linked by business relationships	Description of the prevention/mitigation of significant impacts on work health and safety directly related to the operations, products or services by the business relations, as well as their dangers and risks.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Employee and Unions	403-8: Workers covered by a occupational health and safety management system	If the implementation of occupational health and safety management system is based in regulatory requirement or acknowledge norms considering employees and not employed workers but whose work/workplace is controlled by the organizations: i) the number and percentage of workers that are covered by this system; ii) the number and percentage of workers covered by this system that has been internally audited; iii) the number and percentage of workers covered by this system that has been internally audited or certified by an external part.
		When workers were excluded from this disclosure, justify the reason and type of excluded workers;
		Information of any contextual information necessary for the comprehensiveness about how the data, norms, methods were gathered.
	403-9: Work related injuries	Considering all employees: i) Number and index of deaths from job accident; ii) Number and index of job accident with severe consequences (except from deaths); iii) Number and index of job accident of mandatory communication; iv) The main types of job accidents; v) Number of working hours.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Employee and Unions	403-9: Work related injuries	Considering workers that are not employees whose work/workplace is controlled by the organization: apply all the same items from subtopic “a” from this disclosure.
		The dangers that present risks for job accidents with severe consequences, including: i) How those dangers were identified; ii) Which of those dangers caused or contributed for work accidents with severe consequences during the time of the report; iii) Measures taken or in progress to eliminate the dangerousness and mitigate risks using control hierarchy;
		Measures taken or in progress to eliminate other dangers and mitigate risks of job accidents using control hierarchy.
		If the index of accidents used as parameter 200.000 or 1.000.000 worked hours.
		If any workers were excluded, the description of them.
		Any context information necessary to comprehend how data was gathered, methodology and premise adopted.
	403-10: Work related ill health	Considering all employees: i) The number of deaths resulted from professional illnesses; ii) Number of cases of professional illnesses of mandatory communication; iii) Main types of professional illnesses.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Employee and Unions	403-10: Work related ill health	Considering workers that are not employees whose work/workplace is controlled by the organization: apply all the same items from subtopic “a” from this disclosure.
		The dangers that represents risks of professional illnesses, including: i) How those dangers were identified; ii) Which of those dangers caused or contributed for cases of professional illnesses during the period of the report; iii) The measures taken or in progress to eliminate the dangerousness and mitigate risks using control hierarchy; iv) If any workers were excluded, the description of them.
		Any context information necessary to comprehend how data was gathered, methodology and premise adopted.
Employee	404: Training and Education (GRI, 2016d)	
	401-1: Average hours of trainning per year per employee	Average hours of capacitation carried out by the employees of the organization during the period of the report, separated by gender and functional category.
	404-2: Programs for upgrading employee skils and trasition assistance programs	Type and scope of implemented programs and assistance for enhancement of competencies of employees and programs of assistance for career transition to facilitate continued employability and of management of the end of career due to retirement or termination of work contract.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Employee	404-3: Percentage of employees receiving regular performance and career development reviews	Percentage of employees by gender and functional category that received regular performance and development on the career evaluation during the reporting period.
Employee	405: Diversity and Equal Opportunity (GRI, 2016e)	
	405-1: Diversity of governance bodies and employees	Percentage of people that compose the governance bodies and employees by functional category for each following diversity group: gender, age (lower than 30 years old, from 30 to 50 and more than 50 years old) and other indicators of diversity when relevant, such as minority and vulnerable groups.
	405-2: Ratio of basic salary and remuneration of women to men	Proportion of base salary and remuneration received by women and men for each functional category by relevant operational units, and the definition of relevant operational units.
Employee	406: Non-discrimination (GRI, 2016f)	
	406-1: Incidents of discrimintation and corrective actions taken	Total cases of discrimination occurred during the time period of the report, their current situation and actions taken regarding to: analysis of the case, repair plan being implemented, analysis of the results of the implemented plans by routine processes of analysis of internal management, and if the case is not subjected to corrective measures anymore.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Employee and Unions	407: Freedom of Association and Collective Bargaining (GRI, 2016g)	
	407-1: Operations and suppliers in which the right to association and collective bargaining may be at risk	Operations and suppliers in which the right of workers to exercise association and collective bargaining may be violated or there is a significative risk of violation discriminated by type of operation and supplier, country or geographic areas with the operation in risk, and corrective actions taken by the organization during the time period of the report in the sense to support the right to exercise the association and collective bargaining.
Society	408: Child Labor (GRI, 2016h)	
	408-1: Operations and suppliers at significant risk for incidents of child labor	Report operations and suppliers that may present significant risks of child labor and young workers exposed to dangerous jobs, operations and suppliers that significative risks of child labor discriminated by type of operation and supplier country or geographic areas with the operation in risk, and corrective actions taken by the organization during the time period of the report in the sense to contribute to an effective abolition of child labor.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Society	409: Forced or compulsory labor (GRI, 2016i)	
	409-1: Operations and suppliers at significant risk for incidents of forced or compulsory labor	Report operations and suppliers that may present significant risks of forced or compulsory labor discriminated by type of operation and supplier country or geographic areas with the operation in risk, and corrective actions taken by the organization during the time period of the report in the sense to contribute to eliminate any kind of forced or compulsory labor.
Society	410: Security practices (GRI, 2016j)	
	410-1: Security personnel trained in human rights policies or procedures	Percentage of security personnel that had a formal training in policies or specific procedures of the organization in human rights and its appliance on security, and if the requirements of the training is applied for hired companies that provide security personnel.
Society	411: Rights of indigenous people (GRI, 2016k)	
	411-1: Incidents of violation involving rights of indigenous people	Total number of violations of indigenous rights during the reporting period, and the current situation of cases and actions taken regarding to: analysis of the case by the organization, repair plan implemented, analysis of the results from the implementation of the repair plan by routine processes of internal management analysis, and if the case is not subjected to corrective measures.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Society	413: Local Communities (GRI, 2016l)	
	413-1: Operations with local community engagement, impact assessments, and development programs	Percentage of operations that implemented engagement, impact evaluations and development programs for the local community including: evaluations and monitoring of social, gender and environmental impact, public release of evaluations of social and environmental programs, plans of engagement of stakeholders, committees and consultations processes for the local community, including vulnerable groups, labor board, health committees, labor safety and other workers representers to discuss impacts and formal processes for complaints from local communities.
	413-2: Operations with significant actual and potential negative impacts on local communities	Operations with real or potential negative impacts on local communities, including their localization and description of the negative impacts.
s	414: Supplier Social Assessment (GRI, 2016m)	
Supplier	414-1: New suppliers that were screened using social criteria	Percentage of new suppliers screened by social criteria
	414-2: Negative social impacts in the supply chain and actions taken	Number of suppliers evaluated by their social impacts and identified as potential or actual negative impacts, the significant potential or actual negative impacts identified in the supply chain, the percentage of suppliers with potential or actual negative impacts that were agreed on improvements to be made and those which the relationship ended as a result of the evaluation, and explanation of the reason.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Society	415: Public Policy (GRI, 2016n)	
	415-1: Political contirbutions	Report of donations for political contributions made directly or indirectly by the organization by country and the beneficiary, and how the monetary value was estimated.
Customer	416: Customer Health and Safety (GRI, 2016o)	
	416-1: Assessment of the health and safety impacts of product and service categories	Report of a significant product or service whose health and safety are assessed for improvement
	416-2: Incidents of non-compliance concerning the health and safety impacts of products and services	Report of total number of incidents that were non compliance according regulations or voluntary codes on health and safety impacts of products or services during the time of the report separated by: incidents that were not according to regulations and resulted on fine or penalty, that resulted on a warning or that were only not according to the voluntary codes. When none of those situations happens, only a brief statement of the situation is enough.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Customer	417: Marketing and Labeling (GRI, 2016p)	
	417-1: Requirements for product and service information and labeling	Type of information that is required by the organization's procedures for product and service information and labeling: the source of components of the product or service, contend regarding to components that might have environmental or social impact, safe use of the product or service, the disposal of the product and environmental or social impacts, and/or othersm and the percentage of significant products or services covered by and assessed for compliance with such procedures.
	417-2: Incidents of non-compliance concerning product and service information and labeling	Total number of incidents of non-compliance with regulatory or voluntary codes regarding to labeling during the time of the report separated by: incidents that were not according to regulations and resulted on fine or penalty, that resulted on a warning or that were only not according to the voluntary codes. When none of those situations happens, only a brief statement of the situation is enough.
	417-3: Incidents of non-compliance concerning marketing communications	Same information from 417-2, but instead of information about labeling, it requires information about marketing communication.

Stakeholder	GRI Disclosure	Report requirement
Customer	418: Customer Privacy (GRI, 2016o)	
	418-1: Substantiated complaints concerning breaches of customer privacy and losses of customer data	Requires the report of the number of complaints received about customer privacy issues separated by complaints received from outside parties and substantiated by the organization, and/or from regulatory bodies, the amount of leaks, thefts or losses or customer data. When none of those situations happens, only a brief statement of the situation is enough.